

Germanic Lexeme Reports: Lexical Derivation Volume

Alpha 01 lexical volume. This volume assembles the current lexeme-report corpus in manifest order without revising entry-level prose, citations, locators, or transducer logic.

Introduction

The catalogue groups words by the kind of historical explanation they require. Regular derivations establish the reach of the sound laws. The remaining classes mark, without concealment, the places where attestation, morphology, analogy, or an unresolved mismatch intervenes.

The catalogue proceeds from words; the preceding part proceeds from rules. Together they allow each proposed sound law to be tested against its lexical witnesses and each etymology against the complete ordered history.

Data and sources

This volume assembles the lexical corpus from the aligned Germanic dataset and the compact derivation traces that accompany each entry. Comparative dictionaries, Old English dictionaries, and historical grammars are cited in the prose where they bear on particular lexical arguments.

The result is a lexical catalogue rather than a separate report on citation method or trace machinery.

Transducer and derivation method

Four objects must be distinguished in every derivation: the citation reconstruction, the selected input, the transducer outcome, and the Old English target. The summary identifies them where they differ; the boxed trace then divides the changes into Earlier Germanic and Old English stages.

Derivation classes

The lexical catalogue is ordered by seven derivation classes in the current manifest. Counts in this alpha are:

- Regular derivations: 79
- Attested variants: 4
- Early analogy: 36
- Late analogy: 27
- Reconstructed Old English comparators: 3
- Known but unmodelled developments: 2
- Unexplained or deliberately unmodelled exceptions: 5

Part I. Regular derivations

In these entries the selected Germanic input yields the Old English reflex by regular sound change. They establish the standard against which the following analogical and exceptional histories must be judged.

adder — OE *nædre*

Derivation: **nédrōn* > *nædre* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **nédrōn*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*nædræ</i>
PNWGMc Long E Lowering	<i>*nādrōn</i>	OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*nædre</i>
PNWGMc N Stem N Loss	<i>*nādr̥</i>		
EAF Long A Fronting	<i>*nædr̥</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *nædre*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen distinguishes the masculine snake word **nadra-* from a feminine ablauting formation **nédrōn-*, and gives Old English *nædre* ‘adder’, *næddre* ‘adder’ under the latter (Kroonen 2013, 426). Orel likewise points from the masculine entry to a feminine **nédrōn* ‘adder’ ~ **nadrōn* ‘adder’ type (Orel 2003, 325).

The derivational input therefore is not a reshaped convenience form. It is the comparative reconstruction that specifically underlies the Old English noun.

Old English evidence The Old English word is securely represented by *nædre* ‘adder’, with *næddre* ‘adder’ as a secondary variant. Clark Hall cross-references *næddre* to *nædre* ‘adder’, and Fulk treats *næddre* as the later geminated form beside the older base (Clark Hall 1960, 225; Fulk 2018, 149).

Development to Old English From **nédrōn* ‘adder’, the stressed long mid vowel develops to Old English *nædre* ‘adder’, and the weak feminine ending remains as final *-e*, giving *nædre*. The doubled consonant of *næddre* ‘adder’ is secondary and does not alter the inherited base form.

bake — OE *bacan*

Derivation: **bákaną* > *bacan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bákaną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	<i>*bækaną</i>
[no change]		OE A Restoration	<i>*bakaną</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*bakan</i>
		OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*bakən</i>
		OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*bakan</i>

Old English form: *bacan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel reconstructs the verb as **bakanan* ‘bake’ and cites Old English *bacan* ‘bake’ beside Old High German *backan*, *bahhan* (Orel 2003). Campbell gives *bacan* as one of the standard examples of Old English A-restoration before a single consonant, and Ringe and Taylor state the same development from **bakan* ‘bake’ to Old English *bacan* (Campbell 1959, 61; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller and Clark Hall both record *bacan* ‘bake’ as the ordinary Old English verb (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 72; Clark Hall 1960). The target in this entry is therefore the attested infinitive headword itself, not a selected oblique or finite paradigm cell.

Development to Old English From **bákaną* ‘bake’, Anglo-Frisian brightening first gives **bækaną* ‘bake’. A-restoration then returns the stem vowel to *a* before single *k* plus the back-vocalic infinitive suffix, and later apocope and weak-tail reduction yield *bacan* ‘bake’ (Campbell 1959, 61; Ringe and Taylor 2014). The development is therefore straightforward: **bákaną* > *bacan*.

beech — OE *bōc*

Derivation: **bōkō* > *bōc* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bōkō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*bōk</i>
PNWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*bōku</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *bōc*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen gives the beech noun as **bōk(j)ō-* and cites Old English *boc* ‘beech’, *bēce* ‘beech’ among its reflexes (Kroonen 2013). The derivational input **bōkō* ‘beech’ is the nominative-singular shape of that family, which is the relevant comparison form here.

Old English evidence Kroonen’s Old English evidence already separates the paradigm material: *boc* ‘beech’ as the nominative form and *bēce* ‘beech’ as an oblique form (Kroonen 2013). The relevant comparator is therefore *bōc* ‘beech’; *bēce* ‘beech’ remains related paradigm evidence rather than the form chosen for this comparison.

Development to Old English With nominative input **bōkō* ‘beech’, the development is compact. Northwest Germanic final long *ō* raises to *u*, and later high-vowel apocope leaves *bōc* ‘beech’. The regular comparison is therefore **bōkō* > *bōc*.

begin — OE *beġinnan*

Derivation: **bigínnaną* > *beġinnan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bigínnaną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic		
[no change]		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope
		OE Secondary Nasalization
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Velar Palatalization
[no change]		OE Prefix I Reduction
		OE Weak Tail Reduction

*bigínnan
 *bigínnan
 *biđínnan
 *bēđínnan
 *bēđínnan

Old English form: *beġinnan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The verb is modeled here as inherited **bigínnanq* ‘begin’. Ringe and Taylor state that intervocalic **g* is palatalized between front vowels in Old English (Ringe and Taylor 2014), and Campbell lists *gínnan* ‘begin’ among familiar examples of palatal *g* in this verb family (Campbell 1959, 174).

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller and Clark Hall lemmatize the verb as *be-gínnan* ‘be-
 gin’ / *beġinnan* ‘begin’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 84; Clark Hall 1960). Those plain-*g* dictionary spellings support the same verb that appears here in normalized form as *beġinnan* ‘begin’.

Development note The prefix deserves separate notice. Ringe and Taylor explicitly cite *bi-* > *be-* as an Old English unstressed-prefix development (Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Development to Old English From **bigínnanq* ‘begin’, heavy-syllable nasal apocope yields **bigínnan* ‘begin’. Intervocalic **g* between front vowels then palatalizes to *ġ*, and the unstressed prefix reduces *bi-* to *be-*, giving *beġinnan* ‘begin’.

bier — OE *bǣr*

Derivation: **bérō* > *bǣr* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bérō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic		
PNWGmc Long E Lowering		OE High Vowel Apocope
PNWGmc Final Long O Raising		
EAF Long A Fronting		
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

*bārō
 *bāru
 *bǣru

*bǣr

Old English form: *bǣr*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the noun as **bērō*- f. ‘bier’ and cites Old English *bar* ‘bier’, *bær* ‘bier’ among the reflexes (Kroonen 2013, 717). The derivational input **bérō* ‘bier’ is the same lexeme in the accent notation used here.

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller lemmatize the noun as *bær* ‘bier’, and Kroonen also records *bar* ‘bier’ beside it (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 73; Kroonen 2013, 717). The target *bǣr* ‘bier’ is therefore a normalized long-vowel spelling of the same noun.

Source note Lexicographic spellings vary between *bær* ‘bier’ and *bar* ‘bier’. The normalized target *bǣr* ‘bier’ represents the same long vowel (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 73; Kroonen 2013, 717).

Development to Old English From **bérō* ‘bier’, Northwest Germanic final long *ō* raises to *u*, long *ē* lowers to *æ*, and high-vowel apocope yields *bær* ‘bier’. The resulting noun matches the normalized Old English target.

birth — OE *byrd*

Derivation: **búrdiz* > *byrd* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **búrdiz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE I Umlaut	<i>*byrði</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*búrdi</i>	OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*byrd</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *byrd*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the noun under stem-level **burdi-* and gives Old English (*ge-*)*byrd* among the reflexes (Kroonen 2013). The derivational input **búrdiz* ‘birth’ is the nominative-style form that stands behind that stem label.

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller both attest simplex *byrd* ‘birth’ as an Old English noun meaning ‘birth’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 125). The prefixed form *gebyrd* ‘birth’ is also well established in the tradition: Kroonen lists (*ge-*)*byrd*, Bosworth-Toller has a separate *ge-byrd* ‘birth’ entry, and Campbell cites *gebyrd* and *gebyrdu* in his grammatical discussion (Kroonen 2013; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 125; Campbell 1959).

Form note The relevant comparator here is the simplex noun *byrd*. The prefixed forms remain related attested material within the same lexical family, and Kastovsky’s discussion of deverbal feminines provides the broader derivational setting (Kastovsky 1992, 358).

Development to Old English From **búrdiz* ‘birth’, loss of final *z* gives **búrdi* ‘birth’. I-umlaut fronts *u* to *y*, and high-vowel apocope then yields *byrd*. The result is the ordinary simplex Old English noun.

bone — OE *bān*

Derivation: **báiną* > *bān* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **báiną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*bān</i>
[no change]			
Early Anglo-Frisian			
EAF Ai Monophthongization	<i>*bāną</i>		

Old English form: *bān*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the noun as **baina-*, and Orel gives the same lexeme under **bainan* ‘bone’ (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003). Both are comparative head-word conventions for the same neuter noun whose Old English reflex is *bān* ‘bone’.

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller record *bān* ‘bone’ as the ordinary Old English noun (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898). Bright’s glossary also distinguishes citation-form *bān* ‘bone’ from oblique *bāne* ‘bone’ (Bright 1971).

Source note The comparative headwords **baina-* and **bainan* ‘bone’ provide lexeme background. The relevant comparison form here is the nominative-accusative singular **báiną* ‘bone’.

Development to Old English West Germanic monophthongization turns stressed **ai* into *ā*, giving **bāną* ‘bone’; heavy-syllable nasal apocope then yields *bān* ‘bone’. The resulting form matches the attested Old English citation noun.

book — OE *bōc*

Derivation: **bōkz* > *bōc* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bōkz*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	[no change]
[no change]	
Early Anglo-Frisian	
[no change]	

Old English form: *bōc*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The noun is an athematic consonant stem (root noun), and the sources print its nominative singular in three different notations that encode the same morphology. Orel’s citation form is **bōkz* ‘book’, with the explicit nominative marker **-z* that he writes across the whole root-noun class (Orel 2003, 52). Kroonen cites the bare stem **bōk-* ‘book, beech’ and treats Gothic *bōka* ‘letter’ as a separate *ō*-stem formation (Kroonen 2013, 71–72). Kluge/Seebold print a third variant with voiceless sibilant, **bōks* ‘book’ (Kluge 2011, 158). These are citation conventions, not competing facts: Ringe gives the consonant-stem nominative ending as zero, **-z*, or possibly **-s*, and states that the distribution is unrecoverable for monosyllabic stems (Ringe 2017, 306). No scholar is simply “wrong” here; the notations differ in whether they make the inflectional marker visible.

The derivational input **bōkz* ‘book’ follows Orel’s morphologically explicit convention: it records the nominative marker whose historical elimination the derivation then models. The word is distinct from the *ō*-stem ‘beech’ word, whose derivational input here is the separate nominative **bōkō* ‘beech’.

Old English evidence Old English *bōc* ‘book’ is the endingless nominative-accusative singular of a root noun, with the mutated plural *bēc* ‘books’ preserving the class’s characteristic i-umlaut alternation (Fulk 2018, 165–66). Comparative root-noun evidence shows the branch-by-branch fate of the ending: Gothic keeps its sibilant in this class (*baúrgs* ‘city’, *nahts* ‘night’), while Old Norse *bók* ‘book’ keeps a reflex of **-z* as *-r* only in the masculine root nouns and drops it in feminines (Fulk 2018, 165–67). West Germanic alone is uniform: none of its daughters shows any ending in the root-noun nominative (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118).

Development to Old English The nominative marker of the consonant stems was eliminated before Proto-West Germanic: endingless nominatives arose by Szemerényi’s law after sonorant-final stems and spread analogically through the class (Fulk 2018, 143), so that no West Germanic daughter inherits an ending here (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118). From the derivational input **bōkz* ‘book’ the loss of the marker gives **bōk* ‘book’, which is already the Old English form: *bōc* ‘book’ differs only in spelling. This early morphological loss is a different development from the

later West Germanic loss of final **z* in unstressed syllables (as in **bárdaz* ‘beard’) and from the still later northern loss in stressed monosyllables (as in the pronouns); the root-noun ending was gone before either of those changes applied.

both — OE *bū*

Derivation: **bō* > *bū* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic		[no change]
PNWGmc Stressed Monosyllable O Raising	<i>*bū</i>	
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Old English form: *bū*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen treats the Germanic numeral under **ba-* and gives the inherited paradigm **bai* ‘both’, **bans* ‘both (pl.)’, **bōz* ‘both’/ **bōns* ‘both’, **bō* ‘both’, with Old English *bēgen* ‘both’, *bā* ‘both’, and neuter *bū* ‘both’ (Kroonen 2013, 47). For the present entry, the relevant inherited form is the unextended neuter dual **bō* ‘both’.

The older explanation of *bēgen* ‘both’ derives it from **bō-jen-*, and Orel still gives OE *bezen* ‘both’ (< **bō-jenō* ‘both’) beside ON *báðir* ‘both’, OFris *bēthe* ‘both’, OS *be-thia* ‘both’, and OHG *bēde* ‘both’ (Orel 2003, 65). Fulk reports that explanation cautiously and notes Seebold’s preference for a **bō-p-* analysis instead (Fulk 2018, sect. 10.1). That debate concerns *bēgen* and the extended forms behind Modern English *both* ‘both’, German *beide* ‘both’, and Dutch *beide* ‘both’; it does not displace the inherited neuter **bō* ‘both’ > *bū* ‘both’ treated here.

Old English evidence The Old English dual paradigm is well established. Brunner gives masculine *bēgen* ‘both’, feminine *bā* ‘both’, and neuter *bū* ‘both’ beside *bā*, with compounds such as *bā twā* ‘both (two)’, *bū tū* ‘both (two, neut.)’, and *bām* ‘both’ *twām* ‘two’ (Brunner 1965, sect. 324 Anm. 2). Campbell and Fulk present the same basic pattern: masculine *bēgen* ‘both’, feminine *bā*, neuter *bā*, *bū*, genitive *bēgra* ‘both’, *bēg(e)a*, and dative *bæm* ‘both’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 683; Fulk 2018, sect. 10.1).

bū ‘both’ is therefore an attested neuter dual form, not a reconstruction. It is the cleanest target for this entry because *bēgen* ‘both’ belongs to the historically more contested **bō-jen-* / analogical zone, while *bā* ‘both’ remains a partner form within the dual paradigm rather than the most straightforward monosyllabic comparison.

Development to Old English **bō* ‘both’ is a stressed monosyllabic form. Campbell cites *cū* ‘cow’, *hū* ‘how’, *tū* ‘two’, and *bū* ‘both’ as examples of final accented *ō* > *ū* in the West Germanic stage leading to Old English (Campbell 1959, sect. 122). Brunner states the same development more directly: Auslautendes *ō* erscheint als *û* in *bū* ... *cu* ... *hū*, *tū* (Brunner 1965, sect. 69).

The development is therefore straightforward: **bō* ‘both’ > *bū* ‘both’.

Form comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the inherited OE target from the other forms that belong to the same broader lexical history.

Form	Source / stage	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>*bō</i> > <i>bū</i>	PGmc neuter dual > OE neuter dual	selected regular comparison	main line of the entry

Form	Source / stage	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>bēgen</i>	OE masculine dual	attested, but historically contested and at least partly analogical in Kroonen	real OE evidence, not the Old English form here
<i>bā</i>	OE feminine dual; also neuter variant	attested partner form	part of the OE paradigm, but not the chosen monosyllabic comparator
<i>báðir</i> , German <i>beide</i> , Dutch <i>beide</i> , Modern English <i>both</i>	Norse, continental West Germanic, Modern English extended forms	related but different formation	useful background, not the direct continuation of OE <i>bū</i>

bow — OE *bīegan*

Derivation: **bāugijanq* > *bīegan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bāugijanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Au Brightening	<i>*bāeugijanq</i>
	OE Diphthong Leveling	<i>*bēagijanq</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*bēagian</i>
	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*bēagijan</i>
	Sievers Law Syncope	<i>*bēagjan</i>
	OE Velar Palatalization	<i>*bēaɕjan</i>
	OE I Umlaut	<i>*biedɕjan</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*biedɕjan</i>
	OE J Loss After Heavy	<i>*biedɕan</i>

Old English form: *bīegan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the weak verb as **baugjan* ‘to (make) bend’ and cites Old English *biegan* ‘bow, bend’ among its reflexes (Kroonen 2013). Ringe and Taylor give the northwest Germanic preform **baugijana* ‘bow’, with later **béagian* ‘bow’ behind West Saxon Old English *biegan* ‘bow, bend’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014). The entry therefore concerns the weak causative member of the bend-family, alongside the related strong verb and noun.

Old English evidence Clark Hall lemmatizes *biegan* ‘bow, bend’ as an Old English weak verb, and Bosworth-Toller records *bigan* ‘bow, bend’ as an attested form (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 102). The form *bīegan* ‘bow, bend’ used here is a normalized spelling of that attested Old English weak verb.

Development to Old English From **bāugijanq* ‘bow’, the stem reaches pre-Old-English **bēagian* ‘bow’, after which palatalization of **gj* and i-umlaut yield West Saxon *biegan* ‘bow’; Campbell lists *biegan* ‘bow’ among the regular *ie* outcomes of **éa* under i-umlaut (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Campbell 1959, 80). The development is therefore straightforward: **bāugijanq* > *bīegan* ‘bow’.

breeches — OE *brēc*

Derivation: **brōkiz* > *brēc* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **brōkiz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Velar Palatalization
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*brōki</i>	OE I Umlaut
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE High Vowel Apocope
[no change]		

Old English form: *brēc*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the noun under **brōk-*, with Old English *brēc* ‘breeches’ and plural ‘breeches’ among its reflexes (Kroonen 2013). Ringe and Taylor give the plural development directly as PNWGMc **brōkiz* ‘breeches’ > **breeci* ‘breeches’ > OE *brēc* ‘breeches’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014). The deeper verbal base belongs to the noun’s etymological background, while the derivational input here is the plural noun form **brōkiz* ‘breeches’.

Old English evidence Bright notes *brēc* ‘breeches’ with plural *brēc* ‘breeches’, and Clark Hall gives *brēc* fp. breeches while also listing *broc* ‘breeches’ as a feminine noun probably represented chiefly in the plural (Bright 1971; Clark Hall 1960, 64). I write *brēc* ‘breeches’ for the long vowel and palatal consonant; the attested plural is *brēc*.

Development to Old English After loss of final -z, the stem ends in -ki, so the velar palatalizes and *ō* ‘breeches’ undergoes i-umlaut to *ē* ‘breeches’; final high-vowel apocope then yields *brēc* ‘breeches’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014). The development is therefore regular: **brōkiz* ‘breeches’ > *brēc* ‘breeches’.

calf — OE *ċealf*

Derivation: **kálbaz* > *ċealf* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **kálbaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGMc Final Bare A Loss
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*kálba</i>	EAF Brightening
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Breaking
[no change]		PGmc B Allophony
		OE Velar Palatalization

Old English form: *ċealf*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen treats the noun under **kalbiz-* and notes an older s-stem **kalbaz* ‘calf’ with plural **kalbizō* ‘calves’, while Orel cites **kalbaz* ‘calf’ as the citation form and Ringe and Taylor derive West Saxon *Cealf* from **kalbaz*, **kalbiz-* (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003, 248; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 220). The derivational input here is the singular **kálbaz* ‘calf’, since the entry concerns the citation-form noun.

Old English evidence Clark Hall gives *cealf* ‘calf’ I. (æ, e) nm. (nap. *cealfu* ‘calves’), and Bosworth-Toller likewise records *Caelf* / *Cealf* ‘calf’ beside plural forms such as *calfur* and *cealfu* ‘calves’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 131). Campbell and Fulk show the same singular-plus-*-r-* plural pattern (Campbell 1959; Fulk 2018, 193). I write *ċealf* ‘calf’ for the palatalized initial; the attested dictionary headword is *cealf* ‘calf’.

Development to Old English After loss of final -z and bare -a, Anglo-Frisian brightening gives **kælb* ‘calf’, and breaking before *l* plus consonant yields **kealb* ‘calf’. Ringe and Taylor’s account of the lexeme and their rule for initial *k* in front-vocalic environments support the West Saxon palatalized onset represented here as *ċ*-, so **kálbaz* ‘calf’ develops regularly to *ċealf* ‘calf’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 220).

corn — OE *corn*

Derivation: **kúrnq* > *corn* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **kúrnq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*kórn</i>
PNWGmc U Lowering		<i>*kórŋq</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Old English form: *corn*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the noun as **kurna-*, and Orel gives the citation form **kurnan* ‘corn’, both with Old English *corn* ‘corn, grain’ among the reflexes (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003, 264). The singular form **kúrnq* ‘corn’ is the nominative-accusative singular appropriate to the citation noun.

Old English evidence Clark Hall gives *corn n.* ‘corn,’ *grain*, Bright’s glossary lists *corn, n.* with genitive singular *corŋes*, and Bosworth-Toller treats *corn* ‘corn, grain’ as an ordinary noun head-word (Clark Hall 1960; Bright 1971, 347; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 144). The target is therefore an attested citation form, while forms such as *corŋes* simply provide paradigm background.

Development to Old English With northwest Germanic lowering, **kúrnq* ‘corn’ becomes **kórŋq* ‘corn’, and later loss of final nasal after a heavy syllable yields **kórn* ‘corn’, whence *corn* ‘corn, grain’. The oblique form **kurnān* ‘corn’ belongs to comparative background rather than to the derivational input of this entry.

deed — OE *dēd*

Derivation: **dédiz* > *dēd* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **dédiz*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*dēd</i>
PNWGmc Long E Lowering		<i>*dādiz</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion		<i>*dādi</i>
EAF Long A Fronting		<i>*dædi</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Old English form: *dēd*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel reconstructs the noun as **dēdiz* ‘deed’, and Ringe and Taylor derive the same inherited i-stem from Proto-Germanic **dédiz* ‘deed’ through northwest Germanic **dadiz* ‘deed’ (Orel 2003; Ringe and Taylor 2014). The acute accent in **dédiz* ‘deed’ marks stress on the same reconstructed long vowel.

Old English evidence Campbell states that Primitive Germanic *ē* appears as West Saxon *ǣ* but in other Old English dialects mostly as *ē*, and Brunner gives the contrast explicitly as West Saxon *dǣd* ‘deed’ beside non-West-Saxon *dēd* ‘deed’ (Campbell 1959; Brunner 1965). Clark Hall likewise lists *dæd* ‘deed’ and cross-refers Anglian *dēd* to it (Clark Hall 1960). West Saxon *dǣd* is therefore the relevant Old English form here, with Anglian *dēd* as a dialectal doublet.

Development to Old English From inherited **dēdiz* ‘deed’, loss of final -z and the West Saxon lowering of stressed long *ē* yield *dǣd* ‘deed’; Anglian *dēd* ‘deed’ preserves the non-West-Saxon outcome (Campbell 1959; Brunner 1965). The development treated here is therefore the regular West Saxon line.

door — OE *dor*

Derivation: **dúrą* > *dor* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **dúrą*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*dór</i>
PNWGmc U Lowering	<i>*dórą</i>	
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Old English form: *dor*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs a neuter **dura-* ‘gate, (single) door’ and cites Old English *dor* ‘door’ among its reflexes. In the same entry he separates Old English *duru* ‘door’, Old Frisian *dore*, and Old High German *tura* ‘door’ as reflexes of **durō-* instead (Kroonen 2013).

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *dor* ‘door’ as a neuter noun and separately records feminine *duru* ‘door’ with its own inflection (Clark Hall 1960). Ringe and Taylor likewise treat *duru* ‘door’ as an early Old English u-stem, originally a root noun shifted into that class (Ringe and Taylor 2014). The Old English form here is therefore the attested neuter *dor* ‘door’, while *duru* ‘door’ remains a parallel Old English reflex from another stem history.

Development to Old English From **dúrą* ‘door’, Northwest Germanic u-lowering gives **dórą* ‘door’, and heavy-syllable nasal apocope then yields *dor* ‘door’. The regular development treated in this entry is therefore **dúrą* > *dor*; the feminine *duru* ‘door’ belongs to the separate line identified by Kroonen and Ringe-Taylor (Kroonen 2013; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

fare — OE *faran*

Derivation: **fáraną* > *faran* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fáraną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	EAF Brightening	<i>*færaną</i>
[no change]	OE A Restoration	<i>*faraną</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*faran</i>
[no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*farąn</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*faran</i>

Old English form: *faran*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen gives the inherited strong verb as **faran-*, and Orel gives the same lexeme as **faranan* ‘fare’, both with Old English *faran* ‘fare’ among the reflexes (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003, 132). Campbell also uses *faran* ‘fare’ as a standard example of Old English A-restoration (Campbell 1959, 61).

Old English evidence Clark Hall lemmatizes the strong verb as *faran* ‘fare’ and separately records weak *færan* ‘to frighten’; *fære* ‘fare’, *færst* ‘fare’, and *færð* ‘fare’ belong to present-tense forms of *faran* rather than to the infinitive itself (Clark Hall 1960). Bosworth-Toller preserves the same distinction (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 108). The Old English form here is therefore the attested citation infinitive *faran* ‘fare’.

Development to Old English From **fāranq* ‘fare’, Anglo-Frisian brightening first gives **færanq* ‘fare’, but A-restoration before single *r* returns **faranq* ‘fare’; later apocope and weak-tail reduction yield *faran* ‘fare’ (Campbell 1959, 61). Fulk’s contrast with participial *faren-* < **faræn-* < **faran-* shows why fronting elsewhere in the paradigm does not alter the infinitive headword (Fulk 2018).

fell — OE *fell*

Derivation: **féllq* > *fell* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **féllq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope <i>*féll</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	

Old English form: *fell*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the noun as **fella-* ‘membrane, skin, hide’ and cites Old English *fell* ‘skin, fell’ beside Dutch *vel* ‘skin, fell’ and German *Fell* (Kroonen 2013). The derivational input **féllq* ‘fell’ is the derivable singular form of that same inherited noun.

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *fell* ‘skin, fell’ as the noun ‘fell, skin, hide’, and Bright’s glossary likewise gives *fell* ‘skin, fell’ with inflected forms such as accusative singular *fel* and dative plural *fellum* (Clark Hall 1960; Bright 1971). The target is therefore the attested noun *fell* ‘skin, fell’, not the verb *fellan* or the preterite *feoll*.

Development to Old English With **féllq* ‘fell’, no special earlier reshaping is needed: heavy-syllable nasal apocope yields **féll* ‘fell’, surfacing as *fell* ‘skin, fell’. The regular development treated here is therefore **féllq* > *fell*.

fern — OE *fearn*

Derivation: **fárnaz* > *fearn* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fárnaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*fárn</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*fárna</i>	EAF Brightening	<i>*færn</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Breaking	<i>*fearn</i>
[no change]			

Old English form: *fearn*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the noun as masculine **farna-* and gives Old English *fearn*, *fern*, while Orel gives the same lexeme as neuter **farnan* ‘fern’ with Old English *fearn* ‘fern’ (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003, 133). Those are comparative headword conventions rather than competing Old English outcomes; the modeled input here is the nominative-style **fárnaz* ‘fern’.

Old English evidence Clark Hall gives *fearn* ‘fern’ as an Old English noun, and Bosworth-Toller records *fearn* ‘fern’ with inflected forms such as *fearnes*, *fearna*, and *fearne* (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 219). Kroonen also records *fern* ‘fern’, but the local lexical sources give stronger support to *fearn* ‘fern’ as the citation target (Kroonen 2013).

Development to Old English From **fárnaz* ‘fern’, loss of final -z and final -a gives **fárn* ‘fern’; Anglo-Frisian brightening then yields **færn* ‘fern’, and breaking before *r* plus consonant gives *fearn* ‘fern’ (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014). The development treated here is therefore the regular *rC*-breaking line.

field — OE *feld*

Derivation: **félθuz* > *feld* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **félθuz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*féld</i>
EAF Th Voicing	<i>*félduz</i>		
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*féldu</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *feld*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor treat Old English *feld* ‘field’ as one of the cases where earlier **felþu-* ~ **feldu-* may reflect either inherited *þ* ~ **d* alternation or the regular West Germanic development **þ* > *ld* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170). The broader proto label **félθuz* ‘field’ can remain as comparative background, while that narrower historical ambiguity does not affect the regular classification.

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *feld* ‘field’ with oblique forms such as *felda* and *felde*, and Campbell notes early place-name spellings in *-felth* beside the later standard form (Clark Hall 1960, 114; Campbell 1959, 169). The Old English form here is therefore the attested citation noun *feld* ‘field’, with the older *-felth* spellings as historical support rather than as rival targets.

Development to Old English In the modeled pathway, medial **lþ* becomes *ld*, final -z is lost, and high-vowel apocope then yields *feld* ‘field’. Whether the voiced dental ultimately reflects inherited alternation or the regular **lþ* > *ld* development, both accounts converge on the same Old English form (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 170).

flea — OE *flēah*

Derivation: **fláuxz* > *flēah* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fláuxz*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Au Brightening OE Diphthong Leveling	* <i>fláeux</i> * <i>flēax</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]		

Old English form: *flēah*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence This word carries a genuine stem-class dispute, not merely a notational one. Orel reconstructs a root noun with his class-wide explicit nominative marker, **flauxz* ‘flea’ (Orel 2003, 105). Kroonen instead reconstructs an *ō*-stem **flauhō*- ‘flea’, with no -z at any layer of the analysis (Kroonen 2013, 145). Kluge and Seebold offer yet a third analysis, a masculine a-stem **flauha*- ‘flea’ (Kluge 2011, 304), whose nominative singular **flauhaz* would have carried its -z in an unstressed syllable and lost it under the West Germanic unstressed loss rather than with the root nouns. The attested forms do not decide the question: Old English *flēah* ‘flea’ and Old Norse *fló* ‘flea’ are compatible with all three reconstructions. This is a case where reputable sources disagree about the morphological class itself, and the disagreement is documented here rather than silently normalized away.

The derivational input **fláuxz* ‘flea’ adopts Orel’s root-noun analysis with its morphologically explicit nominative marker. Under Kroonen’s *ō*-stem analysis the nominative would instead have ended in *-*ō* and developed like the other *ō*-stems; the choice of Orel’s form keeps the word in the root-noun class alongside ‘book’, ‘goose’, and ‘louse’, whose endingless West Germanic nominatives it shares (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118).

Old English evidence Old English *flēah* ‘flea’ is the endingless nominative-accusative singular. The root-noun class to which Orel assigns it shows no nominative ending anywhere in West Germanic (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118); on Kroonen’s *ō*-stem analysis the endingless form would instead reflect the regular fate of the *ō*-stem nominative in this shape. Either way the attested Old English form is the expected one, which is precisely why the class question remains open.

Development to Old English On the selected root-noun analysis, the nominative marker was eliminated before Proto-West Germanic (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118), giving **fláux* ‘flea’ from the derivational input **fláuxz* ‘flea’. The diphthong is then fronted and levelled in Old English, yielding **flēax* ‘flea’, spelled *flēah* ‘flea’ with final *h* for the fricative. The early loss of the root-noun marker is historically distinct from the later West Germanic loss of final *-z in unstressed syllables and from the northern monosyllabic loss with compensatory lengthening; the derivational input is a stressed monosyllable, but its *-z stands after a consonant and was gone long before the northern change, whose domain is vowel-final monosyllables.

fly — OE *flēogan*

Derivation: **fléuganq* > *flēogan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fléuganq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Diphthong Leveling OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*flēoganq</i> <i>*flēogan</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*flēogān</i> <i>*flēogan</i>

Old English form: *flēogan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor derive the verb as **fleugana* ‘fly’ > OE *flēogan* ‘fly’ and elsewhere contrast West Saxon *flēogan* ‘fly’ with Anglian *flēgan* ‘fly’, alongside related forms noted in the form note below (Ringe and Taylor 2014). The derivational input **flēuganq* ‘fly’ represents that inherited strong verb in the notation used here.

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller record *flēogan* ‘fly’ as the ordinary Old English strong verb, and Bright gives the familiar paradigm *flēag* ‘flew’, *flugon* ‘flew’, *flōgen* ‘flown’ with present *fleogeð* ‘flies’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898; Bright 1971). The target in this entry is therefore the attested verbal infinitive itself.

Form note Ringe and Taylor also list related *flēoge* ‘fly’ / *flēge* ‘fly’ and Anglian *flēgan* ‘fly’, which belong to the same family but do not replace the infinitive *flēogan* ‘fly’ treated here (Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Development to Old English From **flēuganq* ‘fly’, Old English diphthong leveling gives **flēoganq* ‘fly’; heavy-syllable nasal apocope and weak-tail reduction then yield *flēogan* ‘fly’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014). The development is therefore regular: **flēuganq* > *flēogan* ‘fly’.

forlorn — OE *lēosan*

Derivation: **lēusanq* > *lēosan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **lēusanq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Diphthong Leveling OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*lēosanq</i> <i>*lēosan</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*lēosān</i> <i>*lēosan</i>

Old English form: *lēosan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the verb under **leusan-* and cites prefixed daughters such as Gothic *fra-liusan* ‘lose’ and Old English *for-lēosan* ‘lose, forlorn’; Orel likewise gives Old English *for-leósan* ‘lose’ (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003). The inherited verbal base is therefore clear, though the daughter set often appears with the prefix.

Old English evidence The direct Old English evidence behind English *forlorn* lies in the prefixed verb *forlēosan* ‘lose, forlorn’ and especially in the participle *forloren* ‘forlorn’, recorded by Ringe and Taylor and in the dictionaries (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898). The simplex infinitive *lēosan* ‘lose’ represents the verbal base itself.

Form note As a base-form comparison, the simplex infinitive is *lēosan* ‘lose’, while the English adjective continues the prefixed Old English family *forlēosan* ‘lose’ / *forloren* ‘forlorn’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Development to Old English From **léusanq* ‘lose’, Old English diphthong leveling gives **lēosanq* ‘lose’, and later nasal apocope and weak-tail reduction yield *lēosan* ‘lose’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014). The prefixed forms follow the same verbal base with added *for-*.

gang — OE *gang*

Derivation: **gángaz* > *gang* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **gángaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*gáng</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*gánga</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *gang*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel reconstructs the noun as **gangaz* ‘gang’ and cites Old English *gang* ‘going, way’ beside Old Norse *gangr*, Old Frisian *gang* / *gong*, Old Saxon *gang* ‘going, way’, and Old High German *gang* ‘going, way’ (Orel 2003). The derivational input **gángaz* ‘gang’ is the same lexeme in the accent notation used here.

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller both record *gang* ‘going, way’ as the noun ‘going, journey, way’, and Bright’s glossary gives *gong* (*gang*), *m.*, *path*, *course* (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 159; Bright 1971, 392). The target is therefore the attested noun headword itself.

Form note This entry concerns the noun *gang* ‘going, way’, not the separate verb *gangan* (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 159).

Development to Old English From **gángaz* ‘gang’, loss of final *-z* gives **gánga* ‘gang’, and later loss of final bare *-a* yields *gang* ‘going, way’. The development is therefore regular: **gángaz* > *gang*.

gift — OE *ġift*

Derivation: **ġiftiz* > *ġift* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **ġiftiz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Velar Palatalization	<i>*ǥifti</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*ġifti</i>	OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*ǥift</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *ġift*

A. The selected reconstruction and the question it answers Old English *ġift* ‘gift’ is a small word with unusually important chronological consequences. A simple high vowel follows an initial palatal consonant, whereas *ġiefan* ‘give’ shows the diphthongal treatment associated with that consonant. To explain the difference we must ask which vowel was present when ordinary palatal diphthongization operated, not simply which order of rules can reproduce the final

spellings. Campbell lists the short-i gift headword among his initial-palatal examples (Campbell 1959, 173–74, §427).

We select PGmc **giftiz* ‘gift’ following Ringe’s explicit reconstruction (Ringe 2017, 135). Our acute root-stress convention does not add a different vowel or claim that the source prints an accent. Both the comparative reconstruction and the selected computational input use the raised vowel. This is a regular inherited derivation, not a late analogical substitute input. The decision is nevertheless not a claim that every etymological source prints the same reconstruction. A substantial e-form tradition must be explained and preserved rather than suppressed.

B. Orel: the full e-vowel noun reconstruction Orel’s noun entry gives an e-vowel reconstruction, normalized here as **geftiz* ‘gift’, and connects it with the verb ‘give’ (Orel 2003, 130). It has the full iz ending, not merely a bare root or a stem ending in a hyphen. His evidence includes the Old English gift headword and the Old Frisian counterpart *jeft* ‘gift, privilege’, alongside the wider inherited formation. The e is plainly printed in the original page: it is not an OCR accident or a vowel introduced by our transcription. Only the initial velar sign is normalized to g here; no argument about stop versus fricative history is drawn from that typographic normalization.

Orel thus provides genuine published support for the older e-input used in our model. However, the entry does not explain why e is reconstructed despite the high-vowel reflex, identify a specific later raising date, or argue against the early raising account. Its derivation from ‘give’ supplies an etymological relationship; that alone does not demonstrate that the noun’s realized root vowel remained identical to the verb’s at every historical stage. The cited bibliography points to morphology and verbal etymology treatments, including Bammesberger and Seebold, considered below (Orel 2003, 130). Those references are evidence of the scholarly tradition behind the entry, not a license to attribute an unstated phonological argument to Orel.

C. Kluge–Seebold: an e-vowel feminine stem Kluge–Seebold gives **gefti-* ‘gift’, explicitly a Germanic feminine stem, and relates the noun to ‘give’ (Kluge 2011, 359). This is independent confirmation that an e-vowel etymological presentation is established in major reference works. It is not the same printed object as Orel’s full nominative reconstruction. We must not silently append z and then present the expanded form as a quotation from Kluge–Seebold.

The entry cites the Old English gift headword and the Old Frisian form *jeft(e)* ‘gift’ within the inherited family (Kluge 2011, 359). Its principal discussion concerns the word’s semantic history; it does not supply a worked chronology of root-vowel raising versus palatal diphthongization. Consequently the entry establishes the stem and its etymological affiliation more directly than it establishes the vowel quality at a narrowly dated phonological node. This does not prove that the stem notation is purely abstract. It means that such an interpretation, if adopted, would require an argument beyond the entry.

D. Bammesberger: the e-grade derivational analysis Bammesberger places the formation among ti-stems built on an e-grade verbal root and prints a segmented e-vowel form (Bammesberger 1990, 142, §5.4.2). His discussion relates the noun to the Germanic root of ‘give’ and treats the consonantal sequence ft as regular in the ti-abstract formed from a labial-final root. On the same page the formation also participates in his explanation of the structural pattern of other abstracts. The continuation lists further e-grade formations with Old English i-vowel reflexes (Bammesberger 1990, 142–43).

This is a substantive reason for retaining e in the derivational analysis: the noun belongs to an e-grade formation, not an arbitrarily invented high-vowel root. But derivational grade and realized surface quality after a regular conditioned sound change are different questions. An e-grade formation can have a later i-reflex without becoming a zero-grade formation. The passage supports the morphological analysis; it does not itself decide that the inherited e survived until Old English mutation or state a competing date for raising. We therefore retain its e-grade evidence in the deeper explanation without using it alone to override a separately argued phonological reconstruction (Bammesberger 1990, 142–43).

E. Seebold: segmented forms and the limits of notation Seebold prints a segmented e-vowel formation with the full nominal ending and supplies more differentiated Old English evidence than a single normalized citation (Seebold 1970, 218). He distinguishes *giftu* ‘wedding’, explicitly plural, *gyft* ‘marriage’, and *feoh-gift* ‘gift of money’. A separate homonymous noun associated with ‘food’ belongs to a different formation and must not be recruited as attestation for the noun treated here. These distinctions matter: the formation’s identity is well supported, but a plural or compound citation is not automatically evidence for a particular singular manuscript token.

His methodological introduction also makes clear that the reconstructed notation is not uniformly a direct transcription of one phonological moment. Earlier states are reconstructed for selected developments, including the development of *ei* to long *i* (Seebold 1970, 35). The symbols for stem classes are modelled on common-Germanic forms without claiming exact phonetic reproduction (Seebold 1970, 35–36). These explicit cautions make it particularly important not to read every segment mechanically as an input to a later sound-change cascade. They do not, however, specifically explain the root *e* in this noun: the warning about stem-class endings cannot be generalized into proof that all reconstructed root vowels are abstract morphological labels. We leave that interpretive limit visible rather than declaring the *e/i* discrepancy merely notational.

F. Ringe: the realized PGmc i-form and its phonological rationale Ringe explicitly gives PGmc **giftiz* ‘gift’ as the nominal formation associated with the verb ‘give’ (Ringe 2017, 135). His discussion places it in the broader treatment of productive nominal formation and consonantal developments. The Old English comparison is plural *gifta* ‘wedding’, with a change of stem class. We do not turn that plural into a claim that Ringe attests our normalized singular target.

The vowel has a separate phonological explanation. Ringe states that *e* was raised to *i* when a high front vocalic followed in the same or immediately succeeding syllable (Ringe 2017, 151–52). The noun’s following *i* supplies precisely such an environment. This explains how an etymological e-grade formation can be represented with *i* in a realized phonological reconstruction. It is not a lexical exception, a grammatical condition on nouns, or a repair licensed only because this one word otherwise produces an unwanted diphthong.

Ringe is more cautious about the exact ancestral dating than a bare reconstruction might suggest. The merger of stressed *e* and *i* in Gothic prevents direct demonstration of the raising there. His indirect argument depends on raising preceding *j*-loss and subsequent contraction, particularly the history of the numeral ‘three’. He calls a PGmc date the most probable hypothesis, not completely certain (Ringe 2017, 152–53). That qualification belongs in our account. It concerns the placement of the change in the deeper ancestry; it must not be misrepresented as doubt that his noun entry actually prints an *i*-vowel reconstruction.

Ringe and Taylor independently insist on separating this inherited raising from Old English front mutation: the older change occurred hundreds of years earlier, and alleged later repetitions are rare and doubtful (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 220). Their discussion therefore supplies an important chronological check against explaining this noun’s inherited high vowel by the general Old English mutation rule.

G. Why we choose *i*, and what changes in the derivation For the input to a PGmc-to-OE cascade we prefer the explicitly staged phonological reconstruction, rather than carrying an earlier etymological e-grade representation forward until a convenient later rule can correct it. Ringe’s noun and regular raising account together supply that reconstruction (Ringe 2017, 135, pp. 151–153). The competing reference forms remain part of the evidence: we neither count dictionary spellings as votes nor conclude that their authors were wrong merely because they did not give a worked chronology.

With earlier *i* already present, the noun undergoes the inherited consonantal and ending developments, then initial palatalization. Ordinary palatal diphthongization does not change its high vowel, and Old English mutation need not raise an *e* that is no longer there. Loss of the final high vowel and surface spelling yield *gift* ‘gift’. Our earlier implementation instead allowed a selected e-input to reach late mutation and used that correction to justify putting all palatal diphthongization afterward. The right final spelling concealed the wrongly conflated histories.

The independent ordinary chronology is breaking, then palatal diphthongization, then mutation (Fulk 2018, 74; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 215–17, 222). The worked contrast is *ġiest* ‘guest’: its low-front vowel first becomes *ea* after the palatal, and *ea* then becomes *ie* under mutation. Gift’s earlier *i* is a negative control on ordinary diphthongization, not an independent proof of that relative order. The later treatment of *scēap* ‘sheath’ is separately retained after mutation; its mutation-derived long vowel does not require ordinary diphthongization as a whole to be late (Campbell 1959, 68–69; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 235). The complete conditioning of that later treatment remains unresolved.

H. Confidence and the remaining alternatives Our confidence is strongest in the distinction between inherited raising and later OE mutation, and in the independently supported ordinary diphthongization chronology. The choice of Ringe’s *i*-input is well motivated as an explicit working phonological reconstruction, but is not advertised as unanimous: Orel’s *e*-form, Kluge–Seebold’s *e*-stem and the *e*-grade derivational presentations remain genuine alternatives (Orel 2003, 130; Kluge 2011, 359; Bammesberger 1990, 142–43; Seebold 1970, 218). We have not established that every one of those forms denotes exactly the same historical phonological checkpoint as Ringe’s input.

Confidence in the precise PGmc date is qualified by Ringe’s own indirect evidence (Ringe 2017, 152–53). Confidence in our normalized target as a headword is distinct from certification of a diplomatic paradigm cell (Campbell 1959, 173–74). Variant spellings alone do not establish a different exceptionless sound law, lexical diffusion, or an analogical history; those explanations would need their own evidence. We make no such new claim here.

The computational comparison is deliberately secondary. The adopted input and ordinary chronology preserve every previously generated final form, while realizing the source sequence for *guest* and leaving *sheath*’s derivation unchanged. That demonstrates compatibility of the selected account with the present corpus, not its historical truth by output score. If stronger evidence eventually requires an *e*-vowel at the input node, the necessary earlier regular raising must be specified and tested as such; it must not be silently delegated again to late OE mutation.

give — OE *ġiefan*

Derivation: **ġébanq* > *ġiefan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **ġébanq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*ġéban</i>
[no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*ġébān</i>
	PGmc B Allophony	<i>*ġéβān</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	OE Velar Palatalization	<i>*ġjéβān</i>
[no change]	OE Ws Palatal Diphthongization	<i>*ġjiefβān</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*ġjiefān</i>

Old English form: *ġiefan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the strong verb as **geban-* and cites Old English *ġiefan* ‘give’ among its reflexes (Kroonen 2013). Ringe and Taylor contrast West Saxon *ġiefan* ‘give’ with Mercian *for-geofan* ‘give’ and Northumbrian *geafa* ‘give’, showing that the inherited verb takes different later dialectal shapes (Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Old English evidence Campbell gives *gefan* (W-S *ġiefan* ‘give’) among examples of initial palatalization, and Clark Hall records the verb under plain *ġiefan* ‘give’ with forms such as *geaf* and *ġiefen* (Campbell 1959; Clark Hall 1960). I write *ġiefan* ‘give’ for the palatal initial.

Dialect note West Saxon *ie* here reflects palatal diphthongization after initial palatalization; non-West-Saxon forms such as *geafa* ‘give’ or *for-geofan* ‘give’ continue the same verb without the West Saxon vocalism (Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Development to Old English From **gébanq* ‘give’, initial *g* palatalizes before *e*; West Saxon palatal diphthongization then yields *ie*, and later tail reduction gives *giefan* ‘give’ (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014). The result is therefore the regular West Saxon infinitive.

gold — OE *gold*

Derivation: **gúlθq* > *gold* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **gúlθq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*góld</i>
EAF Th Voicing	<i>*gúldq</i>		
PNWGMc U Lowering	<i>*góldq</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *gold*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor cite the noun as **gulþa-* / **gulda-*, and Kroonen gives the same pair (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 42; Kroonen 2013). The derivational input **gúlθq* ‘gold’ preserves the older consonantal form while leaving open whether the medial stop reflects inherited alternation or regular West Germanic development.

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller and Clark Hall both record *gold* as the ordinary Old English neuter noun (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 121; Clark Hall 1960, 152). The target is therefore the attested citation form itself.

Development note Ringe and Taylor note that the medial stop can be understood either as alternation **gulþa-* / **gulda-* or as the ordinary West Germanic change **lp* > *ld*; both routes lead to the same Old English consonantism (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 42).

Development to Old English From **gúlθq* ‘gold’, the regular consonant development gives **gúldq* ‘gold’; Northwest Germanic / Old English lowering then yields **góldq* ‘gold’, and apocope gives *gold* (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 42).

goose — OE *gōs*

Derivation: **gánsz* > *gōs* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **gánsz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		[no change]	
EAF Nasal Spirant Lengthening	<i>*gãns</i>		
EAF Nasal Spirant Loss	<i>*gãs</i>		
EAF Nasalized Low Rounding	<i>*gōs</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *gōs*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The ‘goose’ word is a root noun whose nominative singular has an unusually layered history. Orel’s citation form is **gansz* ‘goose’, with his class-wide explicit nominative marker **-z* stacked on the root-final *s* (Orel 2003, 126). Kroonen reconstructs an endingless nominative **gans* ‘goose’ with Verner-voiced *z* only in the oblique cells (genitive **gunzaz* ‘goose (gen.)’) (Kroonen 2013, 168–69), and Kluge/Seebold treat the German cognate under the same root noun (Kluge 2011, 331). Bammesberger supplies the deeper layer: by Szemerényi’s law the Proto-Indo-European nominative **ǵʰanss* yielded **ǵʰān*, after which the Proto-Germanic nominative was rebuilt with a final voiced sibilant, **ganz*, reanalyzed within the paradigm (Bammesberger 1990, 196). A mainstream specialist thus reconstructs a Proto-Germanic ‘goose’ nominative with a final voiced sibilant; Orel’s notation is not idiosyncratic, and Kroonen’s endingless citation reflects a different analytical layer of the same paradigm rather than a contradictory fact.

The derivational input **gánsz* ‘goose’ follows Orel’s morphologically explicit convention, keeping the nominative marker visible so that its historical elimination is modelled rather than presupposed.

Old English evidence Old English *gōs* ‘goose’ is the endingless nominative-accusative singular, with mutated plural *ġēs* ‘geese’ (Fulk 2018, 165–66). The comparative picture matches the rest of the root-noun class: Gothic replaced the word (its ‘goose’ is the u-stem remodeling behind Spanish *ganso* ‘goose’ (Orel 2003, 126)), and no West Germanic daughter shows any nominative ending (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118).

Development to Old English The root-noun nominative marker was eliminated before Proto-West Germanic (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118), giving **gáns* ‘goose’ from the derivational input **gánsz* ‘goose’. The remaining development is the familiar Ingvaeonic nasal-spirant sequence: the vowel lengthens and rounds before the nasal + voiceless fricative cluster and the nasal is then lost, giving **gōs* ‘goose’, which is the attested Old English form. The early loss of the nominative marker is historically distinct from the later West Germanic loss of final **z* in unstressed syllables and from the northern monosyllabic loss with compensatory lengthening; had the marker survived to the later monosyllabic change, a lengthened vowel before *s* would not be the expected outcome of this shape, since the root-noun ending was already gone.

grave — OE *grafan*

Derivation: **grábaną* > *grafan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **grábaną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening		<i>*græbaną</i>
	OE A Restoration		<i>*grabana</i>
	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope		<i>*graban</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization		<i>*grabɑn</i>
	PGmc B Allophony		<i>*graβɑn</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction		<i>*graβan</i>

Old English form: *grafan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Campbell gives *grafan* ‘dig, grave’ among the standard examples of Old English a-restoration before a single consonant and a following back vowel, and Ringe and Taylor describe the same development for Class VI infinitives (Campbell 1959, 61; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *grafan* ‘dig, grave’ as the verb ‘to dig, grave’ and separately records noun *græf* ‘grave, trench’ (Clark Hall 1960). The target here is the attested infinitive headword of the verb.

Development to Old English From **grábanq* ‘grave’, Anglo-Frisian brightening first gives a fronted stem vowel. A-restoration then returns *a* before single *b* plus the back-vocalic infinitive ending, and later apocope and weak-tail reduction yield *grafan* ‘dig, grave’ (Campbell 1959, 61; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Form note Noun *græf* ‘grave’ and verbal forms such as *græfð* ‘graves’ or past participial *græfen* ‘graven’ belong to other lexical or paradigm positions and do not replace the infinitive *grafan* ‘grave’ as the target here (Clark Hall 1960).

guest — OE *ġiest*

Derivation: **gástiz* > *ġiest* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **gástiz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	<i>*gæsti</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*gásti</i>	OE Velar Palatalization	<i>*ǵæsti</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Ws Palatal Diphthongization	<i>*ǵeasti</i>
		OE I Umlaut	<i>*ǵiesti</i>
[no change]		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*ǵiest</i>

Old English form: *ġiest*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Campbell and Ringe-Taylor treat the noun as an ordinary i-stem whose West Saxon development shows palatal diphthongization, while non-West-Saxon evidence preserves forms of the *gest* ‘guest’ type (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller and Clark Hall record the word under forms such as *gist* ‘guest’, *gest* ‘guest’, *ġiest* ‘guest’, and *gyst* ‘guest’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898; Clark Hall 1960). The Old English form here, *ġiest*, ‘guest’ is the normalized West Saxon form within that attested family.

Development to Old English From **gástiz* ‘guest’, Anglo-Frisian brightening gives a *gæst*-stage, and i-mutation affects the front vowel before the lost high-vocalic ending. In West Saxon the initial palatal environment then produces *ie*, so the regular outcome is *ġiest* ‘guest’ (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Dialect note West Saxon *ġiest* ‘guest’ is the Old English form here. Anglian *gest* ‘guest’ and related spellings remain real Old English comparators rather than corrections to that choice (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Bosworth and Toller 1898).

hair — OE *hǣr*

Derivation: **xérq* > *hǣr* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xérq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Velar Fricative Palatalization	<i>*çǣrq</i>
PNWGmc Long E Lowering	<i>*xārq</i>	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*çǣr</i>
EAF Long A Fronting	<i>*xǣrq</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *hǣr*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the ordinary Proto-Germanic hair word as **hēra-* (Kroonen 2013). The derivational input **xérq* ‘hair’ represents that same long-ē stem in the present derivation.

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller record *hær* ‘hair’ / *hǣr* ‘hair’ as the ordinary Old English noun (Clark Hall 1960, 158; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 510). The target is therefore the attested headword itself.

Development to Old English From **xérq* ‘hair’, Northwest Germanic lowering gives a long front vowel, and later loss of the final nasal leaves the Old English form *hǣr* ‘hair’. The development treated here is straightforward and does not require any special paradigm choice.

Form note Older references to **xazwǣz* ‘hair’ belong to a different lexeme, and the separate *haddr* / *heordan* / *hād-* material does not displace the ordinary simplex *hǣr* ‘hair’ treated here (Kroonen 2013; Clark Hall 1960, 158).

harvest — OE *hierfest*

Derivation: **xárbistuz* > *hierfest* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xárbistuz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	<i>*xærbistu</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*xárbistu</i>	OE Breaking	<i>*xearbistu</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Velar Fricative Palatalization	<i>*çearbistu</i>
[no change]		PGmc B Allophony	<i>*çearβistu</i>
		OE I Umlaut	<i>*çierβistu</i>
		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*çierβist</i>
		OE Med Unstressed I Lowering1	<i>*çierβest</i>

Old English form: *hierfest*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Bammesberger and Ringe-Taylor treat **harbist-* as the inherited base and explain that the regular native West Saxon development would be of the *hierfest* / *hyrfest* type (Bammesberger 1997; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller and Clark Hall record *hærfest* ‘harvest’, with *herfest* ‘harvest’ as a variant in the lexical tradition (Bosworth and Toller 1898; Clark Hall 1960). Those attested forms remain the main dictionary evidence for the noun.

Development to Old English From **xárbistuz* ‘harvest’, Anglo-Frisian brightening, breaking, and i-mutation produce a *hierbist-* stage, and later lowering of unstressed medial *i* to *e* gives *hierfest* ‘harvest’. That is the regular West Saxon development treated here (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Campbell 1959).

Source note The Old English form here, *hierfest*, represents the regular native West Saxon outcome discussed by Bammesberger and Ringe-Taylor. The attested Old English lexical tradition, however, is chiefly *hærfest* ‘harvest’ / *herfest* ‘harvest’, commonly treated as non-West-Saxon or Anglian material in West Saxon transmission (Bammesberger 1997; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

hedge — OE *heġġ*

Derivation: **xágjaz* > *heġġ* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xágjaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*xággj</i>
PWGmc J Gemination	<i>*xággjaz</i>	EAF Brightening	<i>*xæggj</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*xággja</i>	OE Velar Fricative Palatalization	<i>*çæggj</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Velar Palatalization	<i>*çæɟɟj</i>
[no change]		OE I Umlaut	<i>*çeɟɟj</i>
		OE J Loss After Heavy	<i>*çeɟɟ</i>

Old English form: *heġġ*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The derivational input models a palatal **-gj-* ‘hedge’ noun whose Old English development includes gemination, palatalization, and i-mutation. The current derivation therefore reaches a palatal-geminate outcome of the *heġġ* ‘hedge’ type (Campbell 1959).

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller and Clark Hall record the noun under standard spellings *hecġ* ‘hedge’ / *heġġ* ‘hedge’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898; Clark Hall 1960). The lexical item itself is therefore well attested even though the form compared here is normalized.

Development to Old English From **xágjaz* ‘hedge’, West Germanic j-gemination first yields a geminate stop, and later Old English palatalization and loss of final *j* produce *heġġ* ‘hedge’. The development is treated as regular rather than exceptional.

Form note Standard dictionary spelling is *heġġ* ‘hedge’ or *hecġ* ‘hedge’. Normalized *heġġ* ‘hedge’ is the Old English form here, while the ordinary lexicographic forms remain the main Old English citation evidence (Bosworth and Toller 1898; Clark Hall 1960).

helm — OE *helm*

Derivation: **xélmaz* > *helm* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xélmaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*xélm</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*xélma</i>	OE Velar Fricative Palatalization	<i>*çélm</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *helm*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the helmet noun as **helma-* and separately distinguishes a different lexeme **helman-* ‘rudder’ (Kroonen 2013). The derivational input **xélmaz* ‘helm’ is the nominative-style form used for the helmet noun itself.

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller record *helm* ‘helm, helmet’ as the ordinary Old English noun for ‘helmet’, while *helma* ‘helm’ belongs to a separate rudder lexeme (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 542).

Development to Old English From **xélmaz* ‘helm’, loss of final *z* and later loss of the short final vowel yield *helm* ‘helm, helmet’. The development is therefore a straightforward citation-form match.

Form note Comparative **helma-* is headword notation for the helmet cognate set. It should not be confused with Old English *helma* ‘helm’, which is a different noun meaning ‘helm, rudder’ (Kroonen 2013; Clark Hall 1960).

help — OE *helpan*

Derivation: **xélpanq* > *helpan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xélpanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Velar Fricative Palatalization	<i>*çélpanq</i>
	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*çélpan</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*çélpqn</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*çélpn</i>

Old English form: *helpan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The entry treats the strong verb itself rather than the separate noun *help* ‘help’. Bright’s principal parts *helpan*, *healp*, *hulpon*, *holpen* show the ordinary Old English strong-verb family continued by this input (Bright 1971).

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller record *helpan* ‘help’ as the verbal headword ‘to help’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 542). The target is therefore the attested infinitive citation form.

Development to Old English From **xélpanq* ‘help’, no special repair is needed beyond the ordinary reduction of the infinitive ending. The derivation therefore reaches *helpan* ‘help’ directly.

Form note Noun *help* ‘help’ belongs to a separate lexical line and should not replace verbal *helpan* ‘help’ as the target here (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 542).

hind — OE *hind*

Derivation: **xéndjō* > *hind* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xéndjō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic PNWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*xéndju</i>	OE Velar Fricative Palatalization
		OE I Umlaut
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]		OE High Vowel Apocope
		OE J Loss After Heavy

Old English form: *hind*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the animal name as **hindō*- f. ‘hind’ (Kroonen 2013). The derivational input **xéndjō* ‘hind’ represents that same noun in the present derivation.

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller record *hind* ‘hind, doe’ as the noun ‘hind, female deer’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 554). The target is therefore the attested lexical item itself.

Development to Old English From **xéndjō* ‘hind’, i-mutation produces the front-vocalic Old English stem, and later apocope plus loss of final *j* yield *hind*. The outcome is therefore a regular citation-form derivation.

Form note *hindan* ‘from behind, behind’ is a different Old English lexeme and does not belong to the noun history of *hind* (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 554).

hold — OE *healdan*

Derivation: **xáldanq* > *healdan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xáldanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening	<i>*xældanq</i>
	OE Breaking	<i>*xealdanq</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Velar Fricative Palatalization	<i>*çealdanq</i>
	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*çealdan</i>
	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*çealdqn</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*çealdan</i>

Old English form: *healdan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Campbell and Ringe-Taylor treat the verb as a regular *a* + *lC* breaking case, with West Saxon *healdan* ‘hold’ opposed to Anglian and Mercian *haldan* ‘hold’ (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Old English evidence Bright gives the ordinary strong-verb citation form and principal parts *healdan*, *heold*, *heoldon*, *healden* (Bright 1971). The target is therefore the attested infinitive head-word itself.

Development to Old English From **xáldanq* ‘hold’, Anglo-Frisian brightening first yields a fronted vowel, and West Saxon breaking then produces *ea* before *ld*. Later reduction of the infinitive ending gives *healdan* ‘hold’ (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Dialect note West Saxon *healdan* ‘hold’ is the Old English form here. Anglian and Mercian *haldan* ‘hold’ are genuine non-West-Saxon doublets rather than corrections to that choice (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

horn — OE *horn*

Derivation: **xúrnq* > *horn* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xúrnq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*xórn</i>
PNWGmc U Lowering	<i>*xórnq</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *horn*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen and Orel cite lemma-style Proto-Germanic headwords of the **hurna-* / **xurnan* ‘horn’ type for this noun (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003, 234). The derivational input **xúrnq* ‘horn’ is the nominative-style form used in the derivation here.

Old English evidence Clark Hall, Bosworth-Toller, and Bright all record *horn* as the ordinary Old English noun (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 108; Bright 1971). The target is therefore the attested citation form.

Development to Old English From **xúrnq* ‘horn’, Northwest Germanic u-lowering gives **xórnq* ‘horn’, and later loss of the final nasal leaves *horn*. The development treated here is fully regular.

Form note The note’s oblique **xurnǎn* ‘horn’ belongs to comparative stem background only. It does not replace the derivational input **xúrnq* ‘horn’ as the derivational form used here (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003, 234).

lead — OE *lædan*

Derivation: **láidijanq* > *lædan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **láidijanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*lādijan</i>
[no change]		OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*lādijan</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		Sievers Law Syncope	<i>*lādjan</i>
EAF Ai Monophthongization		OE I Umlaut	<i>*lædjan</i>
	<i>*lāidijanq</i>	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*lædjan</i>
		OE J Loss After Heavy	<i>*lædan</i>

Old English form: *lædan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor derive Old English *lædan* ‘lead’ from Proto-Germanic **laidijanq* ‘lead’, and Kroonen likewise cites a weak verb of the **laidjan-* type for ‘lead’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Kroonen 2013, 363).

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller both record *lædan* ‘lead’ / *lædan* ‘lead’ as the ordinary Old English verb ‘to lead, guide, conduct’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898).

Development to Old English From **láidijanq* ‘lead’, monophthongization of **ai* first gives a **lād-* stage. Later syncope, i-mutation, weak-tail reduction, and loss of *j* after a heavy stem yield *lædan* ‘lead’, so the development represented here is fully regular (Ringe and Taylor 2014).

learn — OE *liornian*

Derivation: **líznojanq* > *liornian* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **líznojanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic		
EAF Rhotacism	<i>*lirnōjanq</i>	OE Breaking <i>*liornōjanq</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope <i>*liornōjan</i>
[no change]		OE Secondary Nasalization <i>*liornōjan</i>
		OE I Umlaut <i>*liornejan</i>
		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening <i>*liornejan</i>
		OE Weak Tail Reduction <i>*liornejan</i>
		OE Intervocalic J Vocalization <i>*liorneian</i>
		OE Unstressed EI Contraction <i>*liornian</i>

Old English form: *liornian*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor place the verb in a class-II weak family of the **liznō-* type (Ringe and Taylor 2014), and Kroonen keeps the same comparative base for the Germanic lexeme (Kroonen 2013). The derivational input therefore requires no change of stem class or paradigm cell.

The non-obvious issue is dialectal. Campbell records Northumbrian *liornian* ‘learn’ beside *leornian* ‘learn’, and he states that the *eo* of *leornian* ‘learn’ is secondary, while Northumbrian preserves forms with *io*, where original *eo* and *io* remain distinct (Campbell 1959, sect. 123 n. 2).

Old English evidence **liornian* ‘learn’ is the Northumbrian member of the Old English family. Dictionary practice more often privileges *leornian* ‘learn’ as the ordinary headword (Clark Hall 1960; Bright 1971), but Campbell’s dialect evidence shows that *liornian* ‘learn’ is a genuine Old English form (Campbell 1959, sect. 123 n. 2).

This entry therefore remains compact. The point is to state clearly that the Old English form here belongs to the Northumbrian side of the OE evidence rather than to the leveled *leornian* ‘learn’ headword tradition.

Development to Old English From **lirnōjanq* ‘learn’, the expected Old English developments include rhotacism of *z*, followed by breaking before *r* plus consonant, and the ordinary reduction of the weak verbal ending. The result is *liornian* ‘learn’, preserving the *io* spelling that Campbell associates with Northumbrian where original *eo* and *io* remain distinct (Campbell 1959, sect. 123 n. 2).

Leornian reflects the later *eo* development that Campbell treats as secondary [Campbell (1959), §123 n. 2; §296]. The selected Northumbrian target is therefore the regular comparison form for the *i*-grade member of the family.

Form comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the regular Northumbrian form modeled here from the better-known West Saxon headword.

Form	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>*lirnōjanq</i> > <i>liornian</i>	computed regular output; attested Northumbrian comparison form	selected comparison
<i>leornian</i>	attested later <i>eo</i> form and dictionary headword	useful control, but not the target of this entry

lid — OE *hlid*

Derivation: **xlīdq* > *hlid* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xlídq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope <i>*xlíd</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	

Old English form: *hlid*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel cites a neuter lexeme of the **xlid-* type with Old English *hlid* ‘lid, cover’, and Lloyd includes OE *hlid* ‘lid’ beside ON *hliþó* ‘lid’ and OHG *(h)lit* ‘lid’ among forms that retain *i* (Orel 2003; Lloyd 1966).

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller record *hlid* ‘lid, cover’ as the noun ‘lid, cover, door, gate’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 563).

Development to Old English The derivational input already represents the later Germanic *hlid-* stage used for the derivation here. From **xlídq* ‘lid’, heavy-syllable apocope yields *hlid* ‘lid’, and the form belongs to the retained-*i* set noted by Lloyd rather than to the lowered *e* type (Lloyd 1966).

Form note An earlier etymological stage **liþuz* ‘lid’ belongs to comparative background only. The form represented here is the later **xlídq* ‘lid’ > *hlid* ‘lid’ line that matches the attested Old English noun (Orel 2003; Lloyd 1966).

light — OE *liehtan*

Derivation: **léuxtijanq* > *liehtan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **léuxtijanq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Diphthong Leveling <i>*lēuxtijanq</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope <i>*lēuxtijan</i>
	OE Secondary Nasalization <i>*lēuxtjān</i>
	Sievers Law Syncope <i>*lēuxtjān</i>
	OE I Umlaut <i>*liextjān</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction <i>*liextjan</i>
	OE J Loss After Heavy <i>*liextan</i>

Old English form: *liehtan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Fulk gives Proto-Germanic **liuxtijanan* ‘light’ with Old English *liehtan* ‘illuminate’, and Ringe and Taylor likewise derive West Saxon *liehtan* ‘light, illuminate’ from the same weak-verb formation (Fulk 2018; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller preserve the verb family under spellings such as *liehtan* ‘illuminate’, *lihtan* ‘light, illuminate’, and *lihtan* ‘illuminate’, distinct from the related noun *leoht* ‘light’ and adjective *leoht* / *liht* ‘light’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898).

Development to Old English From **léuxtijanq* ‘light’, the regular verbal line preserves **xt*, passes through a West Saxon *liehtan* ‘illuminate’ stage, and is represented here by normalized *liehtan* ‘illuminate’. The word treated in this entry is therefore the verb ‘to light, illuminate’, not the related noun from **leuxtq* ‘light’ (Fulk 2018; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Dialect note Ringe and Taylor and Campbell distinguish West Saxon *liehtan* ‘light, illuminate’ from Anglian *lihtan* ‘light, illuminate’, while later West Saxon also shows *lyhtan* ‘light, illuminate’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Campbell 1959).

linden — OE *lind*

Derivation: **lindō* > *lind* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **lindō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*lind</i>
PNWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*lindu</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *lind*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites **lindō-* ‘lime tree’ and gives Old English *lind* ‘linden, lime tree’ as the relevant reflex (Kroonen 2013).

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller both record *lind* ‘linden, lime tree’ as the noun ‘lime-tree, linden’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 630).

Development to Old English From **lindō* ‘linden’, Northwest Germanic final **ō* raising first gives a **lindu* ‘linden’ stage, and later high-vowel apocope yields *lind* ‘linden, lime tree’. The development is therefore straightforward and regular.

Form note The Old English noun represented here is *lind* ‘linden, lime tree’. Clark Hall also has a separate adjectival *linden* ‘made of linden-wood’, but that is not the noun counterpart for this entry (Clark Hall 1960).

louse — OE *lūs*

Derivation: **lūsz* > *lūs* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **lūsz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		[no change]	
[no change]			
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *lūs*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel’s citation form is **lūsz* ‘louse’, with the explicit nominative marker **-z* he writes across the root-noun class; his entry points to Bammesberger and Griepentrog for the morphology (Orel 2003, 252). Kroonen has no ‘louse’ entry, so his dictionary cannot be cited for this word (Kroonen 2013, 345). Kluge/Seebold carry the German cognate as the same root noun (Kluge 2011, 563). Bammesberger shows that the root-final *s* is itself secondary: the root **luw-* ‘louse’ was extended with *s* on the model of the ‘mouse’ word (Bammesberger 1990, 195). The ‘mouse’ parallel also shows why no extra sibilant is audible in

the nominative: Ringe reconstructs endingless **mūs* ‘mouse’, with the expected double sibilant of the nominative removed by degemination (Ringe 2017, 149).

The derivational input **lūs* ‘louse’ follows Orel’s morphologically explicit convention. The final **-z* is an inflectional marker made visible in the citation form, not a claim that a phonetic cluster [sz] was ever pronounced; the notation records the morphology whose elimination the derivation models.

Old English evidence Old English *lūs* ‘louse’ is the endingless nominative-accusative singular of a root noun, with mutated plural *lys* ‘lice’ (Fulk 2018, 165–66). Old Norse *lús* ‘louse’ is likewise endingless, in keeping with the North Germanic redistribution that drops the reflex of **-z* in feminine root nouns (Fulk 2018, 167). No West Germanic daughter shows any ending in this class (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118).

Development to Old English The root-noun nominative marker was eliminated before Proto-West Germanic (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 118). From the derivational input **lūs* ‘louse’ the loss of the marker gives **lūs* ‘louse’, which is already the attested Old English form. Because the root itself ends in *s*, the marker’s elimination here is best read together with the degemination that Ringe describes for ‘mouse’: at no stage does the reconstruction require an audible *-sz* sequence. This early morphological development is distinct from the later West Germanic loss of final **-z* in unstressed syllables and from the northern monosyllabic loss with compensatory lengthening; the root-noun ending was gone before either applied, and the root-final *s* of *lūs* ‘louse’ was never eligible for either change.

milk — OE *meoloc*

Derivation: **mélukz* > *meoloc* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **mélukz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Back Mutation	<i>*méoluk</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*méluk</i>	OE Med Unstressed U Lowering	<i>*méolok</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *meoloc*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen and Orel reconstruct the noun with stem notation **meluk-* and nominative **melukz* ‘milk’, and the nominative-style input used here is **mélukz* ‘milk’ (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003, 306).

Old English evidence Old English preserves a mixed dossier for this noun. Ringe and Taylor describe West Saxon *meolc* ‘milk’ < *meoluc* ‘milk’ < **mélukz* ‘milk’, Campbell likewise discusses *meoluc* ‘milk’ and *meoloc* ‘milk’, and Anglian shows *milc* ‘milk’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Campbell 1959).

Development to Old English The unsyncopated line from **mélukz* ‘milk’ loses final **z*, lowers unstressed *u* to *o*, and with back mutation yields *meoloc* ‘milk’. That fuller unsyncopated outcome is the form represented here (Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Form comparison Syncopated *meolc* and Anglian *milc* belong to the competing leveled tradition associated with oblique forms, whereas *meoloc* / *meoluc* preserves the fuller nominal shape (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

mother — OE *mōder*

Derivation: **mōdēr* > *mōder* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **mōdēr*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*mōder</i>
[no change]		
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Old English form: *mōder*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen and Orel cite the Proto-Germanic r-stem kinship noun as **mōder-* with citation **mōdēr* ‘mother’ (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003).

Old English evidence The transmitted Old English headword tradition is *mōdor* ‘mother’ / *modor* ‘mother’, with oblique *mēder* ‘mother’ in the paradigm. Clark Hall, Campbell, and Ringe and Taylor all preserve that contrast (Clark Hall 1960; Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Development to Old English From **mōdēr* ‘mother’, the regular suffixal development yields *mōder* ‘mother’. That regular nominative reflex is the form represented here, while the more familiar citation form *mōdor* ‘mother’ reflects later levelling within the r-stem paradigm (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Form comparison The note therefore concerns inherited vocalism rather than a different lexeme: *mōder* ‘mother’ is the regularized nominative represented here, but dictionaries usually print *mōdor* / *modor* ‘mother’, and the oblique evidence survives in *mēder* ‘mother’ (Clark Hall 1960; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

net — OE *nett*

Derivation: **nátjq* > *nett* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **nátjq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	EAF Brightening	<i>*nættjq</i> <i>*nættj</i> <i>*nettj</i> <i>*nett</i>
PWGmc J Gemination	<i>*nátjq</i> OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	
Early Anglo-Frisian	OE I Umlaut	
[no change]	OE J Loss After Heavy	

Old English form: *nett*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel gives **natjan* ‘net’ with Old English *nett* ‘net’, and Fulk’s account of West Germanic gemination before *j* explains the geminate outcome after a short vowel (Orel 2003; Fulk 2018).

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller record *nett* ‘net’ as the noun, and Campbell notes that final geminates are often graphically simplified in Old English spelling (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 29; Campbell 1959).

Development to Old English From **nátjq* ‘net’, West Germanic j-gemination first gives **nátjtq* ‘net’. Later brightening, loss of the weak ending, and loss of final *j* after a heavy stem yield *nett* ‘net’, so the development represented here is regular (Fulk 2018).

Form note Spellings in *net* can therefore be graphic simplifications, but the lexical target supported by the dictionary evidence is *nett* ‘net’ (Campbell 1959; Orel 2003).

nightmare — OE *mare*

Derivation: **márōn* > *mare* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **márōn*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAf Brightening	<i>*mæ̆r̥ō</i>
PNWGmc N Stem N Loss	<i>*már̥ō</i>	OE A Restoration	<i>*mar̥ō</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*mar̆ō</i>
[no change]		OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*mare</i>

Old English form: *mare*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor treat the lexeme as Proto-Germanic / Proto-Northwest-Germanic **marōn-*, with Old English *mare*, *maran*, and variant *mere*; Orel preserves the same comparative lemma though with a different Old English headword tradition (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Orel 2003).

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *mare* ‘nightmare, monster’ and also preserves related variant forms *mera* / *mere* (Clark Hall 1960, 213).

Development to Old English The selected simplex input **márōn* ‘nightmare’ regularly gives *mare* ‘nightmare’ after brightening, A-restoration before the n-stem ending, and later reduction of the final vowel. The word represented here is the attested simplex noun, not an attested compound (Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Form note The concept corresponds to an unattested compound **nihtmare* ‘nightmare’, but the Old English lexical evidence is for simplex *mare* ‘nightmare’, with oblique *maran* and variant *mere* / *mera* (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Clark Hall 1960, 213).

coat — OE *rocc*

Derivation: **rúkkaz* > *rocc* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **rúkkaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*rókk</i>
PNWGmc U Lowering	<i>*rókkaz</i>		
EAf Final Z Deletion	<i>*rókka</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *rocc*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel cites a masculine **rukka-* ‘coat’ for the garment word, while Kroonen gives **hrukka-*. Both treat this as the garment lexeme and not as the separate stone word (Orel 2003; Kroonen 2013, 290).

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller record *rocc* ‘coat’ as an over-garment or tunic and preserve compounds such as *bisceoprocc* and *breóstrocc* ‘breast-coat’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898).

Development to Old English With **rúkkaz* ‘coat’ as the derivational input, Northwest Germanic u-lowering and later loss of final *-a* yield *rocc* as a regular outcome.

Source note This entry concerns the garment noun only. The stone word seen in *stānrocc* ‘stone-coat’ belongs to a different lexical history (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898).

sheep — OE *scēap*

Derivation: **skēpq* > *scēap* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **skēpq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*skāp</i>
PNW Gmc Long E Lowering	<i>*skāpq</i>	OE Sk Palatalization	<i>*fāp</i>
EAF Long A Fronting	<i>*skēpq</i>	OE Ws Palatal Diphthongization	<i>*fēap</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *scēap*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor cite a later West Germanic **skap* ‘sheep’ > WS *scēap* ‘sheep’, while Orel preserves a Proto-Germanic noun of the **skēp-* type for the same lexeme (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Orel 2003).

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *scēap* ‘sheep’ with spelling variation, and Campbell likewise lists West Saxon *scēap* ‘sheep’ among the palatal-diphthongized forms (Clark Hall 1960; Campbell 1959).

Development to Old English From **skēpq* ‘sheep’, Northwest Germanic lowering gives **skāpq* ‘sheep’; after apocope and palatalization the West Saxon branch diphthongizes to *scēap* ‘sheep’. The development represented here is therefore fully regular.

Dialect note Ringe and Taylor contrast West Saxon *scēap* ‘sheep’ with Mercian and Kentish *scēp* ‘sheep’, and Campbell also notes Northumbrian *scip* ‘sheep’. The form represented here is the West Saxon headword (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Campbell 1959).

shilling — OE *scilling*

Derivation: **skillingaz* > *scilling* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **skillingaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*skilling</i>
	OE Sk Palatalization	<i>*filling</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	OE Med Unstressed I Lowering ¹	<i>*filleng</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	OE Med Unstressed I Lowering	<i>*filling</i>
[no change]		

Old English form: *scilling*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen treats the cognate set under **skellinga-* ~ **skillinga-* and connects it with **skeld-linga-*, while Orel likewise gives the coin word with OE *scilling* ‘shilling’ among the reflexes (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003). The derivational input **skillingaz* ‘shilling’ is the nominative-style form used here to represent that inherited **-ing-* derivative.

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *scilling* ‘shilling’, and Campbell cites it among nouns with unstressed *i* in derivational *-ing* (Clark Hall 1960; Campbell 1959). The target is the ordinary OE citation form, normalized as *scilling* ‘shilling’.

Development to Old English From **skillingaz* ‘shilling’, loss of final *-az* yields **skilling* ‘shilling’. Old English palatalization of initial *sk* before front vocalism then gives *scilling* ‘shilling’. The *i* of derivational *-ing-* remains, so the regular outcome is *scilling* ‘shilling’, not **scilleng* ‘shilling’ (Campbell 1959; Hogg 1992a).

Form note Kroonen’s **skellinga-* ~ **skillinga-* and his internal analysis **skeld-linga-* belong to the etymological background of the cognate set. The derivational input **skillingaz* ‘shilling’ is the specific form used for the derivation represented here (Kroonen 2013).

show — OE *scēawian*

Derivation: **skáwōjaną* > *scēawian* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **skáwōjaną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Aw Long Diphthong	<i>*skéawōjaną</i>
	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*skéawōjan</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*skéawōjan</i>
	OE Sk Palatalization	<i>*fēawōjan</i>
[no change]	OE I Umlaut	<i>*fēawējan</i>
	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*fēawejan</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*fēawejan</i>
	OE Intervocalic J Vocalization	<i>*fēaweian</i>
	OE Unstressed EI Contraction	<i>*fēawian</i>

Old English form: *scēawian*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel and Kroonen cite a Class II verb of the type **skawōjan-*, with OE *scēawian* ‘show’ among the reflexes (Orel 2003; Kroonen 2013, 482). Brunner likewise records the Old English family as *scēawian* ‘show’, *scāwian* ‘show’, confirming that it belongs to the ordinary show-verb set rather than to a special finite-cell formation (Brunner 1965).

Old English evidence Bright lists *scēawian* ‘show’ (W. II.) and also the related form *scēawa* ‘show’ (Bright 1971). The sources therefore use *scēawian* ‘show’, while *scēawian* ‘show’ supplies a normalized spelling.

Development to Old English From **skáwōjanq* ‘show’, the inherited *aw* sequence before a following vowel develops into the *ēaw* diphthong, and **ō* survives between **w* and **j* in the Class II suffix. The development therefore runs regularly to *scēawian* ‘show’, without the direct *aw+j* problem seen in other verb types (Campbell 1959; Orel 2003).

Form note The difference between *scēawian* ‘show’ and *scēawian* ‘show’ is orthographic normalization of initial <sc>, not a difference of lexeme or paradigm cell (Campbell 1959; Hogg 1992a).

sleep — OE *slāpan*

Derivation: **slēpanq* > *slāpan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **slēpanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*slāpan</i>
PNWGmc Long E Lowering	<i>*slāpanq</i>	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*slāpan</i>
EAF Long A Fronting	<i>*slāpanq</i>	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*slāpan</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *slāpan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen preserves the comparative verb as **slēpan-*, and Fulk cites the same family under root **slēb-* (Kroonen 2013; Fulk 2018, 120). The derivational input **slēpanq* ‘sleep’ is the infinitive-style form used here for that inherited sleep-verb.

Old English evidence Clark Hall gives *slāpan* ‘sleep’ with preterite *slēp* ‘slept’, *slēap* ‘slept’, and Bright likewise lists *slāpan* ‘sleep’ (*slāpan* ‘sleep’), *slēp* ‘slept’, *slēpon* ‘slept’, *slēpen* ‘slept’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bright 1971, 435). The target represented here is therefore the normalized infinitive *slāpan* ‘sleep’, not the preterite forms and not the separate noun *slēp* ‘sleep’.

Development to Old English From **slēpanq* ‘sleep’, Northwest Germanic lowering gives **slāpanq* ‘sleep’. The later OE tail developments then yield *slāpan* ‘sleep’ regularly. Brunner and Bülbring show that the OE tradition also has variant spellings such as West Saxon *slāpan* ‘sleep’ / *slāpan* ‘sleep’ and Anglian or Kentish *slēpan* ‘sleep’, but those do not displace the infinitive chosen here (Brunner 1965; Bülbring 1902).

Form note The note concerns lemma type rather than a special derivational problem: this row represents the verb *slāpan* ‘sleep’, whereas *slēp* ‘sleep’ belongs to noun or lookup background and *slēp* ‘slept’ / *slēap* ‘slept’ are preterite forms (Clark Hall 1960; Bright 1971, 435).

smear — OE *smierwan*

Derivation: **smérwijanq* > *smierwan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **smérwijanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Breaking	*sméorwijaŋ
	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	*sméorwijan
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization	*sméorwijaŋ
	Sievers Law Syncope	*sméorwjaŋ
	OE I Umlaut	*smierwjaŋ
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	*smierwjan
	OE J Loss After Heavy	*smierwan

Old English form: *smierwan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen gives the comparative headword as **smerwjan-* (Kroonen 2013). Ringe and Taylor instead cite a later-stage **smirwijaŋa* ‘smear’, from which they derive West Saxon *smierwan* ‘smear’, Mercian *smirwan* ‘smear’, and Northumbrian *smiriga* (Ringe and Taylor 2014). The derivational input **smérwijaŋa* ‘smear’ therefore represents the Kroonen-aligned PGmc layer, while the later-stage dialect split belongs to a different chronological level.

Old English evidence The target represented here is the West Saxon citation form *smierwan* ‘smear’. Campbell’s Anglian discussion explains the contrasting *smirwan* ‘smear’, and Clark Hall, Brunner, and Bright show that the same lexical family later also includes forms such as *smirian*, *smyrian*, and preterite *smyrode* (Campbell 1959; Clark Hall 1960; Brunner 1965; Bright 1971).

Development to Old English From **smérwijaŋa* ‘smear’, breaking before *r* + consonant yields *eo*, and later i-umlaut produces *ie*. The result is West Saxon *smierwan* ‘smear’. Anglian *smirwan* ‘smear’ reflects the well-known failure of breaking in this environment, not a different lexeme (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Dialect note The entry therefore represents the West Saxon member of a broader OE family: *smierwan* ‘smear’ in West Saxon, *smirwan* ‘smear’ in Anglian or Mercian, and related later class-II forms such as *smirian* or *smyrian* in the same lexical field (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Clark Hall 1960).

span — OE *spannan*

Derivation: **spánnanq* > *spannan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **spánnanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	*spánnan
	OE Secondary Nasalization	*spánnan̥
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Weak Tail Reduction	*spánnan

Old English form: *spannan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the inherited verb as **spannan-*, with OE *spannan* ‘span, fasten’ among the reflexes (Kroonen 2013). The derivational input **spánnanq* ‘span’ is the infinitive-style form used here for that same verbal lexeme.

Old English evidence Clark Hall lists noun *spann* and verb *spannan* ‘span, fasten’ as separate headwords, and Brunner likewise records *spannan*, *spannan stv.* (Clark Hall 1960; Brunner 1965). The target is the strong-verb infinitive, not the noun.

Development to Old English From **spánnanq* ‘span’, the final nasal ending is lost and the regular OE weak-tail steps surface *spannan* ‘span, fasten’. No paradigm-cell substitution is needed: the current derivation already lands on the infinitive directly.

Form note English *span* can also reach the noun *spann* in local lookup material. The form represented here is the verb *spannan* ‘span, fasten’, with the noun treated elsewhere (Clark Hall 1960).

spar — OE *spearra*

Derivation: **spárrô* > *spearra* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **spárrô*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening	<i>*spærrô</i>
	OE Breaking	<i>*spearrô</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*spearra</i>

Old English form: *spearra*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen and Orel place this noun in the beam or rafter set **spar(r)an-*, with cognates such as Old Saxon and Old High German *sparro* ‘spar, rafter’ (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003). The derivational input **spárrô* ‘spar’ is the OE-facing nominal form used here for that same lexeme.

Old English evidence The noun is *spearra* ‘spar, rafter’. English gloss overlap also reaches the unrelated verb *sperran* ‘to bar’, which does not belong to this row.

Development to Old English From **spárrô* ‘spar’, Anglo-Frisian brightening gives **spærrô* ‘spar’, and OE breaking before geminate *rr* yields **spearrô* ‘spar’, later *spearra* ‘spar, rafter’. The development is therefore regular for a breaking-conditioned noun of this type (Luick 1914–1940).

Form note This entry concerns the noun *spearra* ‘spar, rafter’ only. It should be kept separate from verb *sperran*, even though the Modern English glosses overlap (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003).

still — OE *stillan*

Derivation: **stéllijanq* > *stillan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **stéllijanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*stéllijan</i>
	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*stéllijan</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	Sievers Law Syncope	<i>*stélljan</i>
	OE I Umlaut	<i>*stilljan</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*stilljan</i>
	OE J Loss After Heavy	<i>*stillan</i>

Old English form: *stillan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The wider West Germanic family includes adjective *still* ‘still, quiet’ and verb *stillen* (Kluge 2011). The derivational input **stéllijanq* ‘still’ represents the verbal j-formation used for the OE row.

Old English evidence Clark Hall gives *stillan* as the verb and separately *stille* ‘still, quiet’ as the adjective (Clark Hall 1960). Bosworth-Toller likewise preserves a substantial prefixed verbal family under *ge-stillan* ‘still, stop’ and related forms (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 724). The Old English form here is the verb *stillan*, not the adjective.

Development to Old English As a heavy-stem Class I weak verb, **stéllijanq* ‘still’ undergoes the expected syncope and i-umlaut, and later loss of *j* after a heavy stem yields *stillan*. The development represented here is regular.

Form note The note concerns lexical framing rather than sound law: *stillan* is the verb represented here, while *stille* ‘still, quiet’ belongs to the related adjectival branch of the family (Clark Hall 1960; Kluge 2011).

summer — OE *sumer*

Derivation: **súmaraz* > *sumer* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **súmaraz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*súmar</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*súmara</i>	EAF Brightening	<i>*súmæc</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*súmer</i>
[no change]			

Old English form: *sumer*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen gives the lexeme as **sumara-*, and Ringe and Taylor likewise use **sumaraz* ‘summer’, while Orel preserves an alternate **sumeraz* ‘summer’ (Kroonen 2013; Ringe and Taylor 2014; Orel 2003, 425). The derivational input **súmaraz* ‘summer’ follows the **a* vocalism that underlies the regular development represented here.

Old English evidence Clark Hall gives *sumor* ‘summer’ m., gs. *summeres* ‘summer’, ds. *sumera* ‘summer’ / *sumere* ‘summer’, and Bright likewise lists *sumor* (*summer*) with genitive *summeres* ‘summer (gen.)’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bright 1971, 440). The tradition therefore preserves both *sumor* ‘summer’ and *summer* ‘summer’, with the oblique forms strongly supporting second-syllable *e*.

Development to Old English From **súmaraz* ‘summer’, loss of final *-az* is followed by fronting and merger in the unstressed second syllable, yielding *sumer* ‘summer’. The form compared here is the regularized *e*-form, while the common citation form *sumor* ‘summer’ remains part of the attested OE tradition (Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Form note The entry does not deny *sumor* ‘summer’. It represents *sumer* ‘summer’ as the regular outcome chosen here, while *sumor* ‘summer’ remains a common headword spelling and *summeres* ‘summer (gen.)’ / *sumere* ‘summer (dat.)’ show that the *e*-vocalism was also real in Old English (Clark Hall 1960; Bright 1971, 440).

sunder — OE *sundrian*

Derivation: **súndrōjanq* > *sundrian* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **súndrōjaną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*súndrōjan</i>
	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*súndrōjǫn</i>
	OE I Umlaut	<i>*súndrējǫn</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*súndreǫn</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*súndrejan</i>
	OE Intervocalic J Vocalization	<i>*súndreian</i>
	OE Unstressed EI Contraction	<i>*súndrian</i>

Old English form: *sundrian*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel distinguishes three related formations: adverbial **sunþraz* ‘asunder’ > *sundor* ‘apart, asunder’, Class I verbal **sunþrjanan* ‘sunder’ > *syndrian* ‘separate, sunder’, and Class II verbal **sunþrōjanan* ‘sunder’ > *sundrian* ‘sunder’ (Orel 2003).

Kluge-Seebold aligns the cognate set with German *sondern* ‘separate’ and OE *gesundrian* ‘separate’, so this entry belongs with the Class II verb, not the adverb (Kluge 2011).

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller list *sundrian* ‘sunder’ and *syndrian* ‘sunder’ separately from adverbial *sundor* ‘asunder’; both also record the prefixed verbal family *ā-sundrian* ‘sunder apart’ (Clark Hall 1960, 296; Bosworth and Toller 1898). The target is therefore the weak verb *sundrian* ‘sunder’.

Development to Old English From **súndrōjaną* ‘sunder’, the Class II weak-verb suffix yields regular OE *-ian*, producing *sundrian* ‘sunder’. Because this is the **-ōjan-* verb and not the Class I **-jan-* formation, the form represented here does not belong to the umlauted *syndrian* ‘separate’ branch.

Form note The earlier confusion was lexical, not phonological: *sundor* ‘apart’ is the separate adverb, and *syndrian* ‘separate’ is a related but different verb. The verb treated here is the Class II verb *sundrian* (Orel 2003; Clark Hall 1960, 296).

swallow — OE *swealwe*

Derivation: **swálwōn* > *swealwe* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **swálwōn*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic PNWGmc N Stem N Loss	EAF Brightening	<i>*swælwō</i>
	<i>*swálwō</i> OE Breaking	<i>*swealwō</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*swealwæ</i>
	OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*swealwe</i>

Old English form: *swealwe*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen gives the bird name as **swalwōn-*, and Ringe and Taylor cite the later West Germanic stage **swalwa* ‘swallow’, from which West Saxon *swealwe* ‘swallow’ and Mercian *swalwe* ‘swallow’ develop (Kroonen 2013, 535; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 200). The selected etymological comparison belongs to the swallow-bird family, not to the verb *swelgan*.

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *swealwe* (*a, o*) as the noun headword (Clark Hall 1960). Campbell and Brunner also preserve later or oblique-family forms such as *swaluwe*, *swalewan*, and *swealuwe*, but those belong to wider variation around the noun rather than to the citation form represented here (Campbell 1959; Brunner 1965).

Development to Old English From **swálwōn* ‘swallow’, brightening yields **swælw-*, and breaking before *lw* gives **swealw-*. The later noun ending develops regularly to *swealwe*. The relevant point is that the bird name has no inherited **g*: that consonant belongs to the separate verb *swelgan* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 200; Kroonen 2013, 535).

swine — OE *swīn*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **swīnq*; form followed here **swīnq* > *swīn* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **swīnq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*swīn</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]		

Old English form: *swīn*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the noun as **swina-* ‘pig’ (Kroonen 2013). The selected comparative form here is the bare neuter citation cell **swīnq* ‘swine’, which matches the singular noun aimed at in Old English rather than an oblique stem form.

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *swin* (*y*) as the ordinary noun headword (Clark Hall 1960). The target here is that singular citation form *swīn* ‘swine’, not a plural glossed in Modern English as *swine*.

Development to Old English From derivational input **swīnq* ‘swine’, loss of the final nasal vowel yields *swīn* ‘swine, pig’. The outcome is therefore the regular monosyllabic noun with preserved long root *ī*.

Source note The derivational input writes stressed long *ī* as **ī*, so comparative **swīnq* ‘swine’ and derivational **swīnq* ‘swine’ represent the same lexical form.

think — OE *þencan*

Derivation: **θánkijanq* > *þencan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **θánkijanq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*θánkijan</i>
	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*θánkijan</i>
	Sievers Law Syncope	<i>*θánkjan</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Velar Palatalization	<i>*θántʃjan</i>
	OE I Umlaut	<i>*θentʃjan</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*θentʃjan</i>
	OE J Loss After Heavy	<i>*θentʃan</i>

Old English form: *þencan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen gives the verb as **þankjan-* ‘to think’, and Ringe and Taylor cite fully inflected **þankijanȝ* ‘think’ beside OE *þencan* ‘think’ (Kroonen 2013; Ringe and Taylor 2014). The noun **þankaz* ‘think’ belongs only to the wider derivational background.

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller preserves the verb under *þencan* ‘think’ / *geþencan* ‘think’, and the citation form here is the ordinary infinitive *þencan* ‘think’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898).

Development to Old English From **θánkijanȝ* ‘think’, palatalization before **j* and i-umlaut produce *þencan* ‘think’. The infinitive is therefore a straightforward weak-verb outcome.

Lexical note Campbell’s assibilation discussion uses the same verb *þencan* ‘think’; the class-III relic *hycgan* is a different lexeme (Campbell 1959; Hogg 1992a).

thorn — OE *þorn*

Derivation: **θúrnaz* > *þorn* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **θúrnaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*θórna</i>
PNWGmc U Lowering	<i>*θórnaz</i>		
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*θórna</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *þorn*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen gives **þurna-* ‘thorn, briar’, while Orel preserves the masculine pair **þurnuz* ‘thorn’ and **þurnaz* ‘thorn’ (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003). The derivational input **θúrnaz* ‘thorn’ belongs to that same comparative family.

Old English evidence Bright lists *þorn* ‘thorn’ (m.) and Clark Hall likewise treats *þorn* ‘thorn’ as the ordinary noun headword (Bright 1971; Clark Hall 1960).

Development to Old English The inherited stem shows regular lowering of *u* to *o* before *r*, and final loss yields *þorn* ‘thorn’. The noun is therefore a regular Old English continuation of the Proto-Germanic thorn-family.

Source note The comparative sources preserve more than one stem formation, but the Old English target itself is simply the citation form *þorn* ‘thorn’.

tide — OE *tīd*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **tīdiz*; form followed here **tīdiz* > *tīd* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **tīdiz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*tīd</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*tīdi</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *tīd*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen gives **tīdi-* ‘time’, and Orel’s **tīdiz* ‘tide’ points to the same feminine noun (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003). The related verb *tīdan* ‘happen’ is separate.

Old English evidence Bright records *tīd* ‘tide’ with singular *tīde* ‘tide’ and plural *tīda* ‘tides’, and Clark Hall treats *tīd* ‘tide’ as the ordinary noun ‘time, period, season’ (Bright 1971; Clark Hall 1960, 309).

Development to Old English From **tīdiz* ‘tide’, final *z* is lost and the high final vowel drops, leaving *tīd* ‘tide’. The development is straightforward for a feminine *i*-stem.

Lexical note English *tide* can also lead to the separate weak verb *tīdan* ‘happen’; the noun is *tīd* ‘tide’.

token — OE *tācn*

Derivation: **tāiknq* > *tācn* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **tāiknq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*tākn</i>
[no change]			
Early Anglo-Frisian			
EAF Ai Monophthongization	<i>*tāknq</i>		

Old English form: *tācn*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites **taikna-* and Orel **taiknan* ‘token’ for the noun ‘sign, token’ (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003, 438). The derivational input **tāiknq* ‘token’ is the simple citation-form noun used for the derivation.

Old English evidence Campbell and Sievers-Brunner preserve both unbroken *tācn* ‘token’ and broken *tācen* ‘token’, with oblique *tācnes* ‘token’ remaining unbroken (Campbell 1959; Brunner 1965).

Development to Old English Monophthongization of *ai* yields *ā*, and loss of the final nasal vowel leaves *tācn* ‘token’. The unbroken form is therefore a regular Old English outcome.

Form note *tācn* ‘token’ is the attested unbroken citation form selected here. Later West Saxon prose often prefers *tācen* ‘token’, but that does not displace the older unbroken form (Campbell 1959; Brunner 1965).

town — OE *tūn*

Derivation: **tūnq* > *tūn* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **tūnq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*tūn</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]		

Old English form: *tūn*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites **tūna-* ‘fenced area’, while Orel gives **tūnan* ‘town’ and **tūnaz* ‘town’ (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003, 452). The derivational input **tūnq* ‘town’ is the simple citation-form noun used in the derivation.

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *tūn* ‘town’ as the ordinary headword ‘enclosure, yard, village, town’ (Clark Hall 1960).

Development to Old English The inherited long *ū* is preserved, and loss of the final nasal vowel yields *tūn* ‘town’ regularly (Brunner 1965).

Source note The comparative headwords vary, but the Old English target here is the direct citation form *tūn* ‘town’, not an oblique **tūnǣn* ‘town’.

wade — OE *wadan*

Derivation: **wádanq* > *wadan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wádanq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening	<i>*wædanq</i>
	OE A Restoration	<i>*wadanq</i>
	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*wadan</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*wadǣn</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*wadan</i>

Old English form: *wadan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Campbell and Ringe and Taylor describe A-restoration before a following back vowel, and Luick explicitly includes *wadan* ‘wade, go through’ among the standard open-syllable examples (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014; Luick 1914–1940, 239).

Old English evidence Clark Hall gives *wadan* ‘wade, go through’ as the verb ‘to go, move, stride, advance’, and Bright lists the same infinitive in the strong-verb paradigm (Clark Hall 1960; Bright 1971).

Development to Old English From **wádanq* ‘wade’, Anglo-Frisian brightening first gives **wædanq* ‘wade’. A-restoration before the back-vocalic infinitive ending then returns *a*, and later reduction yields *wadan* ‘wade, go through’ (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Development note The infinitive belongs to the A-restoration class. The citation form is therefore *wadan* ‘wade’, not a fronted *wæden* ‘waded’-type output.

warp — OE *weorpan*

Derivation: **wérpanq* > *weorpan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wérpanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Breaking	* <i>wéorpanq</i>
	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	* <i>wéorpan</i>
	OE Secondary Nasalization	* <i>wéorpan</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Weak Tail Reduction	* <i>wéorpan</i>

Old English form: *weorpan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor distinguish preterite **warp* ‘warp’ from infinitive **werpana* ‘warp’, and the derivational input here is the verbal form **wérpanq* ‘warp’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *weorpan* as the strong verb headword and separately lists *wearp* as both noun and preterite. Bright gives the paradigm *weorpan*, *wearp*, *wurpon*, *worpen* (Clark Hall 1960; Bright 1971).

Development to Old English Breaking before *r* + *C* yields *weor-*, and the infinitive develops regularly to *weorpan* (Campbell 1959; Hogg 1992a).

Lexical note English *warp* also points to related *wearp* material. The target is the infinitive *weorpan*.

wash — OE *wascan*

Derivation: **wáskanq* > *wascan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wáskanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening	* <i>wæskanq</i>
	OE A Restoration	* <i>waskanq</i>
	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	* <i>waskan</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization	* <i>waskqn</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	* <i>waskan</i>

Old English form: *wascan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites **waskan-*, Orel **waskan* ‘wash’, and Ringe and Taylor likewise derive Old English *wascan* from the same verb family (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003, 489; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 142).

Old English evidence Clark Hall heads the verb as *wascan* ‘wash’, while Sievers-Brunner also notes the variant *wæscan* ‘wash’ (Clark Hall 1960; Brunner 1965).

Development to Old English From **wáskanq* ‘wash’, brightening gives **wæskanq* ‘wash’. A-restoration before the sC cluster restores *a*, and medial *sc* remains unpalatalized before the following back vowel, yielding *wascan* (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 142).

Form note The conservative citation form *wascan* ‘wash’ is selected here. Spellings such as *wæscan* ‘wash’ or *wascan* ‘wash’ belong to variant or normalized background rather than to the target of this entry.

wax — OE *weaxan*

Derivation: **wáxsanq* > *weaxan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wáxsanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening	<i>*wæxsanq</i>
	OE Breaking	<i>*weaxsanq</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*weaxsan</i>
	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*weaxsqn</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*weaxsan</i>
	OE Xs Merge	<i>*weaXSan</i>

Old English form: *weaxan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the verb as **wahs(j)an-*, Orel as **waxsanān* ‘wax’, and Ringe and Taylor discuss the prehistory of Old English *weaxan* within the same verbal family (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003, 478; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Old English evidence Clark Hall gives *weaxan* ‘wax’ as the verb headword and separately records bare *wax* ‘wax’ as a preterite form; Bright likewise treats *weaxan* ‘wax’ as the infinitive (Clark Hall 1960; Bright 1971).

Development to Old English From **wáxsanq* ‘wax’, brightening and breaking yield *weax-*, and the infinitive develops regularly to *weaxan*. The cluster is preserved here, since *xs* > *s* belongs to forms where another consonant follows, such as *wæstm* ‘growth’, not to the infinitive itself (Campbell 1959; Brunner 1965).

Lexical note The target here is the infinitive *weaxan* ‘wax’. Noun *weax* ‘wax’ and preterite *wax* / *wēox* ‘waxed’ belong to different lexical or paradigm slots.

way — OE *weg*

Derivation: **wégaz* > *weg* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wégaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*wég</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*wéga</i>	OE Velar Palatalization	<i>*wédʒ</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *weg*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the noun as **wega-* ‘way, road’, while the selected derivational form here is nominative-singular **wégaz* ‘way’ (Kroonen 2013). Campbell, Hogg, and Ringe and Taylor use the same word as the standard contrast between singular palatal *weg* ‘way’ and inflected *wegas* / *wegum* (Campbell 1959; Hogg 1992a; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 341).

Old English evidence The Old English singular is the ordinary noun *weg* ‘way’, here normalized as *weg* ‘way’ to show the palatal final. The contrasting plural and oblique forms *wegas* ‘ways’, *wegum* ‘ways’ keep a velar stop before the following back vowel (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 341).

Development to Old English From **wégaz* ‘way’, final **z* is lost and the weak tail apocopates, leaving word-final **g* after a front vowel. In that environment Old English palatalization yields *weg* ‘way’, whereas *wegas* ‘ways’ remains velar because the following *a* blocks the same outcome (Campbell 1959; Hogg 1992a; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 341).

Form note Normalized *weg* ‘way’ and dictionary *weg* ‘way’ represent the same noun. No Old English form *wē* ‘we’ is supported by the evidence for ‘way’.

weapon — OE *wāpn*

Derivation: **wēpną* > *wāpn* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wēpną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*wāpn</i>
PNWGmc Long E Lowering	<i>*wāpną</i>		
EAF Long A Fronting	<i>*wāpną</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *wāpn*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs a double-stem noun **wēbna-* ~ **wēpna-* and cites OE *wāpn* ‘weapon’ among its reflexes (Kroonen 2013, 617). The derivational input **wēpną* ‘weapon’ represents the unbroken citation-form noun rather than the later broken simplex.

Old English evidence Campbell’s cluster-noun discussion preserves unbroken *wēpn* ‘weapon’ beside broken *wēpen* ‘weapon’-type forms (Campbell 1959, 150; 1959, 226–27). Bright contrasts broken nominative *wāpen* ‘weapon’ / *wapen* ‘weapon’ with unbroken oblique *wāpnes* ‘weapon’, while Clark Hall lemmatizes the noun under *wapen* ‘weapon’ and also preserves unbroken forms in compounds and related spellings (Bright 1971, 29; Clark Hall 1960, 355).

Development to Old English Northwest Germanic lowering gives *wāpn* ‘weapon’, and loss of the final nasal vowel leaves the unbroken cluster word-finally. The Old English form here is the attested unbroken form *wāpn* ‘weapon’.

Form note The ordinary late West Saxon simplex headword is *wāpen* ‘weapon’, but Campbell’s noun-class discussion also preserves unbroken *wēpn* ‘weapon’ beside broken *wēpen* ‘weapon’-type forms (Campbell 1959, 150; 1959, 226–27). *wāpnes* ‘weapon’ remains the regular unbroken oblique comparator (Bright 1971, 29; Clark Hall 1960, 355).

will — OE *willa*

Derivation: **wéljô* > *willa* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wéljô*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	OE I Umlaut		* <i>willjô</i>
PWGmc J Gemination	* <i>wélljô</i>	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	* <i>willja</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	OE J Loss After Heavy		* <i>willa</i>
[no change]			

Old English form: *willa*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen separates noun **weljan* ‘will, wish’ from verb **weljan* ‘to want’, while Orel and Kluge represent the noun as **weljôn* ‘will’ (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003; Kluge 2011). The selected derivational form **wéljô* ‘will’ is the noun-side input used for this row.

Old English evidence Clark Hall lemmatizes noun *willa* *m.* separately from verb *willan* ‘will, want’ (Clark Hall 1960, 368). The Old English form here is the noun citation form, not the related verb.

Development to Old English From **wéljô* ‘will’, j-gemination yields a heavy stem, i-umlaut gives *will-*, and later shortening plus j-loss produce *willa* ‘will, desire’. The noun is therefore a regular weak masculine outcome.

Lexical note The target here is the noun *willa* ‘will, wish’. Related verb *willan* ‘will, want’ belongs to a separate lexeme and should not be substituted for the noun row (Kroonen 2013; Clark Hall 1960, 368).

wind — OE *windan*

Derivation: **wíndanq* > *windan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wíndanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope		* <i>wíndan</i>
[no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization		* <i>wíndqn</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	OE Weak Tail Reduction		* <i>wíndan</i>
[no change]			

Old English form: *windan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen distinguishes noun **winda-* from verb **windan-*, and the present row belongs to the verb (Kroonen 2013). Fulk and Ringe and Taylor derive the dental directly from PIE **wendh-*, not from a Verner alternant (Fulk 2018; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller record *windan* ‘wind, coil’ as the verb headword (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 101). The Old English form here is the ordinary infinitive of the strong verb.

Development to Old English The derivational input **wíndanq* ‘wind’ yields the regular infinitive *wíndan* by ordinary heavy-syllable apocope and weak-tail reduction. The form is therefore a straightforward strong-verb outcome.

Lexical note English *wind* also names the noun. This row represents the class-III verb, not the noun (Kroonen 2013; Clark Hall 1960).

wold — OE *weald*

Derivation: **wálθuz* > *weald* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wálθuz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	<i>*wældu</i>
EAF Th Voicing	<i>*wálduz</i>	OE Breaking	<i>*wealdu</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*wáldu</i>	OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*weald</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *weald*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the noun as **walþu-* and gives OE *weald* ‘forest, woodland’ beside other West Germanic *wald* ‘forest’ forms (Kroonen 2013). The derivational input **wálθuz* ‘wold’ is the nominative singular used for the derivation.

Old English evidence Clark Hall makes *weald* ‘forest, woodland’ the main noun headword and cross-refers *wald* ‘forest’ and *wold* ‘plain, open country’ to it (Clark Hall 1960). Clark Hall glosses *wald* as (*N,VPs*) — Northumbrian and Vespasian Psalter (Mercian) — making this an explicitly dialect-labelled Anglian form.

Development to Old English **lp* voices to *ld*, Anglo-Frisian brightening yields *wæld-*, and breaking before the cluster gives *weald-*; apocope then yields *weald* ‘forest, woodland’. The noun is therefore a regular breaking outcome.

Dialect note *wald* ‘forest’ survives as an Anglian variant in the same family (Clark Hall *wald* (*N,VPs*): Northumbrian and Vespasian Psalter). The Old English form here is normalized *weald* ‘forest, woodland’, not the variant form (Clark Hall 1960; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

yarn — OE *ġearn*

Derivation: **gárnaq* > *ġearn* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **gárnaq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	<i>*gærnaq</i>
[no change]		OE Breaking	<i>*ġearnq</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*ġearn</i>
[no change]		OE Velar Palatalization	<i>*ġearn</i>

Old English form: *ġearn*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the noun as **garna-*, and Ringe and Taylor give the early chain **garna* ‘yarn’ > **geern* ‘yarn’ > **gearn* ‘yarn’ > OE *gearn* ‘yarn’ (Kroonen 2013; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 220). The derivational input **gárnaq* ‘yarn’ is the nominal citation form used here, while oblique **garnǎn* ‘yarn’ belongs only to comparative background.

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *gearn* (*e*) *n.* ‘yarn, spun wool’, and Bosworth-Toller glosses *gearn* ‘yarn’ with Latin *filatum* ‘spun thread’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898).

Development to Old English From **gárnaq* ‘yarn’, brightening and breaking before *rn* yield *gearn* ‘yarn’; palatalization of initial *g* before the resulting front-vocalic sequence gives normalized *ġearn* ‘yarn’. The derivation is regular.

Form note Dictionary *gearn* ‘yarn’ and normalized *ġearn* ‘yarn’ refer to the same noun. The comparative stem **garna-* and oblique **garnǎn* ‘yarn’ do not replace the derivational input **gárnaq* ‘yarn’.

who — OE *hwā*

Derivation: **xwáz* > *hwā* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xwáz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic		[no change]
Monosyllabic Final Z Loss	<i>*xwā</i>	
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Old English form: *hwā*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The derivational input is the nominative singular masculine of the interrogative pronoun, PGmc **xwáz* ‘who’ (traditionally **hwaz*; Gothic *hwas* ‘who’). Ringe and Taylor cite exactly this form among the witnesses for the northern West Germanic loss of word-final **-z* in stressed monosyllables: “**hwaz* ‘who’ > OE *hwā*” (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 86). The nominative is the natural citation cell of the interrogative and the direct ancestor of the Old English headword form, so no paradigm-cell retargeting is involved.

Old English evidence West Saxon *hwā* ‘who’ is the standard headword form (Campbell 1959, sect. 125, p. 49). The vowel is decisive for the derivation: Campbell states that the back vowel of *hwā* never underwent Anglo-Frisian brightening — “**hwæ* does not exist” — and Sievers-Brunner records the same restriction (Campbell 1959, sect. 125, p. 49; Brunner 1965, sect. 137 Anm. 1, p. 129).

Development to Old English The derivation is two historical steps. First, the later northern West Germanic loss of word-final **-z* in stressed monosyllables removed the sibilant with compensatory lengthening of the short nucleus: **xwáz* ‘who’ > **hwā* ‘who’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 86). Old High German instead rhotacized the sibilant (cf. OHG *wer* ‘who’ type inflection), which is why this loss counts among the diagnostic Ingvaemonic features (Fulk 2018, 18). Second, the resulting long back **ā* stayed back: Anglo-Frisian brightening of long final **ā* requires a preceding nucleus in the word, and in this monosyllable there is none, so the form surfaces directly as OE *hwā* (Campbell 1959, sect. 125, p. 49).

An alternative account derives the endingless pronoun from a generalized unaccented sentence variant **hwa* with later lengthening (Campbell 1959, 166; Brunner 1965, sect. 182, p. 160). Ringe and Taylor reject the unaccented-variant analysis for this witness set because *mā* ‘more’ and *cū*

‘cow’ are not plausibly unaccented words (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 86). The project follows Ringe and Taylor; the alternative is recorded, not adopted.

Why this row is in the corpus This row makes SC097, the monosyllabic final -z loss, *corpus-witnessed: before its addition the change was validated only by synthetic controls. It also witnesses the ordering SC097 before SC003 rhotacism — a rhotacized [†]hwar could never yield hwā** — and exercises the narrowed long-final clause of Anglo-Frisian brightening. See docs/sound_changes/audits/corpus-maturation-01-candidate-adjudication.md §1.

you — OE ēow

Derivation: *ízwiz > ēow (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: *ízwiz

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Ew Long Diphthong	*ēoww
PWGmc Coronal W Assimilation	*íwwiz	OE WW Simplification	*ēow
EAF Final Z Deletion	*íwwi		
PWGmc Unstressed Word Final I Apocope	*íww		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: ēow

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The derivational input is the dative(-accusative) plural of the second-person plural pronoun, PGmc *ízwiz ‘you (dat. pl.)’ (Gothic izwis ‘you’). Ringe and Taylor print the development in full: “PGmc *ízwiz ‘you (dat. pl.)’ (Goth. izwis) > *iwwi > PWGmc *iuwi ~ *iuw (see 3.1.4) > OE iow, OF iū, OS, OHG iu” (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42), following Stiles’s demonstration of the coronal-w assimilation (Stiles 1985, 89–94). Fulk corroborates the *-zw- > *-ww- assimilation (Fulk 2018, sect. 8.3, pp. 204–205). The oblique plural is the cell that survives as the Old English pronoun ēow; the modern English word continues this oblique form.

Old English evidence West Saxon ēow ‘you’ beside early West Saxon and Northumbrian iow ‘you’ shows the normal West Saxon treatment of the diphthong (Campbell 1959, sect. 702, p. 283). The corpus targets the West Saxon citation form.

Development to Old English Four historical steps carry the form. (1) Coronal-w assimilation: *ízwiz ‘you’ > *íwwiz ‘you’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42; Stiles 1985, 89–94). (2) Proto-West Germanic loss of word-final *-z in unstressed syllables: > *íwwi ‘you’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 44–45). (3) Early apocope in unstressed words: > *íww ‘you’, the apocopated member of Ringe and Taylor’s PWGmc doublet *iuwi ~ *iuw; the absence of i-umlaut in the Old English reflex is Ringe and Taylor’s own proof that the trigger vowel fell before umlaut (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 57–58). (4) Vocalization of the geminate *ww to the long diphthong, dated by Ringe and Taylor to Proto-West Germanic itself (*fewwar > *feuwar), followed by geminate simplification: > OE ēow ‘you’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 41–42; Fulk 2018, sect. 8.3, pp. 204–205).

Why this row is in the corpus This row is a chronology witness of unusual power for basic vocabulary. It forces coronal-w assimilation (SC008) to precede rhotacism (SC003): had rhotacism applied first, *ízwiz would have become [†]irwiz, from which ēow is undervivable. It is the corpus witness for SC098, the early apocope in unstressed words, and for its bleeding of i-umlaut (SC055), and it fixes the order of geminate-w vocalization (SC033)

before degemination (SC031). See docs/sound_changes/audits/corpus-maturation-01-candidate-adjudication.md §2 and docs/sound_changes/audits/sc098-dossier-unstressed-word-final-i-apocope.md.

thought — OE *þōhte*

Derivation: **θánxtē* > *þōhte* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **θánxtē*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	* <i>θōxte</i>
EAF Nasalized Low Rounding	* <i>θōxtē</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *þōhte*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The derivational input is the class I weak preterite third singular of the verb ‘think’, PGmc **θánxtē* ‘thought’ (traditionally **panhtē*). Ringe gives the principal parts in full as **pankijana*, **panhtē*, **panhtaz*, with the comparative set Gothic *þagkjan* ‘think’, *þāhta* ‘thought’, ON *þekkja* ‘think’, *þátti* ‘thought’, OE *þencan*, *þōhte*, *þōht*, OHG *denken* ‘think’, *dāhta* ‘thought’ (Ringe 2017, 281). The preterite stem is reconstructed a second time, independently of the paradigm list, among the past participles that show pre-*t devoicing: post-PIE **tong-* gives PGmc **pank-* in **pankijana* beside **panhtaz* ‘thought’ (Ringe 2017, 136). In both passages the Proto-Germanic form carries the nasal before the dorsal fricative. The nasal is therefore present in the derivational input and its loss is derived by the cascade instead of being built into the reconstruction.

The corpus already holds the present stem of the same verb as *think*, PGmc **θánkijana* ‘think’. The preterite is entered as a separate row because the two stems have entirely different vowel histories, and only the preterite passes through the nasal-loss complex.

Old English evidence West Saxon *þōhte* ‘thought’ is the standard preterite singular of *þencan* (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898). Fulk names this exact form as the Anglo-Frisian witness for the rounding of the lengthened nasalized low vowel: the lengthened vowels “may have remained nasalized for a considerable time, well past the close of the NWGmc. period, since **ā* produced this way developed to *ō* in Anglo-Frisian (as in OE pret. sg. *þōhte*, OFris. *thochte* ‘thought’) and did not fall together with OE *ā* < ai or OFris. *ā* < ai, au” (Fulk 2018, sect. 4.1, p. 55). The Old Frisian counterpart *thochte* ‘thought’ confirms that the development is Anglo-Frisian and not an English innovation.

Development to Old English The derivation has two firing stages and no others. Loss of the nasal before the dorsal fricative nasalizes and lengthens the preceding vowel, so **θánxtē* becomes **θāxtē*; the Anglo-Frisian rounding of the nasalized low vowel then gives **θōxtē*, which surfaces as *þōhte* with the fricative written *h* (Ringe 2017, 281; Fulk 2018, sect. 4.1, p. 55).

Three non-firings matter as much as the firings. The Ingvaeonic nasal-spirant law does not apply, correctly, because the dorsal fricative is not one of the **f*, **þ*, **s* spirants that law governs. Preconsonantal loss of the dorsal fricative does not apply either, so the fricative survives to the surface; this is what makes the preterite a cleaner diagnostic than *fist* (Ringe 2017, 281). Finally the rounding does not touch ordinary long low vowels of other origin, as *stone* and *home* show.

Why this row is in the corpus The nasal-loss rule has a high-vowel branch and a low-vowel branch. Before this row only the high-vowel branch had a corpus witness, in *fist* **fúnxstiz*, whose input vowel is **u* and which never reaches the rounding rule at all. The low-vowel

pathway *aNx > *āx > *ōx rested on the handbooks alone. This row supplies an attested instance of it, and with it the feeding relation between the nasal loss and the rounding, which was thereby promoted from stage entailment to an independently demonstrated ordering. See docs/sound_changes/audits/sc025-sc104-nasalized-low-vowel-adjudication.md §12.

hue — OE *hīew*

Derivation: **xéwjā* > *hīew* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xéwjā*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Ew Long Diphthong	* <i>xēowwja</i>
PWGmc J Gemination	* <i>xéwwja</i> OE WW Simplification	* <i>xēowja</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	OE Velar Fricative Palatalization	* <i>çēowja</i>
	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	* <i>çēowj</i>
[no change]	OE I Umlaut	* <i>çīewj</i>
	OE J Loss After Heavy	* <i>çīew</i>

Old English form: *hīew*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The derivational input is the Proto-Germanic neuter *ja*-stem noun ‘visible layer, appearance’. Kroonen reconstructs **heuja-* on the comparative set Gothic *hiwi* ‘surface appearance, complexion’, ON *hý* ‘down on plants’, Nw. *hy*, both of the down on plants, OE *hīw*, *hēow* ‘shape, form, hue, colour’, ME *hue*, and traces it to a quasi-PIE **kieh₁-u-io-* (Kroonen 2013, 224). CAPR writes the prevocalic *-u- of the diphthong as *w, following the convention already used in *knee* **knéwā* and *chew* **kéwwanā*, so the input form is **xéwjā*. The Proto-Germanic raising of *e to *i before *j is modelled inside the cascade rather than assumed in the reconstruction, which is why the input is entered with *é.

Campbell reconstructs the same stem shape in the traditional *i-notation, **niwja-* beside the parallel words, and states the West Germanic law that governs it: “*auj* > *auuj* > *auj*, and *iuj* > *iuuj* > *iuj*” (Campbell 1959, sect. 120.2, p. 46). Ringe and Taylor supply the comparative warrant for the geminate independently of the disputed **awj* cases, reconstructing PWGmc *[*niwwa-*], *[*siwwian*] and *[*gliwwias*] beside singleton-*w nominatives (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 53).

Old English evidence Campbell prints *hīew* ‘form’ beside *hīow* in the very section that derives this stem type, alongside *nīowe*, *nīewe* ‘new’ and *glīow*, *glīw* ‘mirth’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 120.2, p. 46). He states the dialect distribution explicitly: the resulting *iu-* “appears as *io-* in nW-S, *ie-* in W-S”. The project targets West Saxon, so *hīew* is the selected counterpart; *hīw*, *hīow* and *hēow* are the commoner spellings across the corpus of Old English and are recorded by the dictionaries (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898) and by Kroonen (Kroonen 2013, 224).

Development to Old English Campbell’s decisive observation is that the **awj* and **iwj* types share the gemination and then part company: “the u of *auuj* is lost, so that the final result is *ēg* or *ieg*, but the j of *iuuj* is lost, so that the result is *iow* or *iew*” (Campbell 1959, sect. 120.2, p. 46). The cascade reproduces both halves of that statement. West Germanic gemination doubles the *w before *j, giving **xéwwja*. The *ew diphthong is then lengthened to *ēo, the geminate is simplified, the initial dorsal fricative is palatalized, the nasal-final syllable loses its ending, i-umlaut raises *ēo to *īe, and the *j is lost after the now heavy syllable, leaving *hīew* with the *w intact.

The contrast with *hay* **xáwjā* is exact. The two inputs differ in a single segment, both geminate, and thereafter the low-vowel word loses its *w and keeps its *j to give *hīeg*, while this word loses its *j and keeps its *w. The resolution rule that converts the geminate to a diphthong is restricted to the low-vowel type and does not apply here, nor does the fronting of the resulting diphthong.

Why this row is in the corpus The *w branch of West Germanic *j*-gemination was witnessed only by *hay* and *strew*, both of which immediately undergo the later English resolution of *awwj. The branch and the resolution were therefore witnessed by the same two words, and nothing in the corpus showed that the gemination is the broader change. This row separates them. It is a positive witness for gemination of *w before *j after a short front vowel, and a negative control for the resolution rule, whose domain is the low-vowel type alone. It also gives the West Saxon simplification of the geminate its first witness outside the inherited *ww words. See [docs/sound_changes/audits/sc010-w-gemination-and-hay-depth-adjudication.md](#).

Part II. Attested variants and comparison forms

Here the Old English comparator belongs to a documented set of variants. The variation is part of the evidence and not an inconvenience to be normalized away.

cud — OE *cwedu*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **kwíθuz*; form followed here **kwéðuz* > *cwedu* (attested variant).

Derivation trace Proto input: **kwéðuz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic		[no change]
PWGmc Dental Hardening	<i>*kwéðuz</i>	
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*kwédu</i>	
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Old English form: *cwedu*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the resin word as **kwedu-2* ‘cud’ and gives Old English variants *cwidu* ‘cud’, *cweodu* ‘cud’, and *c(w)udu* ‘cud’ (Kroonen 2013, 355). Orel likewise lists *cwidu* under the cognate set (Orel 2003, 266). The derivational input **kwéðuz* ‘cud’ therefore represents the older e-grade, voiced-dental form behind the chosen variant *cwedu* ‘cud’.

Old English evidence The Old English word survives in a wider variant set than one dictionary headword suggests. Ringe and Taylor discuss *cwidu* ‘cud’ > *cwudu* ‘cud’ > *cudu* ‘cud’ and also note late West Saxon *cweodu* ‘cud’; Clark Hall gives *cwudu* ‘cud’, *cweodu* ‘cud’, and *cudu* ‘cud’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 338; Clark Hall 1960, 84). Attested *cwedu* ‘cud’ is treated here as the conservative variant within that set.

Development to Old English From **kwéðuz* ‘cud’, the West Germanic voiced dental hardens in the expected way and the regular Old English development yields *cwedu* ‘cud’. The other Old English spellings belong to the same lexical family, but reflect later leveling, back-umlaut, or further reduction rather than a need to replace the selected input.

Variant comparison

Variant type	Old English form	Comment
conservative target	<i>cwedu</i>	selected attested variant represented here
leveled i-grade form	<i>cwidu</i>	common lexical variant in the same family
back-umlauted forms	<i>cweodu, cwudu</i>	later developments within the same OE tradition
reduced form	<i>cudu</i>	further reduced member of the same variant set

ten — OE *tēon*

Derivation: **téxun* > *tēon* (attested variant).

Derivation trace Proto input: **téxun*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Breaking	<i>*téoxun</i>
[no change]	OE Med Unstressed U Lowering	<i>*téoxon</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	OE H Loss	<i>*téoon</i>
[no change]	OE Contraction	<i>*téon</i>

Old English form: *tēon*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence **tēon* ‘ten’ is the bare cardinal form. Fulk states that Old English *tien* ‘ten’ shows umlaut from the inflected forms, whereas the uninflected form without umlaut is reflected in *tēon* ‘ten’ (Fulk 2018, sect. 10.2). Brunner gives the same contrast more broadly: **tēon* ‘ten’ develops from **tēhun* ‘ten’, while West Saxon *tien* ‘ten’, *tȳn* ‘ten’ belong to a different, umlauted branch of the numeral history (Brunner 1965, sects 129.2, 129 Anm. 6, 234).

The comparison form *tēon* ‘ten’ therefore represents the bare cardinal’s un-umlauted line, not the later umlauted simplex tradition.

Old English evidence The attested simplex forms are varied. Campbell gives *tien* ‘ten’, north-western West Saxon *tēn* ‘ten’, and late Northumbrian *tēo* ‘ten’, *tēa* ‘ten’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 682). Brunner likewise lists West Saxon *tien* ‘ten’, *tȳn* ‘ten’ beside *tēn* ‘ten’, *tēo* ‘ten’, *tēa* ‘ten’ in other dialects (Brunner 1965, sect. 325).

Exact simplex *tēon* ‘ten’ is weaker as a directly cited headword than those spellings. The un-umlauted stem is, however, explicit in *tēoða* ‘tenth’ and *tēontig* ‘ten’ (Brunner 1965, sect. 129.2; Fulk 2018, sect. 10.2). The comparison form *tēon* ‘ten’ is therefore a normalized spelling of that un-umlauted base.

Development to Old English From **téxun* ‘ten’, lowering of medial unstressed *u* gives **téxon* ‘ten’, breaking gives **téoxon* ‘ten’, loss of intervocalic *h/x* yields **téoon* ‘ten’, and contraction produces **téon* ‘ten’, written *tēon* ‘ten’. This is the regular bare-cardinal path.

The umlauted forms *tien* / *tīen* ‘ten’ belong to a different branch, created when the numeral was levelled from inflected forms with a front-vocalic trigger (Fulk 2018, sect. 10.2; Brunner 1965, sect. 129 Anm. 6).

Variant comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the normalized un-umlauted base from the attested simplex variants.

Form or branch	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>tēon</i>	normalized un-umlauted comparison form; trace-supported	Old English form here
<i>tien</i> / <i>tīen</i>	attested West Saxon umlauted simplex forms	genuine OE variants, but not the bare-cardinal line modeled here
<i>tēn</i> / <i>tēo</i> / <i>tēa</i>	attested un-umlauted simplex variants in other dialects	support the same branch as the comparison form

three — OE *þrīe*

Derivation: **θréjez* > *þrīe* (attested variant).

Derivation trace Proto input: **θréjez*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE I Umlaut	<i>*θrije</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*θréje</i>	OE Intervocalic J Vocalization	<i>*θriie</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Contraction	<i>*θrīe</i>
[no change]			

Old English form: *þrīe*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the numeral under a broader stem-style reconstruction rather than under one Old English-ready paradigm cell (Kroonen 2013, 586). The input **θréjez* ‘three’ is therefore best understood as the inherited masculine nominative-accusative singular.

The Old English numeral has no uniform citation form across the paradigm. The masculine singular line must be kept apart from feminine-neuter *þrēo* ‘three’ and from later reduced spellings of the masculine form.

Old English evidence Campbell gives masculine nominative-accusative *þrīe* ‘three’, feminine and neuter nominative-accusative *þrēo* ‘three’, genitive *þrēora* ‘three’, and dative *þrim* ‘three’, adding that late West Saxon has *þry* ‘three’ / *þri* ‘three’ for masculine nominative-accusative beside *þrīe* ‘three’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 683). Fulk presents the same masculine *þrīe* ‘three’ beside the wider numeral paradigm (Fulk 2018, sect. 10.1).

The target is therefore an attested Old English paradigm cell. *þrī* ‘three’ / *þry* ‘three’ belongs to later reduction or headword-style citation, whereas *þrīe* ‘three’ is the conservative masculine nominative-accusative form.

Development to Old English From **θréjez* ‘three’, loss of final -z leaves **θréje* ‘three’ as an intermediate form. The following **θrije* ‘three’ fronts the stem vowel, then vocalizes between vowels, and contraction yields **þrīe* ‘three’. The compact trace records the same sequence as *θrije* > *θriie* > *þrīe*.

Variant comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the selected masculine cell from the later reduced form and from the rest of the numeral paradigm.

Form	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>þrīe</i>	attested masculine nom./acc.; regular output	Old English form here
<i>þrī</i> / <i>þry</i>	later reduced masculine variant	genuine OE variant, but not the conservative comparison form
<i>þrēo</i>	attested feminine-neuter nom./acc.	same numeral, different paradigm cell
<i>þrēora</i> , <i>þrim</i>	attested genitive and dative forms	confirm the wider paradigm, not the cell compared here

wasp — OE *wæfs*

Derivation: **wábsaz* > *wæfs* (attested variant).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wábsaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*wábs</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*wábsa</i>	EAF Brightening	<i>*wæbs</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		PGmc B Allophony	<i>*wæβs</i>
[no change]			

Old English form: *wæfs*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The Proto-Germanic form **wábsaz* ‘wasp’ reaches Old English without any special change of stem or paradigm cell. The question in this entry is instead which attested Old English member of the variant set should serve as the comparison form.

Fulk presents the Old English forms together as *wæfs* ‘wasp’ with variants *wæsp* ‘wasp’ and *wæps* ‘wasp’ (Fulk 2018, sect. 6.5). Bülbring and Brunner then make the chronology more explicit by deriving later *wæps* and late West Saxon *wasp* ‘wasp’ from earlier *wæfs* / *wæfs* through restricted metatheses (Bülbring 1902, sect. 484 Anm. 3; Brunner 1965, sects 193, 204).

Old English evidence The earliest directly cited Old English form is *wæfs* ‘wasp’, written *wæfs* ‘wasp’ in the Épinal-Corpus material discussed by Bülbring and Brunner (Bülbring 1902, sect. 484 Anm. 3; Brunner 1965, sect. 193). Later Old English also shows *wæps* ‘wasp’ and *wæsp* ‘wasp’ / *wasp* ‘wasp’, and dictionary practice often favors *wæps* or later spellings as headwords (Clark Hall 1960, 341).

This entry therefore distinguishes chronological priority from headword habit. *wæfs* ‘wasp’ is not a convenient reconstruction: it is an attested Old English form and also the one that matches the regular development most closely.

Development to Old English From **wábsaz* ‘wasp’, the regular Old English path passes through loss of final z, Anglo-Frisian fronting, and the allophonic development of *b* to a fricative before s, yielding *wæfs* ‘wasp’.

The later forms *wæps* ‘wasp’ and *wæsp* ‘wasp’ / *wasp* ‘wasp’ belong to subsequent, lexically restricted metatheses. They are genuine Old English forms, but they are later within the variant history.

Variant comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the earliest attested and regular form from the later metathesized doublets.

Form	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>wæfs</i>	earliest attested OE form; regular output	Old English form here
<i>wæps</i>	later attested metathesized variant	genuine OE doublet, but secondary
<i>wæsp</i> / <i>wasp</i>	later West Saxon metathesized variant	genuine OE doublet, but not the form compared here

Part III. Early analogy and pre-Old-English input selection

Here an analogical change already separates the transducer input from the lexeme's citation reconstruction before the specifically Old English changes apply. Each entry must therefore justify the remodeled input independently of the successful output.

bottom — OE *botm*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **búdmaz*; form followed here **búttmaz* > *botm* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **búttmaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*bóttm</i>
PNWGmc U Lowering	<i>*bóttmaz</i>	OE Preconsonantal Degemination	<i>*bótm</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*bóttma</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *botm*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the word as a stem complex **budmō* ‘bottom’ with genitive **buttaz* ‘bottom’, summarized as **budman-* ~ **butman-*, and gives Old English *botm* ‘bottom’ as the reflex (Kroonen 2013, 120). The comparative label **búdmaz* ‘bottom’ names the lexeme-level stem complex, while the derivational input **búttmaz* ‘bottom’ represents the pre-Old-English form with oblique **butt-* generalized into the nominative formation.

Orel likewise preserves both sides of the comparison under **budmaz* ‘bottom’ and **butmaz* ‘bottom’ (Orel 2003, 100). The derivational input is thus a historical stem choice, not an arbitrary respelling.

Old English evidence The Old English noun itself is secure. Clark Hall gives *botm* ‘bottom’ (Clark Hall 1960, 63). Bosworth-Toller cross-references *bodan* ‘bottom, floor’ to *botm* ‘bottom’, showing the wider reflex family without weakening the attested lemma (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 112).

Development to Old English Once the oblique **butt-* stem has been generalized, the derivational input **búttmaz* ‘bottom’ develops regularly to *botm* ‘bottom’. The analogical step is therefore early: it belongs to pre-Old-English stem formation rather than to a later choice among Old English paradigm cells.

brand — OE *brandes*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **brándaz*; form followed here **brándas* > *brandes* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **brándas*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	<i>*brándæ̆s</i>
[no change]		OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*brándes</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *brandes*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The inherited noun is the masculine a-stem **brándaz* ‘brand’, continued by Old English *brand* ‘brand’ and its continental cognates (Orel 2003, 53). The selected input **brándas* ‘brand’ is not a different lexeme but the genitive singular of that same a-stem noun.

Both forms belong to the same root and stem class but occupy different inherited inflectional cells. The derivational input is the oblique cell.

Old English evidence Old English dictionaries lemmatize the noun as *brand* ‘brand’ (Clark Hall 1960, 49; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 116). Bosworth-Toller also records inflectional forms such as *brandas* ‘brand’, *branda* ‘brand’, and *brandum* ‘brand’ under the same entry (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 116).

The specific comparison form in this entry, *brandes* ‘brand’, is the expected genitive singular of that a-stem noun. It is therefore an inferred Old English paradigm form rather than the ordinary dictionary headword.

Development to Old English From **brándas* ‘brand’, the regular Old English development passes through the usual unstressed-vowel weakening of the inflectional ending, yielding *brandes* ‘brand’. Nothing in the stem itself requires a special repair. The root consonants and the stressed vowel are the same as in the citation lemma *brand* ‘brand’.

The analytical weight of the entry lies in the ending. By choosing the oblique singular rather than the nominative citation form, the entry presents the same lexeme in a different inherited cell.

Form comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the citation lemma from the selected oblique singular.

Form / interpretation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
citation nominative singular	<i>*brándaz</i>	expected OE lemma <i>brand</i>	<i>brand</i>	regular headword-level outcome
genitive singular	<i>*brándas</i>	regular output: <i>brandes</i>	<i>brandes</i>	exact match for the oblique cell

The noun itself is straightforwardly inherited. The main point of the entry is that *brandes* ‘brand (gen.)’ belongs to the same regular a-stem paradigm as *brand* ‘brand’, even though the citation lemma remains the nominative singular.

breast — OE *brēost*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **brústz*; form followed here **bréustq* > *brēost* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bréustq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Diphthong Leveling OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*brēostq</i> <i>*brēost</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]		

Old English form: *brēost*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The word family shows two related but distinct Proto-Germanic formations. The root noun **brust-* lies behind forms such as Gothic *brusts* ‘breast’, whereas Old English *brēost* ‘breast’ belongs to a thematic formation **breusta-*, alongside Old Norse *brjóst* ‘breast’ and Old Saxon *brīost* ‘breast’ (Kroonen 2013, 114; Orel 2003, 95; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 43).

The derivational input **bréustą* ‘breast’ therefore differs from the citation label **brústz* ‘breast’ because Old English reflects the thematic branch rather than the root noun. The morphological choice comes before the Old English sound changes themselves.

Old English evidence Clark Hall records the noun as *brēost* ‘breast’ / *breóst* ‘breast’ (Clark Hall 1960, 65). The form is an established Old English lexeme, not a reconstructed target assembled from comparative evidence alone.

What requires explanation is not the Old English attestation but the relation between that attested noun and the broader Germanic word family. The relevant comparison form is therefore the thematic Old English noun *brēost* ‘breast’.

Development to Old English From **bréustą* ‘breast’, the regular Old English development gives *brēost* ‘breast’, with the expected *eu > ēo* vowel history (Campbell 1959, sect. 115). No special repair is needed once the correct thematic formation is chosen.

The earlier mismatch arose only if the word was forced into the root-noun line. The Old English noun itself continues the thematic branch cleanly and directly.

Formation comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the broader root-noun family label from the thematic formation actually continued in Old English.

Formation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
broader root-noun family	<i>*brústz</i>	root-noun type outcomes outside OE	non-OE comparanda	useful family label, but not the direct source of <i>brēost</i>
selected thematic formation	<i>*bréustą</i>	regular output: <i>brēost</i>	<i>brēost</i>	exact match between formation and attested OE noun

The relevant point is the formation split. *brēost* ‘breast’ is the regular Old English outcome of the thematic **breusta-* branch, not of the root noun **brust-*.

craft — OE *cræft*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **kráftiz*; form followed here **kráftaz > cræft* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **kráftaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	* <i>kráft</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	* <i>kráfta</i>	EAF Brightening	* <i>kræft</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *cræft*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Comparative sources disagree about the older stem class. Kroonen gives a u-stem **kraftu-*, while Orel prints **kraftiz* ‘craft’ and **kraftuz* ‘craft’ (Kroonen 2013, 340; Orel 2003, 259). The comparative label **kráftiz* ‘craft’ remains in view as a lexeme-level shorthand, while **kráftaz* ‘craft’ is the pre-Old-English form used for the Old English derivation.

Old English evidence The Old English noun itself is secure. Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller both give *cræft* ‘craft’ as the headword (Clark Hall 1960, 19; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 145).

Development to Old English The comparison is between possible pre-Old-English inputs. The i-stem comparator **kráftiz* ‘craft’ gives *creft*, while the u-stem comparator **kráftuz* ‘craft’ gives *craft*. The a-stem-shaped input **kráftaz* ‘craft’ yields *cræft* ‘craft’ and is therefore the form used for the Old English derivation. This does not require treating the comparative dictionaries as identical; it shows the narrower point that the Old English derivation needs a pre-Old-English form without the i-umlaut trigger of **-iz* ‘craft’ and without the back-vowel outcome associated with the u-stem comparator.

Form comparison

Candidate input	OE output	Result
* <i>kráftiz</i>	<i>creft</i>	non-match; i-stem comparator
* <i>kráftuz</i>	<i>craft</i>	non-match; u-stem comparator
* <i>kráftaz</i>	<i>cræft</i>	exact match; selected pre-OE input

dill — OE *dile*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **déljaz*; form followed here **déliz* > *dile* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **déliz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE I Umlaut	* <i>dili</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	* <i>déli</i>	OE Med Unstressed I Lowering ¹	* <i>dile</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *dile*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Comparative evidence preserves both an i-stem and a ja-stem formation, with Old English *dile* ‘dill’ on one side and continental forms such as Old Saxon *dilli* ‘dill’ and Old High German *tilli* ‘dill’ on the other (Fulk 2018, 170). The derivational input **déliz* ‘dill’ therefore represents the i-stem side of the paradigm, whereas the citation label **déljaz* ‘dill’ is a broader comparative headword.

The stem class determines the Old English consonant shape. A ja-stem with **-lj-* would be expected to produce gemination, but the Old English noun shows a single *l*. Fulk's discussion of ja-stems transferred to the i-stems provides the relevant morphological background for the OE side (Fulk 2018, 170).

Old English evidence Old English dictionaries record the plant name as *dile* 'dill', alongside the variant *dili* 'dill' (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 164; Clark Hall 1960, 95). The form discussed here is therefore an attested Old English noun with single *l*.

The Old English evidence is the relevant point. Whatever broader comparative headword is chosen for the family, the inherited form reflected in OE is the i-stem type *dile* 'dill', not a geminated *dill* 'dill' outcome.

Development to Old English From **déliz* 'dill', regular loss of final *z* and the later lowering of unstressed *i* yield *dile* 'dill'. The stem itself remains ungeminated throughout that path.

The contrast is morphological rather than phonological. If the word were forced through a ja-stem **-lj-* pathway, the expected result would show *ll*. The attested Old English noun instead matches the i-stem development.

Formation comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the broader comparative headword from the stem class actually reflected in Old English.

Formation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
comparative ja-stem label	<i>*déljaz</i>	ja-stem type outcome with gemination	<i>dill</i> -type comparison	useful comparative label, but not the OE form
selected i-stem formation	<i>*déliz</i>	regular output: <i>dile</i>	<i>dile</i>	exact match between formation and attested OE noun

The single *l* is the decisive diagnostic. It identifies *dile* 'dill' with the i-stem formation rather than with the continental ja-stem branch.

fast — OE *festan*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **fastēnq*; form followed here **fástijanq* > *festan* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fástijanq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening
	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope
	OE Secondary Nasalization
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	Sievers Law Syncope
	OE I Umlaut
	OE Weak Tail Reduction
	OE J Loss After Heavy
	<i>*fæstijanq</i>
	<i>*fæstijan</i>
	<i>*fæstijən</i>
	<i>*fæstjən</i>
	<i>*festjən</i>
	<i>*festjan</i>
	<i>*festan</i>

Old English form: *festan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen places the verb within the wider **fastu-* adjective family and its derived **fasten-* verbal line, the comparative background behind Old English ‘to fast’ (Kroonen 2013, 171). Ringe and Taylor, however, distinguish the Old English verb more closely: they treat OE ‘to fast’ as originally a class-I weak verb that later acquired the stative meaning through lexical confusion (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 110).

The derivational input **fástijanq* ‘fast’ therefore represents the inherited class-I formation reflected in Old English, whereas the citation label **fastēnq* ‘fast’ belongs to the broader comparative presentation of the lexeme.

Old English evidence Old English dictionaries record forms such as *festan* ‘fast’, alongside related *fæstan* ‘fast’ / *fǣstan* ‘fast’ spellings and meanings (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 213). The form selected here is *festan*, which fits the regular class-I phonological development.

The *æ*-forms remain relevant, but they do not control the entry. In the present analysis they belong to a later analogical reshaping under the adjective *fæst* ‘fast’, whereas *festan* ‘fast’ is the regular inherited class-I comparison form.

Development to Old English From **fástijanq* ‘fast’, Anglo-Frisian brightening and subsequent i-umlaut produce the fronted vowel seen in *festan* ‘fast’. The later weak-tail reductions and loss of *j* after a heavy syllable complete the regular Old English outcome.

What makes the entry non-regular is not the phonology of *festan* ‘fast’ itself, but the choice of formation. Old English continues the class-I verb, even though the comparative headword is often given under the parallel **fastēn-* family.

Class comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the comparative class-III headword from the class-I formation actually reflected in Old English.

Formation / class	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
comparative class-III headword	<i>*fastēnq</i>	class-III type outcome, not <i>festan</i>	wider family context	useful family label, but not the direct source of the target
selected class-I weak verb	<i>*fástijanq</i>	regular output: <i>festan</i>	<i>festan</i>	exact match between formation and attested OE verb
later analogical reshaping	adjective-driven <i>fæst</i> influence	<i>fæstan</i> / <i>fǣstan</i> type spellings	<i>fæstan</i> -type evidence	genuine later OE reshaping, but secondary to the Old English form here

The relevant point is the class split. *festan* ‘fast’ is the regular Old English outcome of the class-I formation, while the better-known *æ*-forms belong to a later analogical layer.

flask — OE *flasce*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **flaskō*; form followed here **fláskōn* > *flasce* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fláskōn*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	<i>*flæskō</i>
PNWGmc N Stem N Loss	<i>*fláskō</i>	OE A Restoration	<i>*flaskō</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*flaskæ</i>
[no change]		OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*flaske</i>

Old English form: *flasce*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The wider Germanic family is often cited under a form such as **flaskō* ‘flask’, but the evidence relevant for Old English points instead to a weak feminine formation **fláskōn* ‘flask’ / **flaskō* ‘flask’ (Orel 2003, 104). That distinction is crucial for the suffixal history of the noun.

The derivational input therefore differs from the citation label in stem class. Old English *flasce* ‘flask’ belongs with the weak feminine line, and the plural or oblique forms *flascan* ‘flask’ support that analysis (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 192).

Old English evidence Old English dictionaries record the noun as *flasce* ‘flask’, with inflectional support from forms such as *flascan* ‘flask’; a later West Saxon *flaxe* ‘flask’ is also noted as a secondary variant (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 235; Clark Hall 1960, 121).

The relevant comparison form is therefore the weak feminine noun *flasce* ‘flask’. The plural and oblique evidence helps explain why the vowel and ending are preserved as they are in the singular.

Development to Old English From **fláskōn* ‘flask’, the weak feminine passes through the expected loss of *n* and the later Old English development of the unstressed ending, reaching *flasce* ‘flask’. Campbell cites restored *a* in exactly this environment, including *flasce* ‘flask’ after inflected *flascan* ‘flask’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 158). Once the weak feminine formation is chosen, the noun follows a regular path to its Old English shape.

The decisive issue is morphological rather than phonological. A simple strong feminine citation form does not capture the OE weak noun as cleanly as the selected **fláskōn* ‘flask’ does.

Formation comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the broader comparative headword from the weak feminine formation actually reflected in Old English.

Formation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
broader comparative headword	<i>*flaskō</i>	broader family label	wider family context	useful lexeme label, but not the cleanest OE-facing derivation
selected weak feminine formation	<i>*fláskōn</i>	regular output: <i>flasce</i>	<i>flasce</i>	exact match between formation and attested OE noun

The weak feminine suffix is the relevant point. It aligns the inherited form with attested *flasce* ‘flask’ and its supporting paradigm forms.

follow — OE *fylġan*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **fulgēnq*; form followed here **fūlgijanq* > *fylġan* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fūlgijanq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*fūlgijan</i>
[no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*fūlgijān</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	Sievers Law Syncope	<i>*fūlgjān</i>
[no change]	OE Velar Palatalization	<i>*fūldʒjān</i>
	OE I Umlaut	<i>*fylḍjān</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*fylḍjan</i>
	OE J Loss After Heavy	<i>*fylḍan</i>

Old English form: *fylġan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the verb as **fulgen-* and gives Old English *fylgan* ‘follow’, *folgian* ‘follow’, adding that Old Norse *fylgja* ‘follow’ and Old English *fylg(e)an* continue a formation **fulgjan-* (Kroonen 2013, 159). The comparative headword and the class-I formation are therefore related but not identical.

Ringe and Taylor distinguish PNWGmc **fulgija-* ‘follow’ ~ **fulgai-* ‘follow’ > OE *fylgan* ‘follow’ ~ *folgian* ‘follow’ and describe it as a dual formation that probably reflects an older alternation between j-present and e-stative (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 293–94). This is a stem-class choice, not a spelling choice. The derivational input **fūlgijanq* ‘follow’ belongs to the class-I **fulgija-* / **fulgjan-* branch; the citation form **fulgēnq* ‘follow’ belongs to the parallel class-II history behind *folgian* ‘follow’.

Old English evidence The Old English evidence preserves both formations. Clark Hall lists *fylgan* ‘follow’ with variant spellings *fylgian* ‘follow’ and *fyligan* ‘follow’ (Clark Hall 1960, 125). Bosworth-Toller likewise has a separate *fylgean* ‘follow’ entry (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 275).

Bright notes traces of the older conjugation in *fylg(e)an* ‘follow’ (Bright 1971, 77) and lists *folgian* ‘follow’ (*fylgean* ‘follow’) in the glossary (Bright 1971, 364). The relevant comparison form in this entry is therefore the class-I verb *fylgan* ‘follow’ / *fylgean*, here normalized as *fylġan* ‘follow’. The spelling with ġ represents the palatalized velar before a front-vocalic environment.

Development to Old English **fūlgijanq* ‘follow’ is a class-I weak-verb formation. In the class-I branch the **j* blocks NWGmc lowering of *u* to *o*, since Ringe and Taylor formulate that lowering for environments in which no **j* intervened (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 96). The same front-vocalic environment then triggers i-umlaut, so *u* becomes *y* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, sect. 6.6.2).

The subsequent Old English developments are palatalization of the velar, weak-tail reduction, and loss of *j* after a heavy syllable, yielding *fylġan* ‘follow’. This is the regular outcome of the class-I formation. The class-II form *folgian* ‘follow’ belongs to the parallel **-ē-* / **-ai-* branch and is not the form modeled here.

Class comparison A class comparison identifies which inherited formation corresponds to the established Old English form under discussion. The comparison below is manual; no full automatic class probe is presented here.

Formation / class	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
citation class-II formation	*fulgēnq	probe output: <i>folgon</i>	<i>folgian</i> ‘follow’	mismatch: the regular output is not the remodeled infinitive <i>folgian</i>
parallel class-II branch	PNWGmc *fulgai-	Ringe-Taylor: OE <i>folgian</i> ‘follow’	<i>folgian</i> ‘follow’	documents the separate class-II branch, but not the target of this entry
selected class-I formation	*fūlgijanq	regular output: <i>fylgan</i> ‘follow’	<i>fylgan</i> ‘follow’ / <i>fylgan</i> ‘follow’	exact match between input, output, and class

The relevant point is the class split. *fylgan* ‘follow’ is the regular Old English outcome of the class-I *fulgija- / *fulgjan- formation, whereas *folgian* ‘follow’ belongs to the parallel class-II branch.

gall — OE *ġealla*

Derivation: citation reconstruction *gállq; form followed here *gállô > *ġealla* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: *gállô

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	EAF Brightening	*gællô
		OE Breaking	*geallô
		OE Velar Palatalization	*ǵeallô
		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	*ǵealla

Old English form: *ġealla*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The wider cognate family can be presented under a form such as *gállq ‘gall’, but the Old English noun itself belongs with a weak noun *gallōn- ‘gall’, cited here as *gállô ‘gall’ (Kroonen 2013, 165). The derivational input therefore differs from the broader comparative headword in stem class.

The stem class determines the Old English shape. The weak masculine pathway preserves the ending needed for *ġealla* ‘gall’, whereas a simple strong-noun headword does not align as closely with the attested OE noun.

Old English evidence Old English dictionaries record the noun as *gealla* ‘gall’, and Bright also gives the dative *geallan* ‘gall’, confirming a weak-noun paradigm (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 297; Clark Hall 1960, 145; Bright 1971, 372). The normalized spelling *ġealla* ‘gall’ uses ġ for the palatal consonant.

Campbell also notes dialectal variation, contrasting West Saxon or Kentish *gealla* ‘gall’ with Anglian *galla* ‘gall’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 486). The target of this entry is the West Saxon type *ġealla* ‘gall’.

Development to Old English From *gállô ‘gall’, the weak noun develops through the expected Old English history of the suffix and the regular breaking environment before *ll*, yielding *ġealla*

‘gall’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 486). Once the weak masculine input is chosen, the noun follows a regular path to its attested Old English form.

The decisive issue is therefore morphological. Old English reflects the weak noun, while the broader family label belongs to a different way of presenting the cognate set.

Stem comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the broader comparative headword from the weak noun formation actually reflected in Old English.

Formation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
broader family label	* <i>gállq</i>	broader cognate-set headword	wider family context	useful lexeme label, but not the direct source of <i>ġealla</i>
selected weak noun	* <i>gállô</i>	regular output: <i>ġealla</i> ‘gall’	<i>ġealla</i> ‘gall’	exact match between formation and attested OE noun
dialectal Anglian continuation	weak noun branch	Anglian <i>galla</i> ‘gall’ type	<i>galla</i> ‘gall’	genuine OE variant, but not the West Saxon form used here

The weak-noun stem class is the relevant point. It gives a direct route to attested *ġealla* ‘gall’, while the broader comparative label serves only as a family heading.

heaven — OE *heofon*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **xémenaz*; form followed here **xébun* > *heofon* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xébun*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Velar Fricative Palatalization
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	PGmc B Allophony
	OE Back Mutation
	OE Med Unstressed U Lowering
	* <i>çébun</i> * <i>çéβun</i> * <i>çéoβun</i> * <i>çéoβon</i>

Old English form: *heofon*

A. Selected CAPR derivation

Item	Value
lexical item	heaven
citation reconstruction / lexeme label	* <i>xémenaz</i>
form followed here	<i>xébun</i> (northern WGmc / pre-OE hebun)
Old English target	heofon
classification	early_analogy
derivational result	* <i>xébun</i> > <i>heofon</i> (multiplicity 1, exact match)

Compact live trace (corrected cascade, literal adjacent-mn SC022):

step	form
proto input	* <i>xébun</i>
OE Med Unstressed U Lowering	* <i>xébon</i>
OE Velar Fricative Palatalization	* <i>çébon</i>
PGmc B Allophony	* <i>çéβon</i>
OE Back Mutation	* <i>çéoβon</i>
Old English Orthography	<i>heofon</i>

No rule in this span creates the labial: it enters with the input *b* ($\rightarrow \beta \rightarrow f$). Only vocalic and surface changes are modelled.

B. Why **xébun* is not arbitrary Ringe and Taylor reconstruct northern West Germanic **hebun* ‘sky, heaven’, gen. **hebunas* ‘heaven’, whence West Saxon and Northumbrian *heofon* ‘heaven’, Mercian *heofen* ‘heaven’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 272, 324). R&T’s *hebun* is the lexeme CAPR writes **xébun* (canonical *x* for source *h*), dated to that northern West Germanic stage, not Proto-Germanic; §D explains its labial.

The word is an inherited mn-stem (Kroonen 2013, 220): PIE *h₂ék-mōn*, gen. *h₂k-mn-ós*, remodelled in Germanic to nom. **hemō* ‘heaven’, gen. **hemnaz* ‘heaven’. In the zero-grade oblique cluster cells the sequence *-mn-* is adjacent, and the change *mn > βn/bn/fn** is regular there (Fulk §6.14 (Fulk 2018, 121)). Old Norse preserves exactly this paradigmatic distribution — *himinn* ‘heaven’ (nominative, with *m*) beside dative *hifni* ‘heaven’ (oblique, with *f* from the syncopated cluster) — while Old English and Old Saxon (OS *heban* ‘heaven’, *hebenes* ‘heaven’ (Fulk 2018)) generalized the labial into the vowel-bearing stem. The *b* of *xébun* is therefore analogical within this nominative input*, but its historical source is regular and recoverable — back to the inherited genitive (see §E).

C. The unresolved *u* The medial *u* is the less secure element and must not be treated as certain merely because the cascade needs a back vowel to trigger back mutation. It is the n-stem suffixal vowel, the genuine conditioning environment for West Saxon back umlaut of *e* (parallel to *seven*, §D), and it is supported by Ringe–Taylor’s reconstruction and by the Old English back-mutation pattern (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 324). But its exact deeper ablaut grade — *u* here, against the *i* of the cognate vowel-stem **hemina-* (*himinn* ‘heaven’, Go. *himins* ‘heaven’) — is not fully recoverable. It is the irreducible residue of the reconstruction; the *b* is not.

D. Regular modelled span The northern-WGmc / pre-OE $\rightarrow$ Old English development **xébun* > *heofon* is regular and is the exact structural parallel of the independently regular numeral *seven*, **sébun* > *seofon* (row 2174, *DERIVATION_CLASS* regular). Both have a medial *u* and a labial, and both undergo West Saxon back umlaut of *e* before *u* across that labial (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 324; Hogg 1992a). The live traces run in lock-step (medial *u*-lowering, labial spirantization, back mutation, orthography). Ringe and Taylor explicitly treat *heaven* and *seven* as parallel back-umlaut examples, which is why *seven* is retained here as the control.

E. Deep oblique controls The obliques go deeper than the selected nominative and derive the labial themselves. Live outputs under the corrected literal adjacent-*mn* cascade, with evidential status marked:

cell / form	type	corrected-cascade output	status	note
nom. citation * <i>xémenaz</i>	reconstructed (citation)	<i>hemen</i>	counterfactual (no labial)	citation a-stem; no cluster, so no regular <i>f</i>
gen.sg cluster * <i>xémnas</i>	reconstructed (PIE * <i>h₂k-mn-ós</i>)	<i>hefnes</i>	reconstructed, not attested in OE	labial regular here (<i>mn > βn</i>)

cell / form	type	corrected-cascade output	status	note
dat.sg cluster *xémni	reconstructed	<i>hifn</i>	attested only as ON <i>hifni</i> ‘heaven’	labial + i-umlaut regular
dat.pl cluster *xémnum	reconstructed	<i>hefnum</i>	reconstructed, not attested in OE	labial regular
remodelled stem *xébun	reconstructed (R&T *hebun)	<i>heofon</i>	attested (selected row)	labial pre-supplied
R&T genitive *hebunas	reconstructed	<i>heofones</i>	attested	labial pre-supplied
OE oblique <i>heofnes</i> / <i>heofnum</i>	attested	—	actual OE forms	carry <i>eo</i> ; from the re-vowelled stem + late syncope
ON <i>himinn</i> : <i>hifni</i> ‘heaven’	attested (North Gmc)	—	attested cluster line	keeps the <i>m : f</i> alternation
OS <i>heban</i> / <i>hebenes</i>	attested (Old Saxon)	—	labial generalized	vowel-bearing throughout

Distinctions kept explicit: attested OE forms (*heofon*, *heofones*, *heofnes*, *heofnum*) descend from the re-vowelled stem; the cluster outputs *hefnes/hifn/hefnum* are reconstructed regular outputs, and for Old English they are counterfactual — the actual attested obliques carry *eo* from back mutation on the retained/restored medial vowel, then late syncope (*heofonum* > *heofnum*), not from a bare *-fn-* cluster. The genuine attested witness of the pure cluster line is Old Norse *hifni* ‘heaven’.

F. Why the oblique is not the selected row The oblique lines are historically essential — they show that the labial has a regular origin, all the way back to the inherited genitive *h₂k-mn-ós* — *but they are inferior as the single CAPR input*→*target datum*. In Old English every oblique cluster form encounters morphological re-vowelling (restoration of a medial vowel into the labialized *-βn-*stem) before it reaches an attested Old English shape. That re-vowelling is a non-regular event; it interrupts any single deterministic path from a cluster oblique to an attested OE form. The nominative input *xébun* begins after that restructuring and then proceeds by regular sound change to a secure attested target — the longest clean modellable span.

G. Attestation warning Bare Old English *hefn* is not securely attested and must not be reintroduced as an attested comparator. The earliest witnesses (Cædmon’s Hymn) are *hefun* ‘heaven’, *hefen* ‘heaven’, and (Moore Bede) *heben* ‘heaven’ — all with a medial vowel. The reconstructed cluster output *hefn* (§E) is a reconstruction, never a manuscript form.

H. Classification rationale The row is *early_analogy*, not *late_analogy* and not *known_unmodelled*.

- The selected row models exactly one form, **xébun* → *heofon*. The necessary paradigm restructuring (labial levelling + suffix-vowel generalization) precedes the derivational input; once that input is chosen, the modelled development is regular. This is the definition of *early_analogy* (analogy separates the input from the citation reconstruction before the specifically Old English changes apply).
- It is not *late_analogy*: the analogy is in the input, not a later paradigm-cell selection; the later history of *other* paradigm cells (oblique syncope, *heo-* levelling) does not touch the modelled nominative derivation.
- It is not *known_unmodelled*: that label (a legitimate, conservative alternative discussed in dossier-heaven-paradigm-history-2026.md) would discard a real, defensible regular span. **xébun* > *heofon* is a clean regular derivation to a secure attested target, so CAPR models it.

The old cross-syllable *mV...n* proxy in SC022 — which formerly fabricated the labial from an intervocalic *m* so that the previous input **xémonu* could reach *heofon* — has been retired in favour of the literal historical adjacent *mn* > *βn*. See dossier-heaven-paradigm-history-2026.md §§13–15 and the implementation audit audits/heaven-sc022-implementation-2026.md.

knight — OE *cniht*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **kníxtaz*; form followed here **knéxtaz* > *cniht* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **knéxtaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*knéxt</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*knéxta</i>	OE Breaking	<i>*knéox</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Ws Palatal Umlaut	<i>*knixt</i>
[no change]			

Old English form: *cniht*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The comparative sources align on an *e*-grade reconstruction for this noun. Ringe and Taylor cite **kneht* ‘knight’, and Orel gives **knextaz* ‘knight’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 142; Orel 2003, 256). Kluge-Seebold likewise points to **knehta-* (Kluge 2011, 506). The derivational input **knéxtaz* ‘knight’ follows that comparative evidence.

A competing citation reconstruction **kníxtaz* ‘knight’ remains possible as a label for the word family, but it is not the reconstruction followed here. The Old English development discussed below is based on **knéxtaz* ‘knight’.

Old English evidence Old English dictionaries record the noun as *cniht* ‘knight’ (Clark Hall 1960, 63; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 71). Campbell cites plural *cneohtas* ‘knights’ among the broken forms, showing the same vowel environment from another point in the paradigm (Campbell 1959, sect. 146).

The target is therefore an ordinary attested Old English noun. No reconstructed OE comparator is needed here.

Development to Old English From **knéxtaz* ‘knight’, the relevant Old English changes include breaking before the velar cluster and then the later reduction that yields *cniht* ‘knight’. Campbell later notes the early West-Saxon alternation *cniht* ‘knight’ beside plural *cneohtas* ‘knights’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 305). Sievers-Brunner gives the same contrast as *cniht* ... *cneohtas* (Brunner 1965, sect. 122). With that corrected input, the derivation is straightforward.

Stem comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the handbook-supported *e*-grade input from a competing citation reconstruction.

Formation / label	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
competing citation reconstruction	<i>*kníxtaz</i>	not the reconstruction followed here	broader citation tradition	useful as a competing label, but not the source-based choice used for the OE derivation

Formation / label	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
handbook-supported reconstruction	<i>*knéxtaz</i>	regular output: <i>cniht</i> ‘knight’	<i>cniht</i> ‘knight’	exact match between comparative reconstruction and attested OE noun
related plural evidence	same stem family	plural <i>cneohtas</i> ‘knights’ type background	<i>cneohtas</i> ‘knights’	supports the vowel environment, but not the Old English form here cell

lade — OE *hladan*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **laθōjanq*; form followed here **xláðanq* > *hladan* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xláðanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	<i>*xlædanq</i>
PWGmc Dental Hardening	<i>*xládanq</i>	OE A Restoration	<i>*xladanq</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*xladan</i>
		OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*xladqn</i>
[no change]		OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*xladan</i>

Old English form: *hladan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor cite the strong verb *hladan* ‘lade, load’ directly (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 248). The citation label **laθōjanq* ‘lade’ is used here only as a broader family heading, not as the direct source of the OE derivation.

The derivational input therefore marks an early stem choice. The entry follows the strong Verner-grade form that reaches Old English *hladan* directly.

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller records the verb as *hladan* and preserves the expected strong-verb paradigm material around it (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 559). Clark Hall likewise records *hladan* (Clark Hall 1960, 159). The target is an attested infinitive rather than a reconstructed paradigm cell.

For this entry the relevant comparison form is the infinitive *hladan* itself. The question is how that attested strong verb relates to the broader comparative family.

Development to Old English From **xláðanq* ‘lade’, the verb passes through the expected early voiced stop stage, Anglo-Frisian brightening, and the later A-restoration that returns the root vowel to *a* before the full infinitival ending. Campbell treats verbs such as *hladan* as showing restored *a* in the present system (Campbell 1959, sect. 744). Ringe and Taylor likewise derive *hladan* from the voiced strong-verb line (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 248). The resulting Old English infinitive is *hladan*.

Class comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the wider weak-verb family label from the strong verb actually reflected in Old English.

Formation / class	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
comparative weak-verb label	*laθōjaną	wider family background	broader family context	useful family label, but not the direct source of <i>hladan</i>
selected strong Verner-grade input	*xláðana	regular output: <i>hladan</i>	<i>hladan</i>	exact match between formation and attested OE infinitive

lap — OE *lappa*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **lábbaz*; form followed here **láppô* > *lappa* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **láppô*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	EAF Brightening	<i>*læppô</i>
[no change]	OE A Restoration	<i>*lappô</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*lappa</i>
[no change]		

Old English form: *lappa*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The comparative sources point to a weak noun with *pp*: Orel gives **lappôn* ‘lap’, and the Old English dictionary tradition preserves variant *læppa* ‘lap’ (Orel 2003, 236; Clark Hall 1960, 180). The derivational input **láppô* ‘lap’ follows that evidence.

A competing comparative label **lábbaz* ‘lap’ has also circulated for the word family, but the cited handbooks do not make it the direct source of the Old English weak noun. The form relevant to the OE development is the weak masculine input **láppô* ‘lap’.

Old English evidence Campbell cites *lappa* ‘lap’ as a case of restored *a* (Campbell 1959, sect. 158). Sievers-Brunner records *lappa* ‘lap’ beside variant *læppa* ‘lap’ (Brunner 1965, sect. 10). The dictionary tradition also preserves *læppa* ‘lap’ (Clark Hall 1960, 180; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 613).

The target of this entry is the restored singular *lappa* ‘lap’. The variant *læppa* ‘lap’ and the oblique or plural *leappan* remain part of the Old English record and help frame the noun’s vowel history.

Development to Old English Campbell explicitly lists *lappa* ‘lap’ among the forms with restored *a* (Campbell 1959, sect. 158). Sievers-Brunner records *lappa* ‘lap’ beside variant *læppa* ‘lap’ at the same Old English stage (Brunner 1965, sect. 10). With the weak masculine input chosen, the selected *lappa* ‘lap’ outcome is therefore the regular Old English comparison.

Stem comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the weak masculine formation from a competing voiced comparative label.

Formation / label	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
competing voiced comparative label	*lábbaz	not the form followed for the OE weak-noun derivation	broader comparative background	useful as a competing label, but not the source-based choice used here
selected weak masculine noun	*láppô	regular output: <i>lappa</i>	<i>lappa</i>	exact match between formation and attested OE noun
attested OE variant line	same noun family	<i>læppa, leappan</i>	<i>læppa / leappan</i>	useful control forms within the same OE tradition

laugh — OE *hliehhan*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **lákanq*; form followed here **xláxjanq* > *hliehhan* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xláxjanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	<i>*xlæxxjanq</i>
PWGmc J Gemination	<i>*xláxxjanq</i>	OE Breaking	<i>*xleaxxjanq</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Velar Fricative Palatalization	<i>*xleaxcjjanq</i>
[no change]		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*xleaxcjjan</i>
		OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*xleaxcjjan</i>
		OE I Umlaut	<i>*xliexcjjan</i>
		OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*xliexcjjan</i>
		OE J Loss After Heavy	<i>*xliexcjan</i>

Old English form: *hliehhan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The wider Germanic family includes a non-j branch represented here by the citation label **lákanq* ‘laugh’, while the derivational input **xláxjanq* ‘laugh’ reflects the j-present line behind Old English *hliehhan* ‘laugh’.

This branch supplies the geminate fricative and the vowel development characteristic of the Old English verb. The comparative family label and the OE-facing input are therefore related but not identical.

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller records *hlihhan* ‘laugh’ as the verb ‘to laugh’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 551). Clark Hall cross-references *hlæhan* ‘laugh’, *hlehan* ‘laugh’, and *hlihhan* ‘laugh’ to *hliehhan* ‘laugh’ (Clark Hall 1960, 160–61). Bright’s glossary likewise gives *hlihhan* (*hliehhan*, *hlyhhan*) (Bright 1971, 315). The target of this entry is the West Saxon *hliehhan* ‘laugh’.

The variants belong to the same background, but the attested lemma *hliehhan* ‘laugh’ supplies the evidence followed here.

Development to Old English From **xláxjanq* ‘laugh’, West Germanic j-gemination yields the doubled consonant (Campbell 1959, sect. 407). Ringe and Taylor derive Old English *hliehhan* ‘laugh’ from the j-present branch via breaking before the palatalized geminate (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 240). They separately compare the related noun *hleahtr* as the outcome of **hlahtraz* ‘laugh’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 328).

Branch comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the wider non-j family label from the j-present branch actually reflected in Old English.

Formation / branch	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
wider non-j family	*lákanaǵ	comparative background outside the selected OE line	wider family context	useful family label, but not the direct source of <i>hliehhan</i>
selected j-present branch	*xláxjanaǵ	regular output: <i>hliehhan</i>	<i>hliehhan</i>	exact match between branch and attested OE lemma
attested OE variants	same OE verb line	<i>hlæhhan</i> , <i>hlehhan</i>	<i>hlæhhan</i> / <i>hlehhan</i>	genuine variant evidence, but secondary to the form compared here

loam — OE *lām*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **laimōn*; form followed here **láimq* > *lām* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **láimq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*lām</i>
[no change]			
Early Anglo-Frisian			
EAF Ai Monophthongization	<i>*lāmq</i>		

Old English form: *lām*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The inherited comparative noun is given as **laimōn* ‘loam’ or **laiman-*, and both Orel and Kroonen identify Old English *lām* ‘loam’ as a neuter reflex of that family (Orel 2003, 272; Kroonen 2013, 363). The form followed here, **láimq* ‘loam’, differs from the comparative headword because it represents the stem class that matches the Old English noun most directly.

This is therefore a class shift within the history of the English branch rather than a dispute about the OE target itself.

Old English evidence Old English dictionaries record the noun as *lām* ‘loam’, a neuter word for ‘loam, clay, mud’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 604; Clark Hall 1960, 196). The target is an attested citation form rather than a reconstructed comparator.

The relevant question is not whether *lām* ‘loam’ is Old English, but which inherited formation best accounts for that attested neuter noun.

Development to Old English From **láimq* ‘loam’, regular monophthongization of *ai* and the later loss of the final nasal syllable yield *lām* ‘loam’. With that OE-facing input, the phonological development is straightforward.

Class comparison The comparison below sets the inherited comparative n-stem label beside the OE-facing stem class used to derive the attested noun.

Formation / class	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
inherited comparative noun	*laimōn	comparative family background	wider family context	useful headword, but not the direct OE-facing input
OE-facing stem class followed here	*láimaǵ	regular output: <i>lām</i>	<i>lām</i>	exact match between the form followed here and the attested OE noun

lung — OE *lungen*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **lungō*; form followed here **lúnganjō* > *lungen* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **lúnganjō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE I Umlaut	<i>*lúngennju</i>
PWGmc J Gemination	<i>*lúngannjō</i>	OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*lúngennj</i>
PNWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*lúngannju</i>	OE J Loss After Heavy	<i>*lúngenn</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Final Geminate Simplification	<i>*lúngen</i>
[no change]			

Old English form: *lungen*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen treats the basic noun as **lungōn-* and also cites an OE-facing derivative **lungunjō-*, continued by Old English *lungen* ‘lung’ and close West Germanic cognates (Kroonen 2013, 384). The derivational input **lúnganjō* ‘lung’ models that derived feminine formation rather than the base noun. The notation differs slightly from Kroonen’s **lungunjō-*, but both point to the same derived feminine line.

The difference between the citation label and the derivational input is therefore derivational. Old English *lungen* ‘lung’ is not a direct reflex of the bare base noun **lungō* ‘lung’; it belongs to an expanded feminine formation.

Old English evidence Old English dictionaries record the noun as *lungen* ‘lung’, with inflected forms such as *lunenne* and *lungena* (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 634). Clark Hall also preserves a small family of compounds such as *lungenād* ‘lung-disease’, *lungensealf*, and *lungenwyr* (Clark Hall 1960, 191).

The target is an attested Old English lexeme with its own paradigm, not a rescued inflectional cell.

Development to Old English From the selected derived input, the expected derivational consonant and vowel adjustments lead to *lungen* ‘lung’. Once the expanded feminine formation is chosen, the Old English outcome is regular.

Formation comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the base noun from the derived feminine formation reflected in Old English.

Formation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
base noun	*lungō	base-noun outcome without the OE derivative suffix	broader family context	useful headword, but not the direct source of <i>lungen</i>
derived OE-facing formation	*lúnganjō	regular output: <i>lungen</i>	<i>lungen</i>	exact match between the derived formation and the attested OE noun
Kroonen's cited derivative	*lungunjō-	comparative support for the same OE-facing formation	<i>lungen</i> and cognate set	supports the derived feminine formation, with notation differing from the normalized input form used here

navel — OE *nafola*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **nablô*; form followed here **nábulô* > *nafola* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **nábulô*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening OE A Restoration PGmc B Allophony
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening OE Med Unstressed U Lowering
	* <i>næbulô</i> * <i>nabulô</i> * <i>naβulô</i> * <i>naβula</i> * <i>naβola</i>

Old English form: *nafola*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen instead gives a nasal-suffix navel formation with Old English *nafela* ‘navel’ among its reflexes (Kroonen 2013, 420), while Ringe and Taylor give the derivational pathway **nabulô* ‘navel’ > **næbula* ‘navel’ > *nafola* ‘navel’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 270). The difference is one of stage and notation rather than of lexeme identity: the derivational input **nábulô* ‘navel’ is the pre-syncope form needed for the Old English development.

For the Old English comparison, the crucial point is simply that the pre-OE form still contains a medial vowel.

Old English evidence Ringe and Taylor note the early West Saxon shift *nafola* ‘navel’ > *nafela* ‘navel’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 336). Campbell likewise records *nafela* ‘navel’ beside Corpus *nabula* ‘navel’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 159). The target of this entry is the nominative singular *nafola* ‘navel’, the form that matches the selected derivational pathway most directly.

nafela ‘navel’ is the better-known later West Saxon spelling, while *nabula* ‘navel’ preserves a less reduced medial vowel. These forms belong to the same lexical history, but this entry is centered on *nafola* ‘navel’.

Development to Old English Ringe and Taylor give the pre-OE line **nabulō* ‘navel’ > **næbula* ‘navel’ > OE *nafola* ‘navel’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 270). The trace represents that same development with stress-marked notation and explicit intermediate weakening. Intervocalic *b* then surfaces as *f*, and final weak-tail shortening gives *nafola* ‘navel’.

The medial vowel is still present when A-restoration applies. That is why the selected pre-syncope input differs from the syncopated comparative headword.

Stage comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the comparative citation form from the pre-syncope input and from the later OE spellings.

Formation / stage	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
syncopated comparative headword	<i>*nablô</i>	reduced <i>næfla</i> -type outcome rather than <i>nafola</i> ‘navel’	not the Old English form here	useful citation form, but too reduced for the pathway modeled here
selected pre-syncope input	<i>*nábulô</i>	regular output: <i>nafola</i> ‘navel’	<i>nafola</i> ‘navel’	exact match between derivational input and target
later OE reduction stages	same lexical history	attested <i>nafela</i> ‘navel’; Corpus <i>nabula</i> ‘navel’	<i>nafela</i> ‘navel’ / <i>nabula</i> ‘navel’	related OE spellings, but not the chosen comparator

neck — OE *hnecca*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **xnákkaz*; form followed here **xnékkô* > *hnecca* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xnékkô*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*xnékkā</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]		

Old English form: *hnecca*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The noun belongs to an ablauting n-stem family. Kroonen reconstructs a paradigm with nominative **hnekkō* ‘neck’, genitive **hnukkaz* ‘neck’, and accusative plural **hnakkuns* ‘neck’, and he places Old English *hnecca* ‘neck, nape’ among the e-grade descendants (Kroonen 2011, 167). Kluge-Seebold likewise identifies *ae. hnecca* as an ablaut partner of the a-grade *Nacken* family (Kluge 2011, 347).

A competing comparative label **xnákkaz* ‘neck’ belongs to the wider family, and Orel also gives an a-grade headword line (Orel 2003, 218). The derivational input **xnékkô* ‘neck’, however, is the form that matches the Old English branch.

Old English evidence Clark Hall records the weak masculine noun *hnecca* ‘neck, nape’ (Clark Hall 1960, 162). Bosworth-Toller likewise records *hnecca* ‘neck, nape’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 567). The target is therefore an attested citation form, not an oblique cell or a reconstructed lemma.

The phonological question is upstream of the Old English evidence. The attested noun already shows that the branch continued an e-grade form rather than the a-grade seen in much of the continental material.

Development to Old English From **xnékkô* ‘neck’, the derivation is straightforward. The trace shortens the final long vowel to **xnékka* ‘neck’, and Old English orthography gives *hnecca* ‘neck’. The derivation depends on the earlier selection of the e-grade weak-noun form continued by Old English.

Stem comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the wider a-grade family from the selected e-grade Old English branch.

Formation / label	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
competing comparative label	<i>*xnákkaz</i>	broader a-grade family rather than the selected OE source	continental <i>Nacken</i> line	useful family label, but not the input followed for the Old English derivation
weak noun with a-grade	<i>*xnakkô</i>	expected <i>hnacca</i> type outcome	<i>hnacca</i>	fixes the class, but not the vowel grade
selected e-grade nominative	<i>*xnékkô</i>	regular output: <i>hnecca</i>	<i>hnecca</i>	exact match between derivational input and attested OE noun
oblique paradigm background	<i>*hnukkaz</i> , <i>*hnakkuns</i>	ON/OHG/German a-grade continuation	<i>hnakki</i> / <i>Nacken</i>	shows the wider ablaut family, but not the chosen OE branch

needle — OE *nædl*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **néðlō*; form followed here **néðlō* > *nædl* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **néðlō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*nædl</i>
PNWGmc Long E Lowering	<i>*nāðlō</i>		
PWGmc Dental Hardening	<i>*nādlō</i>		
PNWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*nādлу</i>		
EAF Long A Fronting	<i>*nædлу</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *nædl*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor treat the word as a voiced/voiceless alternant, citing **nēplō* ‘needle’ ~ **nēdlō* ‘needle’ > OE *nēdl* ‘needle’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 329). The form followed here, **nēðlō* ‘needle’, is the voiced Verner-grade form used for the Old English comparison, while the citation form **nēθlō* ‘needle’ remains the broader lexeme label.

The development discussed here follows the Ringe-Taylor alternant framework.

Old English evidence Clark Hall records the attested citation form *nædl* ‘needle’ (Clark Hall 1960, 210). Campbell lists *nēdl* ‘needle’ among the expected unbroken forms after *t* and *d* (Campbell 1959, sect. 367). Hogg also includes *nidi* / *nædl* ‘needle’ in the same broader cluster history (Hogg 1992b).

The target is therefore an attested citation form. No oblique-cell substitution is involved in this entry.

Development to Old English Ringe and Taylor give the historical line **nēplō* ‘needle’ ~ **nēdlō* ‘needle’ > OE *nēdl* ‘needle’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 329). Campbell likewise lists *nēdl* ‘needle’ among the expected unbroken forms after *t* and *d* (Campbell 1959, sect. 367). The trace expresses the same pathway with the voiced alternant followed here for the Old English comparison.

The essential choice lies in which Proto-Germanic alternant is taken as the starting point. Once the voiced form is chosen, the rest of the pathway is regular.

Alternant comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the broader citation headword from the voiced alternant used for Old English.

Formation / stage	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
comparative voiceless headword	<i>*nēθlō</i>	broader word-family label rather than the OE-facing alternant	<i>*nēplō</i> line	useful citation form, but not the derivational input for the Old English comparison
voiced Verner alternant followed here	<i>*nēðlō</i>	regular output: <i>nædl</i>	<i>nædl</i>	exact match between the form followed here and the attested OE noun
later hardening stage	<i>*nēdlō</i>	intermediate pre-OE stage in the same derivation	<i>nædl</i>	genuine stage in the pathway, but not the Proto-Germanic form followed here

nose — OE *nosu*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **nasō*; form followed here **núsō* > *nosu* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **núsō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic		[no change]
PNWGmc U Lowering	<i>*nósō</i>	
PNWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*nósu</i>	
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Old English form: *nosu*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs a Germanic ablaut pair **nasō-* ~ **nusō-* and adds that the root **nus-* is likely to have arisen as a secondary zero grade after a remodeling of the older paradigm (Kroonen 2013, 423). Campbell is more specific for Old English, citing *nosu* ‘nose’ < **nusō* ‘nose’ (Campbell 1959, 44).

The citation reconstruction **nasō* ‘nose’ is therefore best treated as the full-grade comparative headword, while the derivational input **núsō* ‘nose’ represents the remodeled zero-grade line continued by the Old English form discussed here. Orel’s **nasō* ‘nose’ alongside OE *nasu* ‘nose’ preserves the competing full-grade notation and shows that the two lines should not be collapsed without comment (Orel 2003, 320).

Old English evidence *Nosu* ‘nose’ is an attested Old English noun. Ringe and Taylor list it among the few surviving early Old English feminine u-stems (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 385). Clark Hall likewise gives *nosu f.* ‘nose’, with genitive-dative singular *nosa*, and cross-refers *nasu* ‘nose’ to *nosu* ‘nose’ (Clark Hall 1960, 810).

The selected OE target is therefore attested *nosu* ‘nose’, not a reconstructed placeholder. The lexicographical record also gives *nasu* ‘nose’ for the full-grade side of the tradition.

Development to Old English From **núsō* ‘nose’, the regular path is the one documented by the current trace: **núsō* ‘nose’ > **nósō* ‘nose’ > **nósu* ‘nose’ > *nosu* ‘nose’. The early special step lies in the choice of the zero-grade input, not in any late Old English repair.

With that input chosen, the OE development is straightforward. The full-grade line behind **nasō* ‘nose’ instead points toward *nasu* ‘nose’, not to the form treated here.

Stem comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the full-grade comparative line from the remodeled zero-grade input that yields the Old English form.

Formation / label	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
full-grade comparative line	<i>*nasō</i>	expected full-grade continuation <i>nasu</i>	<i>nasu</i>	useful comparative background, but not the Old English-facing input
remodeled zero-grade line	<i>*núsō</i>	regular output: <i>nosu</i>	<i>nosu</i>	exact match between derivational input and attested OE noun

sap — OE *sæp*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **sapōn*; form followed here **sápq* > *sæp* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **sáp̥q*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	EAF Brightening		<i>*sæpq</i>
[no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope		<i>*sæp</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *sæp*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The comparative sources do not give one uniform inherited stem. Kroonen preserves the word family as **saf* ‘sap’ / **ppan-*, with Old English *sæp* ‘sap’ (Kroonen 2013, 420). Orel preserves the comparative notation **sapōn* ‘sap’ and **sapan* ‘sap’ (Orel 2003, 319).

The derivational input **sáp̥q* ‘sap’ therefore does not replace those comparative labels. It identifies the OE-facing stem shape that yields the attested noun treated here.

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *sæp* ‘sap’ (e) n. (Clark Hall 1960, 247). The target is therefore an attested neuter Old English noun. Orel’s plain *sap* ‘sap, juice’ notation belongs to comparative normalization, not to the spelling adopted here for the Old English form (Orel 2003, 319).

Development to Old English From **sáp̥q* ‘sap’, Anglo-Frisian brightening yields *sæ* ‘sap’, and heavy-syllable nasal apocope then produces *sæp* ‘sap’. That is the regular path documented by the current trace.

The competing comparative lines do not give the same result. The inherited n-stem notation **sapōn* ‘sap’ yields *sape* ‘sap’, while an i-stem continuation from the **sapi-* line leads to *sep* ‘sap’ / *sepe* ‘sap’ rather than to *sæp* ‘sap’. The special step in this entry is therefore the early stem choice, not a late OE paradigm-cell selection.

Stem comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the competing comparative stem lines from the Old English-facing input.

Formation / label	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
comparative n-stem line	<i>*sapōn</i>	local comparator output: <i>sape</i> ‘sap’	<i>sape</i> ‘sap’	useful comparative background, but not the source of attested <i>sæp</i>
inferred i-stem comparator from <i>*sapi-</i>	<i>*sapiz</i>	local comparator output: <i>sepe</i> ‘sap’	<i>sepe</i> ‘sap’	confirms that an i-triggering stem does not reach the target
selected a-stem input	<i>*sáp̥q</i>	regular output: <i>sæp</i> ‘sap’	<i>sæp</i> ‘sap’	exact match between derivational input and attested OE noun

sea — OE *sǣ*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **sái*; form followed here **sáiwiz* > *sǣ* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **sáiwiz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE W Loss Before I	<i>*sāi</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*sáiwī</i>	OE I Umlaut	<i>*sǣi</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*sǣ</i>
EAF Ai Monophthongization	<i>*sāwī</i>		

Old English form: *sǣ*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen gives the noun in stem notation as **saiwi-*, an i-stem whose English reflex is cited as OE *sæ* ‘sea’ (Kroonen 2013, 423). Ringe and Taylor write the fuller form **saiwiz* ‘sea’ and derive it through **sawi* ‘sea’ > **sei* ‘sea’ > OE *sǣ* ‘sea’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, sect. 6.7.1). The comparative headword is therefore shorter than the form required for the English history: **sái* ‘sea’ names the lexeme, but **sáiwiz* ‘sea’ preserves the medial **w* and the final high vowel that control the later development.

Old English evidence The Old English noun is the ordinary word for ‘sea’. Kroonen cites it as *sǣ* ‘sea’; the normalized form here is *sǣ* ‘sea’ (Kroonen 2013, 423). Campbell likewise treats *sea* as continuing the same **saiui* ‘sea’ > **sǣi* ‘sea’ history, with loss of *u/w* before *i* (Campbell 1959, sect. 406).

Development to Old English Once the fuller i-stem input is chosen, the development is regular. After Proto-West-Germanic monophthongization **sáiwiz* ‘sea’ > **sāwiz* ‘sea’ and final **z* loss **sāwiz* ‘sea’ > **sāwī* ‘sea’, the non-initial **w* disappears before unstressed **i*, and the following high vowel fronts the root vowel before final apocope. The documented chain is **sáiwiz* ‘sea’ > **sāwiz* ‘sea’ > **sāwī* ‘sea’ > **sāi* ‘sea’ > **sǣi* ‘sea’ > *sǣ* ‘sea’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, sect. 6.7.1; Campbell 1959, sect. 406).

Stem and stage comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the abbreviated comparative headword from the fuller i-stem input that yields the Old English form.

Formation / label	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
abbreviated comparative headword	<i>*sái</i>	too short to preserve the <i>*w</i> ... <i>*i</i> environment needed for the documented chronology	<i>sǣ</i>	useful comparative label, but not the Old English-facing input
selected i-stem input	<i>*sáiwiz</i>	documented regular output: <i>sǣ</i>	<i>sǣ</i>	exact match between derivational input and Old English target

sieve — OE *sife*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **sibaz*; form followed here **sibi* > *sife* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **sibi*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	PGmc B Allophony OE Med Unstressed I Lowering1	<i>*sīβi</i> <i>*sīβe</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]		

Old English form: *sife*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kluge-Seebold gives wg. **sibi-* n. ... ae. *sife*, and Campbell groups *sife* ‘sieve’ with short neuter i-stems such as *spere* (Kluge 2011, 847; Campbell 1959, sect. 609). The older morphological background is the s-stem **sib-iz* ‘sieve’, but the derivational input is the normalized i-stem form **sibi* ‘sieve’.

Kroonen’s nearby **sebjō-* entry belongs to the separate kinship lexeme that yields Old English *sibb* ‘sieve’, not to the sieve word. Orel’s **sibaz* ‘sieve’ ... OE *sife* ‘sieve’ preserves a broader handbook notation, but that a-stem shape does not fit the Old English form treated here (Orel 2003, 328).

Old English evidence Clark Hall gives *sibi* ‘sieve’ (GL) ... = *sife* ‘sieve’ and also *sife* ‘sieve’ n. ‘sieve’ (Clark Hall 1960, 263). Campbell likewise cites Corpus Glossary *sibi* ‘sieve’ and treats *sife* ‘sieve’ as a short neuter i-stem (Campbell 1959, sects 444, 609). The normalized Old English target is therefore *sife* ‘sieve’, while *sibi* ‘sieve’ is an attested earlier spelling rather than a separate lexeme.

Development to Old English From **sibi* ‘sieve’, the regular derivation gives **sīβi* ‘sieve’ > **sīβe* ‘sieve’ > *sife* ‘sieve’. Medial *b* is realized as a spirant and later written *f*, while the final unstressed *i* lowers to *e*. The older s-stem background **sib-iz* ‘sieve’ explains the morphology, but the derivational input **sibi* is the immediate pre-Old-English form.

Stem comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the accepted i-stem line from its rejected competitors.

Formation / label	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
ja-stem kinship line	Kroonen <i>*sebjō-</i> / comparator <i>*sibja</i>	OE <i>sibb</i> ‘sieve’	<i>sibb</i> ‘sieve’	separate lexeme, not the target treated here
a-stem handbook line	<i>*sibaz</i>	expected <i>sif</i>	<i>sif</i>	wrong ending for the attested noun
selected i-stem line from older <i>*sib-iz</i>	<i>*sibi</i>	documented regular output: <i>sife</i> ‘sieve’	<i>sife</i> ‘sieve’; early spelling <i>sibi</i> ‘sieve’	exact match between derivational input and Old English evidence

spare — OE *sparian*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **sparēnq*; form followed here **spārōjanq* > *sparian* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **spārōjanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]		EAF Brightening	<i>*spærōjanq</i>
		OE A Restoration	<i>*sparōjanq</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*sparōjan</i>
		OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*sparōjan</i>
		OE I Umlaut	<i>*sparejan</i>
		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*sparejan</i>
		OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*sparejan</i>
		OE Intervocalic J Vocalization	<i>*spareian</i>
		OE Unstressed EI Contraction	<i>*sparian</i>

Old English form: *sparian*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen keeps the inherited verb under class-III **sparēn-* (Kroonen 2013, 465). Orel similarly preserves **sparēnan* ‘spare’ (Orel 2003, 362). Ringe and Taylor, however, reconstruct **sparai-* ~ **sparja-* for the English branch and derive the citation verb from a class-II line (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 162, 191). The derivational input **spārōjanq* ‘spare’ therefore represents the refashioned class-II formation behind Old English *sparian* ‘spare’, while the citation reconstruction **sparēnq* ‘spare’ remains the inherited comparative headword.

Old English evidence Campbell says that *sparian* ‘spare’ does not show the ordinary class-III characteristics, but the Ritual forms, normalized here as *spæria* ‘spare’, *spær* ‘spare’, and *spærede* ‘spare’, together with Vespasian Psalter *spearad* ‘spare’, point to primitive Old English forms both with and without back vowels (Campbell 1959, sect. 764). Brunner likewise records Northumbrian *spæria* ‘spare’, *spærede* ‘spare’ beside common Old English *sparian* ‘spare’ and Vespasian Psalter *spearad* ‘spare’ (Brunner 1965, sect. 364 Anm. 11). The citation form treated here is *sparian* ‘spare’; the Anglian forms are relics of the older formation, not alternative headwords of equal status.

Development to Old English Once the class-II formation **spārōjanq* ‘spare’ is chosen, the remaining development is regular. The regular derivation shows brightening, restoration of *a* before the back vocalism of the suffix, later i-mutation within the weak ending, weak-tail reduction, and contraction to *sparian* ‘spare’. By contrast, Brunner’s rule against further apocope of final *-e* explains why Ritual *spær* ‘spare’ cannot be the regular continuation of inherited **spārē* ‘spare’ (Brunner 1965, sect. 150).

Formation comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It contrasts the inherited class-III formation with the refashioned class-II one that yields the citation verb.

Formation / comparison	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
inherited class-III infinitive	<i>*spārēnq</i>	paradigm comparison / probe output: <i>sparen</i>	<i>sparian</i> ‘spare’	wrong class and wrong ending for the citation verb
inherited class-III imperative singular	<i>*spārē</i>	paradigm comparison / probe output: <i>spære</i>	Ritual <i>spær</i> ‘spare’	loss of final <i>-e</i> is not regular; so the relic form cannot control the entry

Formation / comparison	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
inherited class-III finite present	* <i>spárēθi</i>	paradigm comparison / probe output: <i>spæreþ</i>	<i>spearad</i> ‘spare’	attested form is mixed, not a direct continuation of the inherited cell
selected class-II formation	* <i>spārōjaną</i>	documented regular output: <i>sparian</i> ‘spare’	<i>sparian</i> ‘spare’	exact match between derivational input and Old English citation form

staff — OE *stæf*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **stábiz*; form followed here **stábaz* > *stæf* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **stábaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	* <i>stáb</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	* <i>stába</i>	EAF Brightening	* <i>stæb</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		PGmc B Allophony	* <i>stæβ</i>
[no change]			

Old English form: *stæf*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The comparative dictionaries do not give one uniform stem class. Kroonen reconstructs an a-stem **staba-* (Kroonen 2013, 471). Orel writes **stábiz* ‘staff’ ~ **stábaz* ‘staff’ (Orel 2003, 368). A direct i-stem input in *-iz ‘staff’ would predict i-mutation in Old English, whereas the attested noun keeps *æ*.

Old English evidence The Old English noun itself is the ordinary citation form *stæf* ‘staff’. Luick lists *stæf* ‘staff’ among closed monosyllables with *æ* (Luick 1914–1940, 176). Ringe and Taylor pair singular *stæf* ‘staff’ with plural *stafas* ‘staffs’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 193). The normalized form here is therefore *stæf*; later English *staff* with *a* belongs to a later stage of the word’s history.

Development to Old English With the selected a-stem input, the development is regular. Final *-z disappears, bare final -a is lost, Anglo-Frisian brightening gives *æ* in the closed monosyllable, and medial *b* surfaces as a fricative written *f*. The documented chain is **stábaz* ‘staff’ > **stába* ‘staff’ > **stáb* ‘staff’ > *stæb* ‘staff’ > *stæf* ‘staff’. A direct continuation of **stábiz* ‘staff’, by contrast, would produce i-mutated *stefe* ‘stave, staff’ rather than the attested singular.

Formation comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the rejected i-stem line from the selected a-stem input.

Formation / label	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
comparative i-stem line	* <i>stábiz</i>	expected <i>stefe</i> after i-mutation	<i>stæf</i>	wrong vowel for the attested singular
mixed comparative notation	Orel * <i>stabiz</i> ~ * <i>stabaz</i> ; Kluge * <i>stabi-/a-</i>	source-level stem-class uncertainty	<i>stæf</i>	useful comparative background, but not a single OE-facing input
selected a-stem input	* <i>stábaz</i>	documented regular output: <i>stæf</i>	<i>stæf</i>	exact match between derivational input and Old English target

stem — OE *stefn*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **stámnaz*; form followed here **stámniz* > *stefn* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **stámniz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	* <i>stæβni</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	* <i>stámni</i>	OE I Umlaut	* <i>steβni</i>
PNWGmc Mn Dissimilation	* <i>stáβni</i>	OE High Vowel Apocope	* <i>stefn</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *stefn*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel reconstructs the Proto-Germanic source as **stámnaz* ‘stem, trunk’ (also variant **stamniz* ‘stem, trunk’), citing Old Norse *stafn* ‘stem of a ship’, Old Frisian *stevene* ‘stem of a ship’ (fem.), and Old Saxon *stamn* ‘stem’ as its main continuants (Orel 2003, 371).

This word is etymologically unrelated to the Old English homonym *stefn* ‘voice, sound’ / *stemn* ‘voice, sound’, which descends from a distinct Proto-Germanic **stebnō* ‘voice, sound’ / **stemnō* ‘voice, sound’ etymon. The two OE lexemes are distinguished in Clark Hall, Bosworth-Toller, Brunner, and Luick; they collide on the surface forms *stefn* and *stemn* through historically independent developments.

Kroonen relates the ‘stem’ family to the *stam(m)* ‘stem, trunk’ group attested in Old High German, Dutch, and German, without reconstructing a separate ‘prow’ proto-form (Kroonen 2013, 479–80).

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *stefn* ‘stem, trunk, root, prow, foundation’, the weak n-stem *stefna* ‘prow or stern of a ship’, and the related *stofn* ‘trunk, stem, branch, shoot’ (Clark Hall 1960, 276, 341).

Luick §211 explicitly distinguishes OE *stefn* ‘stem, trunk’ / *stemn* ‘stem, trunk’ — noting cognates with Old Saxon *stamn* ‘stem’ and Middle English *stam* ‘stem’ — from the separate OE voice/sound word (*stefn* ‘voice, sound’ / *stemn* ‘voice, sound’) treated in §75 (Luick 1914–1940, sect. 211). Brunner §205 lists *stefn*, *stemn* *Stamm* among words showing the *fn/mn* alternation (Brunner 1965, sect. 205).

The primary comparison form used here is *stefn* ‘stem, trunk, root, prow’, the form attested most directly in the semantic range relevant to English *stem*. The n-stem *stefna* ‘prow/stern’ is a closely related but more narrowly attested nautical specialization.

Development to Old English The derivation of OE *stefn* ‘stem, trunk’ from the i-stem input **stámniz* ‘stem, trunk’ (Orel’s attested i-stem variant; the citation reconstruction remains **stámnaz* ‘stem, trunk’) is now regular and modelled, with multiplicity 1. Live trace under the corrected literal adjacent-*mn* SC022:

step	form
proto input	<i>*stámniz</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*stámni</i>
PNWGmc Mn Dissimilation (adjacent <i>mn</i> > <i>βn</i>)	<i>*stáβni</i>
EAF Brightening (<i>á</i> > <i>æ</i>)	<i>*stæβni</i>
OE i-Umlaut (<i>æ</i> > <i>e</i> , from the i-stem ending)	<i>*steβni</i>
OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*steβn</i>
Old English Orthography (<i>β</i> > <i>f</i>)	<i>stefn</i>

The consonantal change *mn* → *βn/fn* is attested comparatively: Old Norse *stafn* ‘stem of a ship’ and Old Saxon *stamn* ‘stem’ preserve the *fn/mn* variants expected from this family. The handbooks treat the change as a pre-Old-English development (Luick §211; Brunner §205), and the FST now encodes it as the historical adjacent *mn* > *βn* (the rule *PNWGmcMnDissimilation* / SC022). The *e* of *stefn* is regular from *á* via brightening (*á* > *æ*) plus i-umlaut triggered by the i-stem ending (*æ* > *e*), so both the vowel and the consonant follow by regular sound change once the i-stem input is selected.

Note the contrast with *heaven*. Here SC022 (*PNWGmcMnDissimilation*) fires directly inside the selected derivation, deriving the labial of *stefn* from the adjacent *-mn-* cluster of **stámniz*. In *heaven*, by contrast, the same historical change *mn* > *βn/fn* operated only in the deeper cluster-bearing oblique prehistory; the resulting labial was then generalized into the vowel-bearing **hebun-* stem, so the selected CAPR path **xébun* > *heofon* begins *after* that analogy and does not itself contain SC022 (see dossier-heaven-paradigm-history-2026.md §§13–15 and audits/heaven-sc022-implementation-2026.md). The earlier cross-syllable *mV...n* proxy — which had formerly fabricated a labial from an intervocalic *m* — has been retired in favour of this literal adjacent *mn* > *βn*. Selecting the i-stem input **stámniz* over the a-stem citation **stámnaz* is a pre-OE input selection; once selected, the Old English development is regular. Hence the classification *early_analogy* (analogy separates the input from the citation reconstruction before the specifically Old English changes apply), not *known_unmodelled*.

Homonym note Old English *stefn/stemn* is a surface homonym for two etymologically unrelated words:

1. *stefn/stemn* ‘voice, sound’: from PGmc **stebnō* (Ringe-Taylor, Orel); via *bn* → *fn* (b-allophony), giving *stefn* ‘voice, sound’. This is a different row from 2216.
2. *stefn/stefna/stofn/stemn* ‘stem, trunk, prow’: from PGmc **stámnaz* ‘stem/trunk’ (Orel); via the pre-OE cluster change *mn* → *fn*. This is row 2216.

The form followed here, **stébnō*, used in earlier versions of this entry was the wrong homonym’s transponent and must not be used here.

Source comparison

Form or label	Status	OE relation	Result
* <i>stámnaz</i> ‘stem, trunk’	Orel’s PGmc a-stem citation for the stem/trunk/prow family	lexeme-level citation	retained as PROTO (citation)
* <i>stámniz</i> ‘stem, trunk’	Orel’s attested i-stem variant	selected derivational input	regular OE output <i>stefn</i> (mult 1)
<i>stefn</i> III ‘stem, trunk, root, prow’	primary OE target (strong masc.)	stem/trunk sense per Clark Hall	target form
<i>stefna</i> ‘prow/stern’	OE n-stem specialization	nautical sense per Clark Hall	comparison form
<i>stofn</i> ‘trunk’	OE <i>o</i> -grade variant or earlier stage	trunk/stem sense	comparison form
<i>stemn</i> ‘trunk’	late West Saxon <i>fn</i> → <i>mn</i> doublet	secondary form	comparison form
* <i>stébnō</i> (voice word)	wrong homonym — belongs to voice/sound dossier	no relation to stem/trunk sense	must not be used as row 2216’s derivational input

swan — OE *swanes*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **swánaz*; form followed here **swánas* > *swanes* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **swánas*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	EAF Brightening	* <i>swánæcs</i>
[no change]	OE Unstressed AE Merger	* <i>swánes</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Old English form: *swanes*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The Germanic noun is ordinarily cited as the masculine a-stem **swánaz* ‘swan’ (Orel 2003, 367). The derivational input **swánas* ‘swan’ is not a competing lexeme reconstruction. It is the genitive singular **swánas* of the same paradigm.

The question here is therefore one of paradigm cell rather than stem history. The citation form remains **swánaz* ‘swan’ > *swan* ‘swan’; the comparison form is the genitive singular **swánas* ‘swan’ > *swanes* ‘swan’.

Old English evidence Bright’s glossary records the ordinary noun as *swan* ‘swan’, m. and also gives the exact inflected form *swanes* ‘swan’, citing the phrase *swanes feðre* (Bright 1971, 441).

The target is therefore an attested Old English genitive singular, not a reconstruction or the ordinary citation lemma.

Development to Old English From **swánas* ‘swan’, Anglo-Frisian brightening gives **swánæcs* ‘swan’, and subsequent merger of unstressed *æ* with *e* yields *swanes* ‘swan’. The comparison is straightforward once the genitive singular is chosen as the relevant cell.

Paradigm-cell comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the ordinary citation form from the selected inflected cell.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
citation nominative singular	* <i>swánaz</i>	OE headword <i>swan</i> ‘swan’	<i>swan</i> ‘swan’	ordinary lexeme line
genitive singular	* <i>swánas</i>	regular output: <i>swanes</i> ‘swan’	<i>swanes</i> ‘swan’	attested cell

thousand — OE *þūsend*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **θūs-undī*; form followed here **θūs-èndi* > *þūsend* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **θūsèndi*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Strip Secondary Stress	* <i>θūsènd</i>
PWGmc Early I Apocope	* <i>θūsènd</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *þūsend*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the Germanic numeral as **þūsundī*- and cites Old English *þūsend* ‘thousand’ among its continuations (Kroonen 2013, 554). The derivational input **θūs-èndi* ‘thousand’ is not the same claim. It is an OE-oriented transponent with the second-member vowel already resolved to *e* and the final high vowel already shortened for apocope.

The chronology must explain why Old English shows *þūsend* ‘thousand’ while related languages such as Old Saxon and Old High German keep *u* in the second syllable? (Kroonen 2013, 554).

Old English evidence Old English *þūsend* ‘thousand’ is an ordinary citation form, not a selected oblique or paradigm cell. Campbell treats it as a neuter noun with normal case forms (Campbell 1959, sect. 689). The problem lies in the internal history of the word, not in its lexical status.

Development to Old English If the old final *-ī* had remained long enough to trigger ordinary double umlaut, Campbell’s rule would point toward a form of the **þýsend* ‘thousand’ type rather than attested *þūsend* ‘thousand’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 203). Preserved root *ū* therefore argues that the umlaut-triggering vowel was lost or neutralized before the ordinary OE umlaut could develop.

That early loss, however, does not by itself explain the medial *e*. Luick compares the word with *ærende* ‘errand/message’ and later groups *thousand* with forms reshaped on that pattern (Luick 1914–1940, sects 198, 492). Viredaz is more cautious, arguing that Old English *e* in this weak position may simply write schwa and so need not prove a unique *ærende* ‘message’-type analogy (Viredaz 2025, sect. 2.1.4).

The selected transponent **θūs-èndi* ‘thousand’ captures the OE-side state from which the regular derivation reaches *þūsend* ‘thousand’.

Stage comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the secure chronology from the more interpretive account of the second-syllable vowel.

Stage / interpretation	Candidate form	OE relation	Result
surviving -ī with ordinary double umlaut	<i>*þūsundī-</i> treated as still umlaut-active in OE	would point toward <i>*þýsend</i>	excluded by preserved <i>ū</i>
early loss of the trigger without further reshaping	<i>*þūsund-</i> type	explains <i>ū</i> , but not why OE alone has medial <i>e</i>	incomplete account
selected OE-oriented transponent	<i>*θūs-èndi</i>	regular output: <i>þūsend</i> ‘thousand’	selected modeling input

timber — OE *timber*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **tímrq*; form followed here **tímbrq* > *timber* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **tímbrq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope OE Epenthetic Vowel	<i>*tímbr</i> <i>*tímber</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]		

Old English form: *timber*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the noun as **timbra-* and cites Old English *timber* ‘timber’ among its continuations (Kroonen 2013, 517). Ringe and Taylor instead state the history from **timra* ‘timber’ through West Germanic **timbr* ‘timber’ to Old English *timber* ‘timber’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 327).

The difference is therefore not over the Old English noun itself. It concerns whether medial *b* belongs in the comparative citation form or appears in an early pre-Old-English stage of the cluster.

Old English evidence Clark Hall lemmatizes the noun as *timber* ‘timber’ and also records *timbor* ‘timber’ as a variant spelling (Clark Hall 1960, 294). The Old English form is thus an ordinary citation noun, not a selected oblique cell or a reconstructed convenience form.

Development to Old English With the consonantal frame **timbr-* ‘timber’ in place, the rest of the development is straightforward. Loss of final *-q* leaves **tímbr* ‘timber’, and epenthetic *e* in the final cluster yields *timber* ‘timber’. Ringe and Taylor’s *timra* > *timbr* > OE *timber* and the handbook treatment of this epenthetic vowel point to the same Old English result (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 327; Campbell 1959, sects 463–464).

Formation comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the comparative headword from the OE-facing consonantal input.

Formation or notation	Candidate form	OE relation	Result
Kroonen’s comparative citation	<i>*timbra-</i>	already matches the consonantal frame of OE <i>timber</i> ‘timber’	closest comparative support for the derivational input
Ringe-Taylor citation line	<i>*timra</i> > <i>*timbr</i> ‘timber’	reaches the same OE noun through early cluster expansion	compatible comparative background

Formation or notation	Candidate form	OE relation	Result
modeled input	<i>*tímbraq</i>	regular output: <i>timber</i> ‘timber’	Old English-facing input

wake — OE *wacan*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **wakēnq*; form followed here **wákanq* > *wacan* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wákanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAf Brightening	<i>*wækanq</i>
	OE A Restoration	<i>*wakanq</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*wakan</i>
	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*wakqn</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*wakan</i>

Old English form: *wacan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen gives the strong verb as **wakan-* with Old English *wacan* ‘wake’ (Kroonen 2013, 568). Ringe and Taylor separately derive Old English *wacian* ‘wake’ from weak **wakai-* ~ **wakja-* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, sect. 3.3.2).

The difference is therefore lexical and class-based, not graphic. Strong *wacan* ‘wake’ ‘wake up, arise’ and weak *wacian* ‘wake’ ‘be awake, watch’ belong to related but distinct histories.

Old English evidence Clark Hall lists *wacan* ‘wake’ and *wacian* ‘wake’ as separate headwords (Clark Hall 1960, 338). Bosworth-Toller cautions under *wacan* ‘wake’: the simplex infinitive itself does not occur, its place seeming to be taken by *wæcnan* ‘wake’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 226).

The target *wacan* ‘wake’ is therefore best understood as a normalized strong headword for the verb family, not as a directly quoted simplex infinitive. It still remains the correct Old English comparison form for the strong branch.

Development to Old English With strong **wákanq* ‘wake’, Anglo-Frisian brightening first gives a form of the **wækanq* ‘wake’ type. A-restoration then returns *a*, and the ordinary tail reductions yield *wacan* ‘wake’. The weak verb *wacian* ‘wake’ belongs to a different prehistory and is not the expected outcome of this input.

Class comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the strong and weak verb lines.

Formation / class	Candidate input	OE outcome or comparison	Result
weak class-III / class-II branch	<i>*wakēnq</i> , <i>*wakai-</i> ~ <i>*wakja-</i>	OE <i>wacian</i> ‘wake’ and related weak forms	related lexeme, but not the target of this entry
strong class-VI branch	<i>*wákanq</i>	regular output: <i>wacan</i> ‘wake’	Old English-facing input
strong normalized headword	<i>wacan</i> ‘wake’	dictionary comparison form beside attested strong-family forms	correct Old English comparator, though not a directly quoted simplex infinitive

water — OE *wæter*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **wátnq*; form followed here **wátōr* > *wæter* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wátōr*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	<i>*wætær</i>
PWGmc Final Or Lowering	<i>*wátar</i>	OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*wæter</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *wæter*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs a heteroclitic noun **watar-* ~ **watan-* and states that the Proto-Germanic material points to **watōr* ‘water’ and **watanaz* ‘water’ (Kroonen 2013, 616). Ringe and Taylor likewise start from singular **wator* ‘water’ before the Old English branch (Ringe and Taylor 2014, sect. 3.1.4).

The generalized comparative label is therefore broader than the singular form that actually corresponds to Old English *wæter* ‘water’. The relevant comparator is the inherited nominative-accusative singular **wátōr* ‘water’.

Old English evidence Bright gives the noun as *wæter* ‘water’ with the regular paradigm *wæteres* ‘water (gen.)’, *wætere* ‘water (dat.)’, *wæter(u)*, *wætera* ‘water (gen.pl.)’, *wæterum* ‘water (dat.pl.)’ (Bright 1971, 29). Ringe and Taylor add the dialectal contrast between West Saxon *weeter* ‘water’ and Mercian *weter* ‘water’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, sect. 6.5.2).

The target is therefore an attested Old English citation form within a normal paradigm. The complication lies on the comparative side of the lexeme, not in Old English attestation.

Development to Old English From **wátōr* ‘water’, pre-final *ō* becomes *a*, yielding **watar* ‘water’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, sect. 3.1.4). Anglo-Frisian brightening then gives **wætær* ‘water’, and merger of unstressed *æ/e* yields *wæter* ‘water’.

Stage comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the generalized lexeme label from the singular input that matches the Old English citation form.

Stage or notation	Candidate form	OE relation	Result
generalized comparative label	<i>*wátnq</i>	broader lexeme shorthand, not the singular that corresponds directly to <i>wæter</i> ‘water’	useful background only
heteroclitic stem notation	<i>*watar-</i> ~ <i>*watan-</i>	source-faithful comparative reconstruction	explains why a singular comparator is needed
inherited singular input	<i>*wátōr</i>	regular output: <i>wæter</i> ‘water’	Old English-facing input

whale — OE *hwæl*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **wálaz*; form followed here **xwálaz* > *hwæl* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xwálaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*xwál</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*xwála</i>	EAF Brightening	<i>*xwæł</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *hwæł*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The comparative sources are not uniform. Orel gives **xwalaz* ‘whale’ and notes some mixed **xwaliz* ‘whale’ evidence (Orel 2003, 197). Kroonen instead cites **hwali-* (Kroonen 2013, 262).

Both notations agree on inherited initial *hw-/xw-*, but they differ in stem label. The a-stem-like input followed here is closer to Orel’s notation than to Kroonen’s citation form.

Old English evidence Clark Hall lemmatizes the noun as *hwal* ‘whale’, and Bosworth-Toller preserves plural *hwalas* ‘whales’ (Clark Hall 1960, 170; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 326). The comparison form is normalized here as *hwæł* ‘whale’ for the singular citation form with Anglo-Frisian fronting.

The plural *hwalas* ‘whales’ supplies control evidence. It shows the same lexeme with *a* in an open syllable beside singular *hwæł* ‘whale’ in a closed monosyllable.

Development to Old English From **xwálaz* ‘whale’, final *-z* disappears and bare final *-a* is lost. Anglo-Frisian fronting then yields *æ* in the closed monosyllable, and Old English orthography writes *hwæł* ‘whale’.

Formation comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the competing comparative notations from the normalized Old English singular.

Comparative line	Candidate form	OE relation	Result
Orel’s citation	<i>*xwalaz</i>	same stem notation as the modeled singular line	closest comparative support for the derivational input
Kroonen’s citation	<i>*hwali-</i>	same initial cluster, different stem label	important comparative rival, but not the notation followed here
modeled input	<i>*xwálaz</i>	regular output: <i>hwæł</i> ‘whale’	Old English-facing input
plural control	<i>hwalas</i> ‘whales’	attested open-syllable plural beside singular <i>hwæł</i> ‘whale’	confirms that the lexeme also preserves an <i>a</i> -vocalism branch

whine — OE *hwīnan*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **wainōjanq*; form followed here **xwīnanq* > *hwīnan* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xwīnanq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*xwīnan</i>
[no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*xwīnqn</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*xwīnan</i>
[no change]		

Old English form: *hwīnan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The citation reconstruction preserved in the header belongs to the lament-family verb seen in German *weinen* ‘whine’ and Old English *wānian* ‘wane’. Kroonen instead separates Old English *hwīnan* ‘whine’ under **hwīnan-* (Kroonen 2013, 267). Orel likewise distinguishes strong **xwinanan* ‘whine’ from weak **wainōjanan* ‘whine’ (Orel 2003, 201). Ringe and Taylor make the same split at the Northwest Germanic level, linking Old Norse *hvina* ‘whine’ and Old English *hwīnan* ‘whine’ to the same strong verb (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 130).

The two families also differ phonologically and morphologically. The lament family has initial *w-*, diphthongal *ai*, and weak-II morphology, whereas the verb behind Old English *hwīnan* ‘whine’ has initial *hw-/xw-*, long *ī*, and strong-verb inflection. The derivational input **xwīnanq* ‘whine’ therefore represents a competing comparative identification rather than a hidden cell of **wainōjanq* ‘whine’.

Old English evidence Clark Hall records *hwīnan* ‘whine’ with the gloss ‘to hiss, whizz, whistle’ (Clark Hall 1960, 171). Seebold keeps the verb among the strong verbs and notes that only a present-tense attestation is directly preserved (Seebold 1970, 280).

The Old English form is normalized here as *hwīnan* ‘whine’. That normalization adds the usual vowel length marking to the dictionary spelling *hwīnan* ‘whine’; it does not turn an unattested verb into a reconstructed one.

Development to Old English Once the strong-verb input **xwīnanq* ‘whine’ is selected, the path to Old English is straightforward. The compact trace shows heavy-syllable nasal apocope, secondary nasalization, and weak-tail reduction, after which the form surfaces as *hwīnan* ‘whine’.

No special paradigm maneuver is needed for this verb. The comparison is between two different Germanic verb families: the Old English form belongs with the strong verb **hwīnan-*, not with the weak lament verb.

Verb-family comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the competing comparative labels that stand behind the inherited Old English forms.

Verb family / interpretation	Candidate input	Old English outcome or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
lament-family weak verb	<i>*wainōjanq</i>	comparative continuation in OE <i>wānian</i> ‘wane’	<i>wānian</i> ‘wane’	competing citation reconstruction, but not the source of <i>hwīnan</i>
selected strong verb	<i>*xwīnanq</i>	regular output: <i>hwīnan</i> ‘whine’	<i>hwīnan</i> ‘whine’	exact match between derivational input and OE verb

Verb family / interpretation	Candidate input	Old English outcome or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
comparative North Germanic cognate	Northwest Germanic strong verb behind ON <i>hvina</i> ‘whine’ / OE <i>hwinan</i> ‘whine’	ON <i>hvina</i> ‘whine’ / OE <i>hwinan</i> ‘whine’	<i>hwīnan</i> ‘whine’	supports the strong-verb identification

withy — OE *wīþig*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **wáiθiz*; form followed here **wīθagq* > *wīþig* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wīθagq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope OE Velar Palatalization OE Unstressed AE Merger OE Late Unstressed Ag Suffix
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	
	<i>*wīθægq</i> <i>*wīθæg</i> <i>*wīθæð</i> <i>*wīθedð</i> <i>*wīθidð</i>

Old English form: *wīþig*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The comparative evidence groups the word with Germanic forms of the **wīþja* ‘withy’ (or **wīþjō-* variant) or **wīþ-* type (Orel 2003, 503). These forms establish the cognate set but do not by themselves explain the Old English suffix of *wīþig* ‘withy’.

For Old English, the relevant point is the suffix history. Campbell’s account of OE *-ig*, including forms such as *hunig*, supports an analysis in which the *-ig* of *wīþig* ‘withy’ continues a derivational **-ag-* sequence rather than a heavy ja-stem **-ij-* (Campbell 1959, sects 275, 376). The derivational input **wīθagq* ‘withy’ is thus a formation choice rather than a mere respelling of the comparative headword.

Old English evidence Clark Hall records the noun as *wiðig* ‘withy’ (Clark Hall 1960, 358). The form used here, *wīþig* ‘withy’, is a normalized Old English spelling with macrons and palatal *ð* marked explicitly.

The relevant comparison form is therefore not a reconstructed dictionary convenience but an established Old English noun. What requires explanation is why the selected Proto-Germanic input is **wīθagq* ‘withy’ rather than a comparative headword of the **wīþja* ‘withy’ type.

Development to Old English From **wīθagq* ‘withy’, Anglo-Frisian brightening gives a fronted vowel in the suffixal syllable, and, on the Campbell analysis adopted here, the later Old English development of **-ag-* yields *-ig* (Campbell 1959, sects 275, 376). Palatalization supplies the final *ð*, and the full development reaches *wīþig* ‘withy’.

This derivation is regular for the form compared here. The central claim of the entry is therefore morphological: Old English *wīþig* ‘withy’ belongs with an **-ag-* derivative, whereas the comparative **wīþja* ‘withy’ label belongs to a different way of presenting the cognate family.

Formation comparison The comparison below sets the relevant formations side by side. It distinguishes the comparative headword from the Old English-facing formation that actually yields the attested noun.

Formation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
comparative family label	* <i>wáiθiz</i>	broader cognate-set headword	OE family context	useful lexeme label, but not the direct source of <i>wīþig</i>
heavy ja-stem analysis	* <i>wīþja</i> ‘withy’ type	Campbell/Adamczyński style heavy ja-stem -e / zero outcome	* <i>wīþig</i> ‘withy’	does not account cleanly for the OE suffix
*-ag- derivative followed here	* <i>wíþagą</i>	regular output: <i>wīþig</i> ‘withy’	<i>wīþig</i> ‘withy’	exact match between formation and target

world — OE *weorold*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **wira-aldiz*; form followed here **wir-aldū* > *weorold* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wiraldū*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Inter Stress Raising	* <i>wéruldu</i>
PNWGMc I Lowering	* <i>wéraldū</i>	OE Back Mutation	* <i>wéoruldu</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE High Vowel Apocope	* <i>wéoruld</i>
[no change]		OE Med Unstressed U Lowering	* <i>wéorold</i>

Old English form: *weorold*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The word is the old compound ‘age of men’. Orel and the **wira-* tradition reconstruct the older *i*-vocalism, while Ringe and Taylor discuss the lowered form **weraldiz* ‘world’ and its pre-Old-English chain **weraldū* ‘world’ > **weruld* ‘world’ (Orel 2003, 501; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 341). Kluge-Seebold likewise gives the compound **wira-aldō* ‘world’ and explicitly includes Old English *weorold* ‘world’ (Kluge 2011, 981).

The derivational input **wir-aldū* ‘world’ therefore combines the older **wir-* vowel of the comparative headword with the early shift of the compound into the *ō*-stems that Ringe and Taylor note for this lexeme (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 341). The early analogical step lies in that stem-class reassignment; the later phonological developments can then run regularly.

Old English evidence Old English does not preserve a single isolated form. Ringe and Taylor give West Saxon *weorold* ‘world’ ~ *worold* ‘world’, Mercian *weoruld* ‘world’, Northumbrian *woruld* ‘world’, and Kentish *wiarald* ‘world’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 341). Sievers-Brunner and Bright present the same wider set, including the syncopated *world* ‘world’ and later rounded *wuorold* ‘world’ (Brunner 1965, sect. 113; Bright 1971, 465).

The Old English form used here is the West Saxon form *weorold* ‘world’. It is an attested Old English form within that broader variant cluster, not the only form the lexeme ever shows.

Development to Old English From the derivational input **wir-aldū* ‘world’, Northwest Germanic *i*-lowering gives **wér-aldū* ‘world’. Inter-stress raising then changes the medial *a* to *u*, producing **wér-uldu* ‘world’. In the Old English branch that unstressed *u* lowers to *o*, and back mutation yields **wéor-oldū* ‘world’; final high-vowel apocope then gives *weorold* ‘world’.

This sequence matches the comparative background in Ringe and Taylor’s literature-stage chain for the word while preserving the **wir-* notation of the comparative label (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 341). The modeled Old English form therefore stands at the meeting point of an early stem-class reshaping and later regular sound change.

Stage comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the comparative headword from the OE-facing stage chosen for the derivation.

Stage / interpretation	Candidate form	Old English outcome or comparison	Relevance to this entry
comparative compound with older first-element vowel	<i>*wíra-aldiz</i>	citation reconstruction / lexeme label	preserves the older <i>*wir-</i> tradition of the compound
literature-stage lowered compound after early stem-class shift	<i>*weraldiz > *weraldu > *weruld</i>	Ringe-Taylor background chain to OE <i>weorold</i> ‘world’ ~ <i>worold</i> ‘world’	explains the older comparative literature cited for the word
Old English-facing input	<i>*wír-aldu</i>	regular output: <i>weorold</i> ‘world’	exact match for the West Saxon form used here
broader OE variant cluster	—	<i>worold</i> ‘world’, <i>weoruld</i> ‘world’, <i>woruld</i> ‘world’, <i>wiarald</i> ‘world’, <i>world</i> ‘world’	real attested comparanda that remain outside that West Saxon line

youth — OE *geogub*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **júgunθiz*; form followed here **júgunθ > geogub* (early analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **júgunθ*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*júguθ</i>
EAF Nasal Spirant Lengthening	<i>*júgūnθ</i>		
EAF Nasal Spirant Loss	<i>*júgūθ</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *geogub*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The wider etymological tradition reconstructs an earlier form of the word as **ju(w)unþi-*. The comparative label **júgunθiz* ‘youth’ already stands at a later Germanic stage with *g*, and the derivational input **júgunθ* ‘youth’ is later again: it represents the form after final *-i* has been lost.

Ringe and Taylor explicitly give the sequence **jugunþi* ‘youth’ > **jugub* ‘youth’ > OE *geogub* ~ *iugub* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 141). The derivational input therefore differs from the broader comparative headword because the Old English development must begin after early loss of final *-i*.

Old English evidence The Old English noun is attested with varying spellings. Ringe and Taylor cite *geogub* ‘youth’ ~ *iugub* ‘youth’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 141). The form is normalized here as

ġeogup ‘youth’: the initial palatal is written with *ġ*, and the attested spelling variation is treated as orthographic rather than lexical.

Nothing in the source stack suggests that a different paradigm cell should be chosen. The relevant Old English comparison form is the noun *ġeogup* ‘youth’ itself.

Development to Old English The decisive early step is the loss of final *-i* before the Old English umlaut stage. If that high vowel remained, the word would develop an over-umlauted y-type vowel instead of the attested form (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 141).

From the derivational input **júgunθ* ‘youth’, the later development is regular: palatal fronting yields **jéugunθ* ‘youth’; nasal-spirant lengthening and loss give **jéogūθ* ‘youth’ (Fulk 2018, 109); unstressed long-vowel shortening then produces **jéoguθ* ‘youth’, which surfaces as *ġeogup* ‘youth’. Campbell preserves *u* after accented *u* in forms such as *dugup* ‘troop’ and *munuc* ‘monk’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 374). Brunner likewise cites *iuzuð* ‘youth’ and *munuc* ‘monk’ under the same development (Brunner 1965, sect. 150.3).

Stage comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the broader comparative headword from the later stages relevant to the Old English noun.

Stage / interpretation	Candidate form	Old English outcome or comparison	Relevance to this entry
earlier etymological headword	<i>*ju(w)unþi-</i>	comparative family background	older comparative reconstruction of the lexeme
later g-bearing comparative label	<i>*júgunθiz</i>	citation reconstruction / lexeme label	preserves the later Germanic stage behind the selected entry
Old English-facing input	<i>*júgunθ</i>	regular output: <i>ġeogup</i>	exact match for the Old English form used here
full <i>-i</i> stage retained too long	<i>*jugunþi</i>	expected over-umlauted y-type result	negative control showing why early <i>-i</i> loss must precede the OE umlaut stage

Part IV. Late analogy and paradigm-cell selection

These Old English forms continue a particular paradigm cell or a later analogical remodeling, not the unaltered citation form. The phonology may be regular once the proper morphological history has been identified.

ban — OE *bannes*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **bánnq*; form followed here **bánnas* > *bannes* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bánnas*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	EAF Brightening	<i>*bánnæs</i>
[no change]	OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*bánnes</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Old English form: *bannes*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel cites a bann-noun under **bannan* ‘ban’, while Seebold distinguishes bann-stems of both masculine and neuter type and gives Old English *gebann* ‘ban’ as the noun reflex (Orel 2003, 35; Seebold 1970, 89). The citation reconstruction **bánnq* ‘ban’ names the lexeme, but the comparison here turns on the genitive singular **bánnas* ‘ban’.

The analysis therefore depends on medial, not final, gemination.

Old English evidence Old English lexicographic evidence securely supports the noun itself. Bosworth-Toller records the noun under nominative *ge-bann* ‘ban’, with oblique usage such as *gebanne* ‘ban’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 303). The exact unprefixd genitive *bannes* ‘ban’ is less directly cited in the dictionaries, so it is best treated here as the regular genitive form used for comparison rather than as a dictionary headword.

Development to Old English From **bánnas* ‘ban’, the geminate remains medial before the case ending and the unstressed vowel develops regularly to give *bannes* ‘ban’. The paradigm comparison therefore sets the genitive against nominative *ban* ‘ban’, the ordinary nominative form of the same noun, rather than against a directly cited genitive headword.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It shows why the genitive singular is the conservative cell used for the entry.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
citation nominative singular	<i>*bánnq</i>	regular output: <i>ban</i>	<i>ban</i>	regular nominative outcome, but not the Old English form here
genitive singular	<i>*bánnas</i>	regular output: <i>bannes</i>	<i>bannes</i>	direct match for the conservative genitive

berry — OE *berges*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **bázjq*; form followed here **bázjas* > *berges* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bázjas*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	<i>*bærjæs</i>
EAF Rhotacism	<i>*bárjas</i>	OE I Umlaut	<i>*berjæs</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*berjes</i>
[no change]			

Old English form: *berġes*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the berry noun as **basja- ~ *bazja-* (Kroonen 2013, 54). The derivational input **bázjas* ‘berry’ is therefore not a rival lexeme headword, but a specific genitive singular cell drawn from that paradigm.

The relevant point is that **rj* did not geminate in Proto-West Germanic. Ringe and Taylor’s *here* ‘army’, *herges* ‘army’s’ comparison shows the same *rj* environment in an Old English paradigm without any hidden gemination repair (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 181).

Old English evidence Campbell cites feminine *berige* ‘berry’ and notes that *-j-* is retained after *r* in this type (Campbell 1959, 250). The reviewed evidence therefore supports the citation form more directly than the exact genitive *berġes* ‘berry’, which is best read here as the regular genitive comparison form rather than as a dictionary headword.

Development to Old English Citation **bázja* ‘berry’ gives *bere* ‘berry (variant)’, not the Old English form here. The genitive singular **bázjas* ‘berry’, however, gives *berġes* ‘berry’, with medial *-rġ-* preserved in the same way that Ringe and Taylor cite *herges* ‘army’s’ beside *here* ‘army’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 181). This points to paradigm choice rather than to an extra phonological rule.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It shows the contrast between the citation form and the genitive singular cell.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
citation nominative singular	<i>*bázja</i>	regular output: <i>bere</i>	<i>berige / berġe</i>	useful citation-form background, but not the Old English form here
genitive singular	<i>*bázjas</i>	regular output: <i>berġes</i>	<i>berġes</i>	exact match for the conservative cell

bow — OE *bēag*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **béuganq*; form followed here **báug > bēag* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **báug*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Au Brightening	* <i>báeug</i>
[no change]	OE Diphthong Leveling	* <i>bēag</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Old English form: *bēag*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The inherited verb belongs to the class-II strong-verb family **béuganq* ‘bow’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 55). Within that paradigm, however, the infinitive and the singular preterite continue different ablaut grades. The derivational input **báug* ‘bow’ is the singular preterite cell, whereas the citation form **béuganq* is the infinitive.

Campbell’s account of Old English class-II strong verbs treats the singular preterite *au* > *ēa* development as regular in this environment (Campbell 1959, 53). That is the phonological path relevant for *bēag* ‘bowed’, whereas the analogical *ū* of the present stem belongs to the separate history behind *būgan* ‘to bow’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 55).

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller and Clark Hall both record *bēag* ‘bowed’ as a preterite form of *būgan* ‘to bow’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 122; Clark Hall 1960, 45). The form discussed here is therefore an attested Old English verbal form, not a reconstructed substitute for the infinitive.

The ordinary dictionary headword remains *būgan* ‘to bow’, but the relevant comparison form for this entry is the singular preterite *bēag* ‘bow, ring’ ‘bowed’. That is the paradigm cell in which the inherited **au* grade is preserved most directly.

Development to Old English From **báug* ‘bow’, Anglo-Frisian fronting and the later leveling of the diphthong produce *bēag* ‘bow, ring’ (Campbell 1959, 53). No special analogical repair is needed for that cell. The form is the regular Old English outcome of the singular-preterite grade.

The analogical element in the wider lexeme belongs instead to the present stem seen in *būgan* ‘bow, bend’. The derivational input differs from the citation form because the regular inherited pathway survives more transparently in the preterite than in the infinitive.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the regular singular preterite from the more familiar infinitival citation form.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
citation infinitive	* <i>béuganq</i>	inherited present-stem history behind <i>būgan</i>	<i>būgan</i>	establishes the lexeme, but not the Old English form here
singular preterite	* <i>báug</i>	regular output: <i>bēag</i>	<i>bēag</i>	exact match between input, output, and attested cell
past participial branch	participial * <i>bugan-</i> type	later participial outcomes	bogen-type evidence	relevant to the paradigm, but not the clearest match for this entry

The singular preterite is the relevant comparison form. It gives a direct lautgesetzlich path to attested *bēag* ‘bow, ring’, while the citation form *būgan* ‘bow, bend’ belongs to a paradigm whose present stem has already undergone later leveling.

cow — OE *cȳ*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **kōz*; form followed here **kūi* > *cȳ* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **kūi*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE I Umlaut	<i>*kȳi</i>
[no change]		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*kȳ</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *cȳ*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs a root noun with the inherited alternation **kō-* ~ **ku-*, explicitly nom. **kōz* ‘cow’, obl. **kū-* (Kroonen 2013, 299). The citation form therefore belongs to the nominative singular, whereas the derivational input **kūi* ‘cow’ belongs to the oblique stem.

Ringe and Taylor also posit a later PNWGMc nominative **kūaz* ‘cow’ > **kūz* ‘cow’ behind Old English *cū* ‘cow’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, sect. 3.1.3). That nominative history accounts for the headword, whereas the form *cȳ* ‘cow’ depends on the oblique **kū-* stem and a following **i*.

Old English evidence Clark Hall lemmatizes the noun under *cū* ‘cow’ and records gen.sg. *cū* ‘cow’ (or *cū(e)*), *cȳ* ‘cow’, *cūs* ‘cow (gen.)’, dat.sg. *cȳ* ‘cow’, nom.-acc.pl. *cȳ* ‘cow’, and dat.pl. *cūm* ‘cow’ (Clark Hall 1960, 67). Ringe and Taylor likewise state that the root-noun *cū* ‘cow’ exhibits dat.sg., nom.-acc.pl. *cȳ* ‘cow’ < **cūi* ‘cow’, dat.pl. *cūm* < **cūm*, and apparently gen.sg. *cā* ‘cow (gen.)’ < **cūiz* ‘cow (gen.)’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, sect. 6.6.1).

The dictionary headword is therefore *cū* ‘cow’, but *cȳ* ‘cow’ is an established Old English paradigm form rather than a convenient reconstruction. It serves as dative singular and also as nominative-accusative plural. The genitive singular is less stable, with *cā* ‘cow (gen.sg.)’, *cȳ* ‘cow’, *cū(e)*, and *cūs* ‘cow (gen.sg.)’ all appearing in the local source record.

Development to Old English **kūi* ‘cow’ is the dative singular of the oblique **kū-* stem. The following **i* triggers i-umlaut, so *ū* becomes *ȳ*, and loss of the final high vowel leaves *cȳ* ‘cow’. The development is **kūi* ‘cow’ > **kȳi* ‘cow’ > **kȳ* ‘cow’ > *cȳ*.

This is the regular oblique-cell path recognized by Ringe and Taylor’s paradigm statement (Ringe and Taylor 2014, sect. 6.6.1). It also explains why *cȳ* ‘cow’ is the cleanest comparison form for the present entry, even though the ordinary headword is *cū* ‘cow’.

Paradigm comparison A paradigm comparison identifies the Proto-Germanic inflectional cell that corresponds to an established Old English paradigm form. The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
citation nominative singular	*kōz	OE headword <i>cū</i> ‘cow’ belongs to the nominative history of the lexeme	<i>cū</i>	useful background, but not the chosen comparison for <i>cȳ</i> ‘cow’
later generalized nominative	PNWGmc <i>kūaz</i> > <i>kūz</i>	inferred nominative <i>cū</i> ‘cow’	<i>cū</i>	explains the leveled headword, not the oblique target
dative singular oblique	*kūi	regular output: <i>cȳ</i> ‘cow’	<i>cȳ</i>	exact match between input, output, and paradigm cell
genitive singular oblique	*kūiz	Ringe-Taylor: apparently <i>cā</i> ‘cow (gen.sg.)’; Hall: <i>cū(e)</i> , <i>cȳ</i> , <i>cūs</i>	gen.sg. variable	too unstable to control the entry

The dative singular is the relevant comparison form. It gives a regular path to attested *cȳ* ‘cow’, while the broader Old English paradigm shows how far the oblique **kū-* grade spread beyond that one cell.

find — OE *fundene*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **fīnθanq*; form followed here **fūnðanō* > *fundene* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fūnðanō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Unstressed Fronting Early	<i>*fūndænō</i>
PWGmc Dental Hardening	<i>*fūndanō</i>	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*fūndænæ</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*fūndene</i>
[no change]			

Old English form: *fundene*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The inherited verb is the strong verb **fīnθanq* ‘find’, continued by Old English *findan* ‘find’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 344). The form followed here, **fūnðanō* ‘find’, belongs to the past-participial paradigm rather than to the infinitive. It represents an oblique singular form of the participle.

The familiar dictionary form *funden* ‘found’ is not the form compared here. The derivational input instead models an attested participial form directly, rather than treating the infinitive or the ordinary dictionary headword as primary. It therefore reaches *fundene* ‘found (p.p.)’ in the form where the trace and the attested evidence match directly.

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller records *fundene* ‘found (p.p.)’ ‘found’ under *findan* ‘find’, citing the form in *Beón þá herigeata swa fundene* (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 219). Clark Hall likewise preserves the participial stem in forms such as *funden* ‘found’ and *tō-fundennes* ‘finding’ (Clark Hall 1960, 124).

The ordinary dictionary headword for the participle is *funden* ‘found’, but the relevant comparison form for this entry is the attested oblique *fundene* ‘found (p.p.)’ ‘found’. It is an Old English form in its own right, not a merely convenient probe.

Development to Old English From **fūnðanō* ‘find’, the participial oblique develops through regular loss and weakening of the final ending, yielding *fundene* ‘found (p.p.)’. In that cell both the consonantism and the medial vowel history remain regular.

The broader participial paradigm fixes the interpretation. The more familiar nominative *funden* ‘found (p.p.)’ is the ordinary dictionary form, whereas the oblique form *fundene* ‘found (p.p.)’ is the attested form compared here.

Paradigm comparison

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
citation infinitive	<i>*fīnθanq</i>	inherited verb <i>findan</i>	<i>findan</i>	establishes the lexeme, but not the form compared here important paradigm background, but not the form compared here exact match between input, output, and attested cell
nominative participial line	<i>*fūnðanaz</i>	ordinary dictionary <i>funden</i> type	<i>funden</i>	
oblique participle compared here	<i>*fūnðanō</i>	regular output: <i>fundene</i>	<i>fundene</i>	

The oblique participle is the relevant comparison form. It matches the derivational input and Old English form directly, while the nominative participial headword remains a different presentation cell within the same paradigm.

fright — OE *fyrhte*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **furxtīn*; form followed here **fūrxtīnaz* > *fyrhte* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fūrxtīnaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*fūrxtīn</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*fūrxtīna</i>	OE I Umlaut	<i>*fyrxtīn</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		NWGmc In Stem N Loss	<i>*fyrxtī</i>
[no change]		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*fyrxti</i>
		OE Med Unstressed I Lowering ¹	<i>*fyrxte</i>

Old English form: *fyrhte*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The noun belongs to the inherited in-stem abstract **furxtīn* ‘fright’, the same family as Gothic *faurhteī* ‘fear, fright’ (Orel 2003, 120). The derivational input **fūrxtīnaz* ‘fright’ is not a different lexeme but an oblique singular cell within that in-stem paradigm.

Ringe and Taylor treat the later nominative forms with *-u* or *-o* as analogically remodeled (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 395–96). I therefore use the oblique in-stem form, which continues the older formation rather than the remodeled nominative.

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller records *fyrhte* ‘fright’ with textual attestation, and it also records nominative forms such as *fyrhtu* ‘fright’ and *fyrhto* ‘fright’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 160). Clark Hall lists adjective and verb material separately under *fyrht* / *fyrhtan* (Clark Hall 1960, 141).

The relevant comparison form is therefore the attested oblique *fyrhte* ‘fright’. The nominative lemma forms remain part of the Old English evidence, but the Old English form here of this entry is the oblique cell.

Development to Old English From **fūrxtīnaz* ‘fright’, the oblique in-stem develops through the loss and weakening of the final ending, yielding *fyrhte* ‘fright’. The form compared here therefore follows the ordinary Old English reduction of the abstract ending in this paradigm.

The later nominative forms with *-u* or *-o* belong to a subsequent analogical reshaping of the paradigm. The Old English form here is earlier in that sense: it is the attested OE cell in which the inherited in-stem development remains most transparent.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the attested oblique form from the later remodeled nominative line.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
citation in-stem headword	<i>*fūrxtīn</i>	broader noun-class label	wider family context	useful lexeme label, but not the cell compared here
remodeled nominative line	nominative in-stem forms	<i>fyrhtu</i> ‘fright’ / <i>fyrhto</i> ‘fright’ type lemma forms	<i>fyrhtu</i> ‘fright’ / <i>fyrhto</i> ‘fright’	genuine OE evidence, but later remodeled
selected oblique singular	<i>*fūrxtīnaz</i>	regular output: <i>fyrhte</i> ‘fright’	<i>fyrhte</i> ‘fright’	exact match between input, output, and attested cell

The oblique in-stem form is the relevant comparison form. It yields attested *fyrhte* ‘fright’ directly, while the more familiar nominative forms belong to a later analogical layer.

hammer — OE *hameres*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **xámaraz*; form followed here **xámaras* > *hameres* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xámaras*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*xámæraes</i> <i>*xámeres</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]		

Old English form: *hameres*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The inherited noun is the masculine a-stem **xámaraz* ‘hammer’, reflected in Old English citation forms such as *hamor* ‘hammer’ and *hamer* ‘hammer’ (Kroonen 2013, 206; Orel 2003, 197; Clark Hall 1960, 160). The derivational input **xámaras* ‘hammer’ is the genitive singular of that same noun rather than a different lexeme.

The citation tradition is already mixed in its unstressed vowel, while the genitive singular gives a closer comparison form. This is a cell choice within one paradigm, not a change of stem class.

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller directly records *hameres* ‘hammer’ in an Old English genitival phrase (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 78). Clark Hall preserves the simplex headword as *hamer* ‘hammer’ / *hamor* ‘hammer’ (Clark Hall 1960, 160).

Sievers-Brunner gives a paradigm line *hamor* ‘hammer’ — *hamores* ‘hammer’, which shows that the oblique tradition itself was not entirely uniform (Brunner 1965, sect. 245). The relevant comparison form here is the attested genitive singular *hameres* ‘hammer’.

Development to Old English From **xámaras* ‘hammer’, Anglo-Frisian brightening and the subsequent merger of unstressed *æ* with *e* yield *hameres* ‘hammer’. The derivation of that oblique form is straightforward once the genitive singular cell is selected.

The noun as a whole retains a mixed citation tradition in *hamor* ‘hammer’ and *hamer* ‘hammer’, and the selected oblique cell avoids making that variation carry the argument of the entry.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the attested genitive singular from the less stable citation tradition.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
citation nominative singular	<i>*xámaraz</i>	regular citation form <i>hamer</i> / <i>hamor</i>	<i>hamor</i> / <i>hamer</i>	good lexical background, but not the Old English form here
genitive singular	<i>*xámaras</i>	regular output: <i>hameres</i>	<i>hameres</i>	exact match between input, output, and attested cell
later oblique tradition	oblique a-stem forms	<i>hamores</i> type evidence	<i>hamores</i>	attested background variant, but not the chosen comparison form

have — OE *hæfep*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **xabēnq*; form followed here **xábēθi* > *hæfep* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **xábēθi*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	* <i>xabēθ</i>
PWGmc Early I Apocope	* <i>xábēθ</i>	OE Velar Fricative Palatalization	* <i>çabēθ</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		PGmc B Allophony	* <i>çæβēθ</i>
[no change]		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	* <i>çæβeθ</i>

Old English form: *hæfeþ*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The verb belongs to the inherited class-III weak paradigm usually cited under **xabēnq* ‘have’ and Old English *habban* ‘have’ (Kroonen 2013, 237; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 93). Within that paradigm, however, the infinitive and the singular present indicative do not continue the same stem. Ringe and Taylor distinguish a *-ja-* stem in the infinitive from a non-geminating *-ai-* / *-ē-* stem in the 2sg and 3sg present forms (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 93).

The derivational input **xábēθi* ‘have’ is therefore the 3sg present cell rather than a rephrasing of the infinitive. For the present analysis, that finite cell is the cleaner comparator for the inherited non-geminating stem.

Old English evidence The ordinary Old English headword is *habban* ‘have’ (Clark Hall 1960, 157). Campbell’s Anglian paradigm includes unsynocopated 3sg forms of the *hæfed* ‘has’ type, and the present paradigm therefore shows forms of the *hæf-* type that support the normalized target *hæfeþ* ‘has’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 762).

The target form is therefore a normalized finite cell rather than the ordinary dictionary lemma. It represents the inherited non-geminating present stem more directly than *habban* ‘have’ does.

Development to Old English From **xábēθi* ‘have’, the finite form yields *hæfeþ* ‘has’ regularly. Ringe and Taylor discuss this non-geminating present stem under *habban* ‘have’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 364). Campbell’s Anglian paradigms include unsynocopated 3sg forms of the *hæfeþ* ‘has’ / *hæfed* ‘has’ type (Campbell 1959, sect. 762).

The wider lexeme is less straightforward only because the infinitive *habban* ‘have’ shows later leveling. The 3sg present cell is therefore the closer comparison form.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the analogically leveled citation form from the regular 3sg present line.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
citation infinitive	<i>-ja-</i> stem of * <i>xabēnq</i>	citation form <i>habban</i>	<i>habban</i>	important headword, but shaped by later leveling
3sg present	* <i>xábēθi</i>	regular output: <i>hæfeþ</i>	<i>hæfeþ</i>	exact match between input, output, and finite form
synocopated finite tradition	same present stem	<i>hæfþ</i> type evidence	<i>hæfþ</i>	compared here genuine later OE finite form, but not the normalized target used here

live — OE *lifeþ*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **libēnq*; form followed here **libēθi* > *lifeþ* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **libēθi*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	PGmc B Allophony		<i>*liβeθ</i>
PWGmc Early I Apocope	<i>*libēθ</i>	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*liβeθ</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *lifeþ*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The inherited verb belongs to the class-III weak family cited by Kroonen under **libēn-*, reflected in Old English *libban* ‘live’ (Kroonen 2013, 336). Ringe and Taylor show that the paradigm also contained a separate 3sg present stem, continued in late Northumbrian *lifed* ‘lives’, which they treat as an archaism (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 364).

The derivational input **libēθi* ‘live’ therefore represents a finite present cell rather than the citation infinitive. The later lemma tradition also includes remodeled forms such as *lifian* ‘live’.

Old English evidence The ordinary lemma tradition centers on *libban* ‘live’ and, in later remodeling, *lifian* ‘live’. For this entry, however, the relevant comparison form is the archaic 3sg present attested as *lifed* ‘lives’, here normalized as *lifeþ* ‘lives’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 364; Campbell 1959, sect. 762).

The target is thus a normalized finite form, not the ordinary dictionary lemma. It preserves the older present-stem history more clearly than the remodeled lemma tradition does.

Development to Old English From **libēθi* ‘live’, regular reduction of the final syllable and later weakening of the unstressed vowel yield *lifeþ* ‘lives’. The attested spelling *lifed* ‘lives’ belongs to the same finite form in late Northumbrian orthography (Campbell 1959, sect. 762; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 364).

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the archaic finite cell from the ordinary infinitival and later remodeled lemma lines.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
citation infinitive line	<i>*libēnq</i>	OE <i>libban</i> headword tradition	<i>libban</i>	establishes the lexeme, but not the Old English form here
3sg present	<i>*libēθi</i>	regular output: <i>lifeþ</i> ; attested <i>lifed</i>	<i>lifed</i> , normalized here as <i>lifeþ</i>	selected archaic finite cell
later remodeled present tradition	later class-II-type forms	<i>lifian</i> and related finite remodeling	<i>lifian</i>	genuine OE development, but secondary to the cell compared here

man — OE *mannes*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **mánnaz*; form followed here **mánnas* > *mannes* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **mánnas*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	EAF Brightening	<i>*mánnaes</i>
[no change]	OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*mánnes</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Old English form: *mannes*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The lexeme-level reconstruction is not uniform. Kroonen cites **mannan-*, and Orel has **mannz* ‘man’ (Kroonen 2013, 354; Orel 2003, 299). The derivational input **mánnas* ‘man’ belongs to a different level: it is the genitive-singular cell chosen for the Old English comparison.

The target is not the ordinary citation form. Its medial geminate precedes the genitive ending.

Old English evidence Campbell gives the paradigm *mann* ‘man’, *man* ‘man’ / *mannes* ‘man’s’ / *menn* ‘men’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 621). Sievers-Brunner likewise cites *man* ‘man’ *mannes* ‘man’s’ (Brunner 1965, sect. 226). He also explains that word-final simplification underlies forms such as *man* ‘man’ beside inflected *monnes* ‘man’s’ (Brunner 1965, sect. 231). Clark Hall keeps the dictionary headword under *mann* (Clark Hall 1960, 197).

The relevant comparison form is therefore the attested genitive singular *mannes* ‘man’s’, not the citation lemma *mann* ‘man’.

Development to Old English Campbell’s paradigm *mann*, *man* / *mannes* / *menn* ‘men’ confirms the selected genitive singular *mannes* (Campbell 1959, sect. 621). In the present analysis, **mánnas* ‘man’ develops through Anglo-Frisian brightening and later unstressed merger to *mannes*. In this cell the geminate remains medial before *-es*. The citation form behaves differently because word-final gemination was simplified in Old English (Brunner 1965, sect. 231).

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It separates the citation-form line from the genitive singular.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
citation nominative singular	<i>*mannāz</i>	expected citation-form outcome <i>man</i>	<i>mann</i> / <i>monn</i>	establishes the lexeme, but not the Old English form here
accusative singular	<i>*mannq</i>	expected <i>man</i>	<i>man</i>	same word-final simplification as the nominative
dative singular	<i>*mannāi</i>	expected <i>manne</i>	<i>manne</i>	preserves medial <i>nn</i> , but not the chosen cell

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
genitive singular	* <i>mánnas</i>	regular output: <i>mannes</i>	<i>mannes</i>	exact match between input, output, and attested comparator

meed — OE *meorde*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **mizdō*; form followed here **mízdai* > *meorde* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **mízdai*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Breaking	* <i>méordē</i>
PNWGmc Unstressed Ai	* <i>mízdē</i>	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	* <i>méorde</i>
Monophthongization			
PNWGmc I Lowering	* <i>mézdē</i>		
EAF Rhotacism	* <i>mérdē</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *meorde*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The lexeme-level reconstruction is **mizdō* ‘meed’, but the derivational input **mízdai* ‘meed’ is a dative-singular cell rather than the citation form. The Old English evidence for the *meord* ‘meed, reward’ side is oblique.

The wider history of competing *mēd* ‘meed, reward’ remains disputed. Kroonen and Fulk explain it through some form of z-loss and compensatory lengthening (Kroonen 2013, 410; Fulk 2018, 69), while Orel keeps a doublet analysis (Orel 2003, 311). The comparison here concerns the attested oblique line *meorde*.

Old English evidence The directly attested forms are obliques: *meorde* ‘meed’ as a dative singular and *meorda* ‘meed’ as a genitive plural (Bright 1971, 328; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 647). Lexicographers reconstruct a bare nominative *meord* ‘meed’ from those obliques, while West Saxon prose more commonly shows the competing doublet *mēd* ‘meed’ (Clark Hall 1960, 214; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 647).

The target of this entry is therefore the attested oblique *meorde* ‘meed’, not the reconstructed lemma *meord* ‘meed’ and not the better-known West Saxon citation form *mēd* ‘meed’.

Development to Old English Ringe and Taylor give the broader noun history as **mizdo* ‘reward’ > **mizdu* ‘reward’ > OE *meord* ~ *méd* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 99). The fuller oblique-cell path modeled here spells out the intermediate rhotacism, monophthongization, lowering, breaking, and unstressed-shortening steps needed for the selected dative-singular comparison.

This entry therefore follows the attested oblique line within the broader development. It does not depend on a full decision about the history of the competing *mēd* ‘meed, reward’ tradition.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the attested oblique target from the broader lemma history.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Expected or documented OE outcome	OE comparison form	Result
citation nominative singular	* <i>mizdō</i>	inferred lemma outcome <i>meord</i> ‘meed’	<i>meord</i> ‘meed’	useful background, but the bare lemma is reconstructed rather than directly attested
selected dative singular	* <i>mízdai</i>	regular output: <i>meorde</i> ‘meed’	<i>meorde</i> ‘meed’	exact match between derivational input and attested target
genitive singular	* <i>mizdōz</i>	regular output: <i>meorde</i> ‘meed’	<i>meorde</i> ‘meed’	converges on the same attested string, but the dat.sg. has the clearest direct support
genitive plural control	plural oblique line	attested <i>meorda</i> ‘meed’	<i>meorda</i> ‘meed’	confirms the broader oblique tradition, but not the chosen singular target

night — OE *niht*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **náxtz*; form followed here **náxti* > *niht* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **náxti*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening OE Breaking OE I Umlaut
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Ws Palatal Umlaut OE High Vowel Apocope
	* <i>næxti</i> * <i>neaxti</i> * <i>niexti</i> * <i>nixti</i> * <i>nixt</i>

Old English form: *niht*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor cite gen.sg. **nahtiz* ‘night’, dat.sg. **nahti* ‘night’, and nom.pl. **nahtiz* ‘night’ for the high-vowel side of the paradigm, and derive West Saxon *niht* ‘night’ from that side (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 240). The citation reconstruction **náxtz* ‘night’ therefore belongs to the nominative-like headword, while the derivational input **náxti* ‘night’ represents the dative-singular cell.

The word later became the model for endingless datives. Ringe and Taylor explicitly explain forms such as *dæg* ‘day’ by analogy with dat.sg. *niht* < **nahti* ‘night’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 380).

Old English evidence Clark Hall lemmatizes *niht* ‘night’ and cross-references forms such as *neaht* ‘night’, *neht* ‘night’, and *nieht* ‘night’ (Clark Hall 1960, 215). Campbell likewise preserves the fluctuation between *neaht* ‘night’ and *niht* ‘night’, giving genitive *nihte*, *nihtes*, dative *niht*, *nihte*, nominative plural *niht* ‘night’, and the contrasting plural-side forms represented by *nehtas* ‘night’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 628.3).

The comparison form used here is therefore an attested Old English *niht* ‘night’, not a reconstructed substitute. The broader lexical record still preserves the non-umlauted side of the paradigm in *neaht* ‘night’-type forms.

Development to Old English Ringe and Taylor derive West Saxon *niht* ‘night’ from **nahti* ‘night’ via **nehti* ‘night’ and **neahti* ‘night’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 240). Campbell and Brunner preserve the contrasting non-umlauted *neaht* ‘night’-type forms elsewhere in the paradigm (Campbell 1959, sect. 628.3; Brunner 1965, sect. 284).

The modeled path is therefore **náxti* ‘night’ > **næxti* ‘night’ > **neaxti* ‘night’ > **niexti* ‘night’ > **nixti* ‘night’ > *niht*.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It identifies the inherited cell that matches the attested Old English form.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
citation nominative singular	<i>*náxtz</i>	expected non-umlauted outcome <i>neaht</i>	<i>neaht</i>	useful background, but not the comparison used for <i>niht</i>
selected dative singular	<i>*náxti</i>	regular output: <i>niht</i> ‘night’	<i>niht</i> ‘night’	exact match between input, output, and paradigm cell

rest — OE *ræste*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **rastō*; form followed here **rástōz* > *ræste* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **rástōz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Surviving Bimoric O Unrounding	<i>*rástā</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*rástō</i>	EAF Brightening	<i>*ræstā</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*ræstæ</i>
[no change]		OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*ræste</i>

Old English form: *ræste*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen treats the noun as a feminine *ō*-stem **rastō*-, continued by Old English *ræst* ‘rest’ (Kroonen 2013, 445). The derivational input **rástōz* ‘rest’ therefore does not replace the lexeme-level headword. It identifies one oblique singular cell on the side of the paradigm that yields *ræste* ‘rest’.

The source tradition used here labels that cell specifically as genitive singular, but the broader local synthesis of the *ō*-stem paradigm shows that the oblique singulars converge on the same front-vocalic *ræste* ‘rest’ side, in contrast to a nominative singular that would remain *rast* ‘rest’.

Old English evidence The ordinary Old English citation form is *ræst* ‘rest’ (Kroonen 2013, 445). Clark Hall likewise gives *ræst* ‘rest’ (Clark Hall 1960, 239). Bosworth-Toller also preserves oblique uses of *ræste* ‘rest’, including prepositional examples such as *on ræste* ‘at rest’ and *tó ræste* ‘to rest’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 121).

The comparison form used here is therefore an attested oblique *ræste* ‘rest’, not a reconstructed surrogate. The dictionary headword *ræst* ‘rest’ remains an equally real part of the Old English record.

Development to Old English Once final *z is lost, the derivational input moves through the front-vocalic oblique side of the paradigm rather than the back-vocalic nominative side. In the modeled derivation, the surviving final long vowel is first exposed, unrounded, fronted, shortened, and then reduced to the final -e of *ræste* ‘rest’.

The key point is the paradigm split. Nominative **rastō* ‘rest’ yields a regular *rast* ‘rest’, whereas the selected oblique input yields *ræste* ‘rest’. The later citation form *ræst* ‘rest’ is best explained as leveling from that oblique *ræst*- stem.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the nominative citation form from the oblique singular chosen here.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
citation nominative singular	<i>*rastō</i>	expected regular outcome <i>rast</i>	<i>ræst</i> ‘rest’	useful background, but not the cell that matches attested oblique <i>ræste</i>
selected oblique singular	<i>*rástōz</i>	regular output: <i>ræste</i> ‘rest’	<i>ræste</i> ‘rest’	exact match between derivational input and attested OE oblique form

shoulder — OE *sculdrum*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **skuldrō*; form followed here **skuldramiz* > *sculdrum* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **skuldramiz*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Sk Palatalization <i>*fūldrum</i>
PNWGmc A To U Before M	<i>*skūldrumiz</i>
PWGmc Early I Apocope	<i>*skūldrumz</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*skūldrum</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	
[no change]	

Old English form: *sculdrum*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The handbooks do not agree on the reconstruction of the Germanic word. Orel gives **skuldr(j)ō* as a feminine *ō-/jō*-stem and explicitly notes that Old English *sculdor* ‘shoulder’ is masculine beside OFrisian *skulder* ‘shoulder’, Middle Low German *schulder* ‘shoulder’, and Old High German *scultra* ‘shoulder’, *scultirra* ‘shoulder’ (Orel 2003, 345). Kroonen reconstructs **skuldra-*, a masculine a-stem, and derives the Old High German feminine forms from **skuldrjōn-* (Kroonen 2013, 478). Ringe and Taylor cite PWGmc **skuldru* ‘shoulder’ for the Old English branch (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 142).

These forms imply different stem classes and different expectations for the Old English inflection. The question is which inflectional cell best aligns with the Old English evidence.

A dative/instrumental plural form **skúldramiz* ‘shoulder’ aligns with the inherited plural ending that later yields Old English *-um*, and it corresponds directly to the attested dative plural discussed below.

Old English evidence The ordinary Old English headword is *sculdor* ‘shoulder’. Clark Hall lemmatizes *sculdor* ‘shoulder’ as the normal dictionary form (Clark Hall 1960, 257). Bosworth-Toller also preserves the dative plural *sculdrum* ‘shoulder’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 85).

Bosworth-Toller’s Supplement records a weak-feminine *sculdra* ‘shoulder’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 699), so *sculdra* ‘shoulder’ belongs to the Old English record beside the stronger masculine paradigm headed by *sculdor* ‘shoulder’. Brunner and Luick also record later spellings such as *sceoldor* ‘shoulder’ and the i-mutated dative plural *scyldrum* ‘shoulder’, which reflect secondary phonological and analogical reshaping within Old English (Brunner 1965, sect. 92.2.a; Luick 1914–1940, 230).

The singular and plural evidence point to different parts of the paradigm. The relevant comparison form here is the attested dative plural *sculdrum* ‘shoulder (dat.pl.)’. The spelling with *sc-* is a normalized representation of the same Old English initial cluster.

Development to Old English Proto-Germanic **skúldramiz* ‘shoulder’ can be interpreted as a dative/instrumental plural form. In this environment the post-tonic *a* before *m* is raised to *u*, giving a form of the **skúldrumiz* ‘shoulder’ type. Unstressed *u* is regularly preserved before *m*, especially in the dative plural ending *-um*: Campbell states this explicitly, and Hogg formulates the same condition for the dative plural inflexion (Campbell 1959, sect. 373; Hogg 1992b, sect. 3.3.1.3). Brunner points in the same direction by excluding *m* from the environments in which medial *o* became general in West Saxon (Brunner 1965, sect. 44 Anm. 7).

Subsequent reduction of the ending removes the final **i* and **z*, so that the inflectional ending appears in Old English as *-um*. The initial cluster is written here as *sc-*, and the development is **skúldramiz* ‘shoulder’ > **skúldrumiz* ‘shoulder’ > **skúldrum* ‘shoulder’ > *sculdrum* ‘shoulder’.

Paradigm comparison A paradigm comparison identifies the Proto-Germanic inflectional cell that corresponds to an established Old English paradigm form. The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
singular-oriented citation input	<i>*skúldrō</i>	probe output: <i>scoldor</i>	<i>sculdor</i> ‘shoulder’	fails: the singular output has root <i>o</i> , not the attested <i>u</i>
serious plural-based singular alternative	<i>*skúldru</i>	probe output: <i>sculdor</i>	<i>sculdor</i> ‘shoulder’	close formally, but it compares a plural-stage input with a singular form
dat./inst.pl. input	<i>*skúldramiz</i> ‘shoulder’	regular output: <i>sculdrum</i> ‘shoulder (dat.pl.)’	<i>sculdrum</i> ‘shoulder’	matches both the output and the dative plural comparison form

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
later weak-feminine singular	—	OE <i>sculdra</i> ‘shoulder’	<i>sculdra</i> ‘shoulder’	secondary doublet, useful as a control rather than the inherited target

The dative plural line is decisive because it matches both the output and the paradigm cell of Old English *sculdrum* ‘shoulder’. Singular-oriented candidates either lower the root vowel or compare unlike cells.

shove — OE *scēaf*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **skéubanq*; form followed here **skáub* > *scēaf* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **skáub*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Au Brightening	<i>*skáeub</i>
	OE Diphthong Leveling	<i>*skēab</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	PGmc B Allophony	<i>*skēaβ</i>
	OE Sk Palatalization	<i>*fēaβ</i>

Old English form: *scēaf*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the strong verb as **skeuban-* ~ **skūban-* and cites Old English present forms *scēofan* ‘shove’, *scūfan* ‘shove’ (Kroonen 2013, 444). Those present-system forms belong to the same verb family, but the comparison here uses the singular preterite **skáub* ‘shove’, not the infinitive.

Old English evidence The ordinary dictionary verb is *scūfan* ‘shove’/*scēofan* ‘shove’, but the preterite itself is well attested. Bright gives the principal parts *scufan* ‘shove’, *sceaf* ‘shove’, *scufon* ‘shove’, *scofen* ‘shove’ (Bright 1971, 347). Sweet gives the same paradigm (Sweet 1953, 29). The normalized form here is *scēaf* ‘sheaf’, regularizing the attested spellings *sceaf* ‘shove’ and prefixed *āsceaf* ‘shove’.

Development to Old English From **skáub* ‘shove’, the development is straightforward. **au* fronts and levels to *ēa*, final **b* becomes a fricative and is written *f*, and initial **sk-* undergoes the usual Old English palatalized spelling in this environment. The derivation therefore gives **skáub* ‘shove’ > **skáeub* ‘shove’ > **skēab* ‘shove’ > **skēaβ* ‘shove’ > *scēaf* ‘sheaf’.

Paradigm comparison A paradigm comparison is needed here because the ordinary citation verb and *scēaf* ‘sheaf’ belong to different cells of the same strong paradigm. The comparison below is manual.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
citation infinitive	*skéubanaq	inherited infinitive line scēofan; present system also leveled scūfan ‘shove’	scēofan ‘shove’ / scūfan ‘shove’	necessary background, but not the comparison used for scēaf ‘sheaf’
1/3 sg. preterite	*skáub	documented regular output: scēaf ‘sheaf’	scēaf ‘sheaf’	direct match for the singular preterite
preterite plural	*skúbun	later leveled plural scufon ‘shove’ beside expected scūfun under the corrected cascade	scufon ‘shove’	poorer comparison for the singular-preterite target
past participle	*skúbanaz	attested participial line scofen ‘shove’	scofen ‘shove’	valid alternative cell, but not the form compared here

span — OE spanne

Derivation: citation reconstruction *spannō; form followed here *spánnai > spanne (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: *spánnai

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening
PNWGmc Unstressed Ai	*spánnē
Monophthongization	
Early Anglo-Frisian	
[no change]	

Old English form: spanne

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Seebold gives Old English *spann* ‘span’ under this noun family (Seebold 1970, 450). The form followed here, *spánnai ‘span’, is therefore not a rival headword, but the specific dative singular form compared on the model of the feminine ō-stem paradigm (Brunner 1965, sect. 252; 1965, sect. 255.2).

Old English evidence The reviewed lexicographic evidence more directly supports the citation noun *spann* ‘span’ than the exact form *spanne* ‘span’. Clark Hall gives *spann* ‘span’ (Clark Hall 1960, 286), and *spanne* ‘span’ is accordingly treated as the regular dative singular form compared here rather than as a dictionary headword.

Development to Old English Citation *spannō ‘span’ yields *span* ‘span’. The oblique cell *spánnai ‘span’ therefore supplies the conservative comparison form: it preserves the medial geminate and yields *spanne* ‘span’, while citation *spannō gives the nominative background form.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the citation form beside the dative singular form compared here.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
citation nominative singular	* <i>spannō</i>	regular output: <i>span</i> ‘span’	<i>spann</i> ‘span’	useful citation-form background, but not the form compared here
dative singular compared here	* <i>spánnai</i>	regular output: <i>spanne</i> ‘span’	<i>spanne</i> ‘span’	exact match for that conservative form

thistle — OE *pistles*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **θéstilaz*; form followed here **θístilas* > *pistles* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **θístilas*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening OE L Adjacent Syncope OE Unstressed AE Merger
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	* <i>θístilæ̃s</i> * <i>θístlæ̃s</i> * <i>θístles</i>

Old English form: *pistles*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel prints **þe(x)stilaz* ‘thistle’ for the lexeme (Orel 2003, 458). The comparative label **θéstilaz* ‘thistle’ therefore remains in view as the lexeme-level headword, while the derivational input **θístilas* ‘thistle’ is a specific genitive singular cell.

Old English evidence The ordinary simplex headword tradition is broken *pistel* ‘thistle’ / *ðistel* ‘thistle’. Clark Hall gives *ðistel* as the noun headword (Clark Hall 1960, 326). The Old English form here here is the genitive singular *pistles* ‘thistle’, which preserves the same stem in an oblique form where the cluster is medial.

Development to Old English Campbell’s discussion of cluster nouns shows the contrast clearly. Simplex forms often develop a parasite vowel in word-final obstruent + sonorant clusters, while comparable medial clusters remain unbroken; his examples include *hrefn*, *tacn* ‘token, sign’, *wépn* ‘weapon’, and *botm* ‘bottom’ beside forms with parasitic vowels elsewhere in the same lexical class (Campbell 1959, 151). The genitive singular **θístilas* ‘thistle’ therefore supplies the conservative comparison form: the cluster is medial and the regular development yields *pistles* ‘thistle’, while the simplex nominative belongs to the broken headword tradition *pistel* ‘thistle’.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It shows the contrast between the citation form and the genitive singular cell.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
citation nominative singular	* <i>θéstilaz</i>	computed output: <i>þistl</i>	<i>þistel</i> ‘thistle’	useful citation-form background, but not the Old English form here
genitive singular	* <i>θístilas</i>	computed output: <i>þistles</i> ‘thistle’	<i>þistles</i> ‘thistle’	exact match for the conservative cell

make (iptv.2sg) — OE *maca*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **makōnq*; form followed here **mákô* > *maca* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **mákô*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening	* <i>mækô</i>
	OE A Restoration	* <i>makô</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	* <i>maka</i>

Old English form: *maca*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The make-family belongs to the Old English class-II weak verbs. Campbell cites *lapiān*, *maciān* ‘make’ among verbs with restored *a* (Campbell 1959, sect. 159). Ringe and Taylor place the Germanic verb in the same class, comparing West Germanic continuants such as Old Frisian *makia* ‘make’, Old Saxon *makon* ‘make’, and Old High German *mahhon* ‘make’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 191).

The derivational input **mákô* ‘make (iptv.2sg)’ is not the citation form of the lexeme but a finite paradigm cell. Ringe and Taylor give the class-II weak imperative singular as -a < *-ō, which makes this cell the relevant comparison point for the Old English form treated here (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 314).

Old English evidence The dictionary headword is *maciān* ‘make’ (Clark Hall 1960, 193). The form compared here in this entry is therefore not the lemma but the imperative singular *maca* ‘make’, chosen as a paradigm form beside the headword *maciān* ‘make’ and the related finite form *macaþ* ‘makes’.

The lexical history is still that of *maciān* ‘make’, but the finite cell isolates the regular outcome of trimoric *ō more cleanly than the citation form does.

Development to Old English From **mákô* ‘make (iptv.2sg)’, Anglo-Frisian brightening first gives **mækô* ‘make (iptv.2sg)’. Campbell cites *maciān* ‘make’ among the class-II verbs with restored *a* (Campbell 1959, sect. 159). Ringe and Taylor’s class-II weak imperative singular -a < *-ō then supports the later finite ending (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 314).

The same development explains why earlier fronted forms of the *mæcā* ‘make’ type do not control the entry. Once trimoric *ō is treated as a back-vocalic trigger for restoration, the imperative singular falls into line with the broader *maciān* ‘make’ family.

Paradigm comparison A paradigm comparison identifies which finite cell of the make-family matches the Old English form chosen here. The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Old English outcome or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
lexeme-level infinitive	* <i>mákōjaną</i>	comparative continuation <i>macian</i> ‘make’	<i>macian</i> ‘make’	ordinary headword of the verb, but not the finite form compared here
imperative singular	* <i>mákô</i>	regular output: <i>maca</i> ‘make’	<i>maca</i> ‘make’	exact match between input, output, and selected paradigm form
present third singular companion	* <i>mákōθi</i>	comparative companion <i>macaþ</i>	<i>macaþ</i>	useful family control, but not the target of this entry

make (3sg) — OE *macaþ*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **makōną*; form followed here **mákōθi* > *macaþ* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **mákōθi*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		EAF Brightening	* <i>mæköθ</i>
PWGmc Early I Apocope	* <i>mákōθ</i>	OE A Restoration	* <i>makōθ</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Late O Shortening	* <i>makoθ</i>
		OE Final Unstressed O Lowering	* <i>makaθ</i>
[no change]			

Old English form: *macaþ*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen derives the Old English verb from **makōjan-* on the make-family base **maka-* (Kroonen 2013, 350). Ringe and Taylor likewise derive Old English *macian* ‘make’ from PWGmc **makon* ‘make’ through **mekojan* ‘make’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 191).

The derivational input **mákōθi* ‘makes’ is therefore a finite 3sg cell of the same family, not the citation form of the verb.

Old English evidence Clark Hall lemmatizes the verb as *macian* ‘make’ (Clark Hall 1960, 193). The relevant comparison form here is normalized present-third-singular *macaþ* ‘makes’, set beside the dictionary headword and the related imperative singular *maca* ‘make’.

Campbell’s class-II paradigm gives ordinary 3sg ending *-aþ*, while his dialect survey allows secondary *-e-* spellings in some traditions (Campbell 1959, sect. 356.4; 1959, sect. 757). *Macap* ‘makes’ is thus the regular comparison form for the non-*j* 3sg cell.

Development to Old English After early loss of final *-i*, **mákōθi* ‘makes’ → **mákōθ* ‘makes’ after loss of final *-i*. Anglo-Frisian brightening gives **mækōθ* ‘makes’, but Campbell lists *macian* ‘make’ among class-II verbs with restored *a*, so the stem returns to *mak-* before the ending is reduced (Campbell 1959, sect. 159).

The ending then follows ordinary class-II 3sg development: **makōθ* ‘makes’ > **makaθ* ‘makes’ > *macaþ*. Campbell’s *_lufas*, *-aþ* (< *-ōsi*, *-ōþi*) and Ringe and Taylor’s discussion of stable class-II_a in finite non-*j* cells support this sequence (Campbell 1959, sect. 356.4; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 80).

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the selected 3sg cell from the make-family lemma and from the companion imperative form.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE outcome or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
lexeme-level infinitive	<i>*makōjaną</i>	dictionary headword macian ‘make’	macian ‘make’	family background, but not the cell compared here
3sg present	<i>*mákōθi</i>	regular output macaþ ‘makes’	macaþ ‘makes’	exact match
imperative singular companion	<i>*mákô</i>	related finite form <i>maca</i> ‘make’	<i>maca</i> ‘make’	useful control, but not the target

bore (iptv.2sg) — OE *bora*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **burōną*; form followed here **búró* > *bora* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **búró*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening
PNWGmc U Lowering <i>*bórô</i>	<i>*bóra</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	
[no change]	

Old English form: *bora*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the bore-family verb as **burojan-* and cites Old English *borian* ‘bore’ among its continuants (Kroonen 2013, 85). Ringe and Taylor give the class-II weak imperative singular ending as *-a* < **-ō* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 314).

The derivational input **búró* ‘bore (iptv.2sg)’ is therefore an imperative cell of the same family, not the citation form of the verb.

Old English evidence Clark Hall lemmatizes the verb as *borian* ‘bore’ (Clark Hall 1960, 48). The comparison form here is the normalized imperative singular *bora* ‘bore (iptv.2sg)’, used beside the headword and the related 3sg form *borap* ‘bores’.

The imperative is thus a paradigm form rather than a replacement for the dictionary lemma. It is the most direct Old English comparator for the non-*j* finite cell represented by **búró* ‘bore (iptv.2sg)’.

Development to Old English Northwest Germanic lowering first gives **bórô* ‘bore (iptv.2sg)’ from **búró* ‘bore (iptv.2sg)’, and late shortening of the unstressed long vowel then yields **bóra* ‘bore (iptv.2sg)’, whence *bora* ‘bore’.

Ringe and Taylor’s class-II imperative singular -a < *-ô points to exactly this type of outcome (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 314). The form compared here therefore isolates the regular finite-cell development more cleanly than the remodelled infinitive does.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the selected imperative cell from the bore-family lemma and from the companion 3sg form.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE outcome or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
lexeme-level infinitive	<i>*burōjanq</i>	dictionary headword <i>borian</i>	<i>borian</i>	family background, but not the cell compared here
imperative singular	<i>*búró</i>	regular output <i>bora</i> ‘bore’	<i>bora</i> ‘bore’	exact match
3sg present companion	<i>*búrōθi</i>	related finite form <i>borap</i> ‘bores’	<i>borap</i> ‘bores’	useful control, but not the target

bore (3sg) — OE *borap*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **burōnq*; form followed here **búrōθi* > *borap* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **búrōθi*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Late O Shortening	<i>*bóroθ</i>
PWGmc Early I Apocope	<i>*búrōθ</i>	OE Final Unstressed O Lowering	<i>*bóraθ</i>
PNWGmc U Lowering	<i>*bórōθ</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *borap*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the bore-family verb as **burojan-* and cites Old English *borian* ‘bore’ among its reflexes (Kroonen 2013, 85). The form compared here isolates the finite 3sg cell **búrōθi* ‘bores’ rather than the infinitive.

Campbell’s class-II pattern *lufas*, -*ap* (< -*ōsi*, -*ōþi*) and Ringe and Taylor’s account of stable class-II *a* in finite forms make this 3sg cell the relevant comparison form for the ending (Campbell 1959, sect. 356.4; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 80).

Old English evidence Clark Hall lemmatizes the verb as *borian* ‘bore’; the imperative singular *bora* and present-third-singular *borap* ‘bores’ are the relevant comparison forms (Clark Hall 1960, 48).

Campbell’s dialect survey allows secondary -*e*- and -*o*- spellings in 2sg and 3sg class-II forms, but the basic ending remains -*ap* (Campbell 1959, sect. 757). The regular comparison form for this non-*j* 3sg cell is *borap* ‘bores’.

Development to Old English From **búrōθi* ‘bores’, loss of final *-i* first gives **búrōθ* ‘bores’. Northwest Germanic lowering then produces **bórōθ* ‘bores’, and late shortening of unstressed *ō* yields **bóraθ* ‘bores’. *Boraþ* ‘bores’ is therefore the regular comparison form for this non-*j* 3sg cell.

Campbell’s class-II ending evidence and Ringe and Taylor’s discussion of stable *a* in finite non-*j* cells support this sequence (Campbell 1959, sect. 356.4; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 80).

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the selected 3sg cell from the bore-family lemma and from the companion imperative form.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE outcome or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
lexeme-level infinitive	<i>*burōjanq</i>	dictionary headword <i>borian</i>	<i>borian</i>	family background, but not the cell compared here
3sg present	<i>*búrōθi</i>	regular output <i>borap</i> ‘bores’	<i>borap</i> ‘bores’	exact match
imperative singular companion	<i>*búrō</i>	related finite form <i>bora</i> ‘bore’	<i>bora</i> ‘bore’	useful control, but not the target

learn (iptv.2sg) — OE *liorna*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **līznōjanq*; form followed here **līznō* > *liorna* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **līznō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Breaking	<i>*līornō</i>
EAF Rhotacism	<i>*līrnō</i>	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*līorna</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *liorna*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor give Old English *liornian* ‘learn’ and *leornian* ‘learn’ from a learn-family base of the **līzn-* type (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 38), and Kroonen likewise keeps the weak verb as **līznōn-* (Kroonen 2013, 380). Fulk cites the same Old English family from **līznō-* (Fulk 2018, 127).

The derivational input **līznō* ‘learn (iptv.2sg)’ is a finite imperative cell of that family, not the citation form of the verb.

Old English evidence Clark Hall gives the ordinary headword as *leornian* (Clark Hall 1960, 186). Brunner explicitly records *leornian*, *nordh. auch liorna*, and Campbell notes Northumbrian forms with *io* beside *leornian* (Brunner 1965, sect. 417 Anm. 10; Campbell 1959, sect. 123 n. 2).

Liorna can therefore be treated as an attested Northumbrian finite form, while *leornian* ‘learn’ remains the better-known dictionary headword.

Development to Old English The form compared here develops regularly as **līznô* ‘learn’ > **līrnô* ‘learn’ by rhotacism, then **līornô* ‘learn (iptv.2sg)’ by breaking before *rn*, and finally **līorna* ‘learn’ > *liorna* by late shortening of the unstressed long vowel.

Campbell’s Northumbrian *io* evidence and Ringe and Taylor’s explicit statement that no form of *liornian* stood in an i-umlauting environment support this stem shape (Campbell 1959, sect. 123 n. 2; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 247). The West-Saxon-looking *eo* forms belong to a different dialectal presentation of the same family.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the selected imperative cell from the learn-family infinitive and from the companion 3sg form.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE outcome or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
lexeme-level infinitive	<i>*līznōjanq</i>	Northumbrian <i>liornian</i> ‘learn’; dictionary headword often <i>leornian</i> ‘learn’	<i>liornian</i> ‘learn’ / <i>leornian</i> ‘learn’	family background, but not the cell compared here
imperative singular	<i>*līznô</i>	regular output and Brunner’s Northumbrian <i>liorna</i>	<i>liorna</i>	exact match
3sg present companion	<i>*līznôθi</i>	related finite form <i>liornaþ</i>	<i>liornaþ</i>	useful control, but not the target

learn (3sg) — OE *liornaþ*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **līznōjanq*; form followed here **līznôθi* > *liornaþ* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **līznôθi*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Breaking	<i>*līornôθ</i>
PWGmc Early I Apocope	<i>*līznôθ</i>	OE Late O Shortening	<i>*līornoθ</i>
EAF Rhotacism	<i>*līrnôθ</i>	OE Final Unstressed O Lowering	<i>*līornaθ</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *liornaþ*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor give Old English *liornian* ‘learn’ and *leornian* ‘learn’ from a learn-family base of the **līzn-* type (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 38), and Kroonen likewise keeps the weak verb as **līznôn-* (Kroonen 2013, 380). The derivational input **līznôθi* ‘learns’ is the finite 3sg cell of that family, not the citation form of the verb.

For the ending, Campbell’s class-II *-aþ* (< *-ôþi*) and Ringe and Taylor’s discussion of stable class-II *a* in finite forms make the non-*j* 3sg cell the relevant comparison point (Campbell 1959, sect. 356.4; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 80).

Old English evidence Clark Hall gives the ordinary headword as *leornian* ‘learn’ (Clark Hall 1960, 186). Brunner records Northumbrian finite forms in *liorn-*, including *liorna* ‘learn’ and *liornes* ‘learning’, beside the West-Saxon-oriented *leornian* tradition (Brunner 1965, sect. 417

Anm. 10). Campbell likewise notes Northumbrian forms with *io* beside *leornian* (Campbell 1959, sect. 123 n. 2).

The relevant comparison form here is the normalized 3sg *liornaþ* ‘learns’. The directly cited Old English evidence supports the finite stem *liorn-*; the *-aþ* ending follows the regular class-II 3sg pattern.

Development to Old English The form compared here develops as **līznōθi* ‘learns’ > **līrnōθi* ‘learns’ by rhotacism, then **līrnōθ* ‘learns’ after early apocope of final *-i*, then **līornōθ* ‘learns’ by breaking before *rn*, and finally **līornaθ* ‘learns’ > *liornaþ* ‘learns’ by late shortening of the unstressed long vowel.

Campbell’s Northumbrian *io* evidence and Ringe and Taylor’s statement that no form of *liornian* stood in an i-umlauting environment support the stem, while Campbell’s class-II ending evidence supports the final *-aþ* (Campbell 1959, sect. 123 n. 2; Campbell 1959, sect. 356.4; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 247).

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the selected 3sg cell from the learn-family infinitive and from the companion imperative form.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE outcome or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
lexeme-level infinitive	<i>*līznōjaną</i>	Northumbrian <i>liornian</i> ‘learn’; dictionary headword often <i>leornian</i> ‘learn’	<i>liornian</i> ‘learn’ / <i>leornian</i> ‘learn’	family background, but not the cell compared here
3sg present	<i>*līznōθi</i>	regular output <i>liornaþ</i> ‘learns’	<i>liornaþ</i> ‘learns’	exact match
imperative singular companion	<i>*līznô</i>	regular output and Brunner’s Northumbrian <i>liorna</i>	<i>liorna</i>	useful control, but not the target

lick (iptv.2sg) — OE *licca*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **likkōną*; form followed here **līkkô* > *licca* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **līkkô*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	<i>*līkka</i>

Old English form: *licca*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor give PWGmc **ekkōn* ‘lick (3sg.)’ continuing as Old English *liccian* ‘lick’, Old Saxon *likkon* ‘lick’, and Old High German *lecchon* ‘lick’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 50). Orel gives the fuller weak-verb reconstruction **likkōjanan* ‘lick’ with the same Old English continuation (Orel 2003, 285).

Campbell’s weak class-II discussion gives present forms such as *lufas*, *-aþ* (< *-ōsi*, *-ōþi*) (Campbell 1959, sect. 356.4). Ringe and Taylor likewise note that class-II weak present 2sg. *-as(t)* and 3sg. *-aþ*

have stable *a* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 80). The form treated here is therefore not that remodeled infinitive but a finite cell in bare trimoric **-ō*.

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller lemmatizes the verb as *liccian* ‘lick’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 614). Campbell cites *liccian* ‘lick’ among Old English forms with preserved geminate *cc* (Campbell 1959, sect. 398.1). Brunner likewise cites *liccian* ‘lick’ (Brunner 1965, sect. 45 Anm. 3). The Old English evidence therefore establishes the verbal headword and its consonantal frame securely.

The Old English form here in this entry is the imperative singular *licca* ‘lick’. It is a paradigm form chosen beside the headword *liccian* ‘lick’ and the related present *liccaþ* ‘licks’, not a separately lemmatized citation word.

Development to Old English With the stem *licc-* established, the remaining development is brief. Campbell’s class-II present endings *lufas*, *-aþ* (< *-ōsi*, *-ōþi*) support late *-a* in this finite cell (Campbell 1959, sect. 356.4). Ringe and Taylor likewise note stable *a* in the class-II 2sg and 3sg (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 80). The same stem consonantism that appears in *liccian* ‘lick’ is preserved here, giving *cc* throughout the finite form.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Old English outcome or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
lexeme-level infinitive	<i>*líkkōjanq</i>	regular output <i>liccian</i> ‘lick’	<i>liccian</i> ‘lick’	ordinary dictionary headword of the verb, but not the finite form compared here
imperative singular	<i>*líkkō</i>	regular output <i>licca</i> ‘lick’	<i>licca</i> ‘lick’	exact match between the derivational input and the Old English form here
present third singular companion	<i>*líkkōþi</i>	regular output <i>liccaþ</i>	<i>liccaþ</i>	useful family control, but not the target of this entry

lick (3sg) — OE *liccaþ*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **líkkōnq*; form followed here **líkkōþi* > *liccaþ* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **líkkōþi*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Late O Shortening		<i>*líkkoθ</i>
PWGmc Early I Apocope	<i>*líkkōθ</i>	OE Final Unstressed O Lowering	<i>*líkkaθ</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Old English form: *liccaþ*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor give PWGmc **ekkōn* ‘lick (3sg.)’ continuing as Old English *liccian* ‘lick’, Old Saxon *likkon* ‘lick’, and Old High German *lecchōn* ‘lick’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 50). Orel gives the fuller weak-verb reconstruction **likkōjanan* ‘lick’ with the same Old English continuation (Orel 2003, 285).

The form compared here in this entry is the non-*j* present third singular **likkōθi* ‘licks’, not the remodeled infinitive. Campbell states the class-II present endings as *lufas*, *-aþ* (< *-ōsi*, *-ōþi*) (Campbell 1959, sect. 356.4). Ringe and Taylor likewise note that class-II weak present 2sg. *-as(t)* and 3sg. *-aþ* have stable *a* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 80).

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller lemmatizes the verb as *liccian* ‘lick’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 614). The same consonantal frame appears in Campbell’s and Brunner’s grammatical citations of *liccian* ‘lick’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 398.1; Brunner 1965, sect. 45 Anm. 3). The Old English headword is therefore clear even though the entry here is not about the citation form.

The form treated here is the present third singular *liccaþ* ‘licks’. It is a selected paradigm form beside the lemma *liccian* ‘lick’ and the related imperative *licca* ‘lick’, not a separately lemmatized headword.

Development to Old English **likkōθi* ‘licks’ first loses final *-i*, giving **likkōθ* ‘licks’. Campbell’s class-II present endings *lufas*, *-aþ* (< *-ōsi*, *-ōþi*) support the regular 3sg outcome *-aþ* (Campbell 1959, sect. 356.4). Ringe and Taylor likewise note stable *a* in the class-II 2sg and 3sg (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 80). Because this ending never contains *-j-*, the form does not pass through an i-umlauted *-eþ* stage.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Old English outcome or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
lexeme-level infinitive	<i>*likkōjaną</i>	regular output <i>liccian</i> ‘lick’	<i>liccian</i> ‘lick’	ordinary dictionary headword of the verb, but not the finite form compared here
imperative singular companion	<i>*likkō</i>	regular output <i>licca</i> ‘lick’	<i>licca</i> ‘lick’	useful family control, but not the target of this entry
present third singular	<i>*likkōθi</i>	regular output <i>liccaþ</i> ‘licks’	<i>liccaþ</i> ‘licks’	exact match between the derivational input and the Old English form here

show (iptv.2sg) — OE *scēawa*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **skawōnq*; form followed here **skáwō* > *scēawa* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **skáwō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Aw Long Diphthong	*skéawô
		OE Sk Palatalization	*jéawô
		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	*jéawa

Old English form: *scēawa*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel reconstructs the verb as **skawōjanan* ‘show (iptv.2sg)’ and cites Old English *sceāwian* ‘show’ beside Old Frisian *skawia* ‘show’, Old Saxon *skawōn* ‘show’, and Old High German *scouwōn* ‘show’ (Orel 2003, 337). The derivational input in this entry is not that infinitive but the imperative singular **skáwô* ‘show (iptv.2sg)’, a finite class-II cell with imperative -a < *-ō (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 314).

The imperative singular provides the direct comparison with the Old English form. The lexical history still belongs to the *sceāwian* ‘show’ verb, but the cell compared here isolates the finite -a outcome more clearly than the citation form does.

Old English evidence Bright lists *scēawian* ‘show’ and explicitly gives the imperative singular *scēawa* ‘show’ under that headword (Bright 1971, 346). The form treated here is therefore an attested finite paradigm form, not a reconstructed convenience form.

The spelling used in this entry is normalized *scēawa* ‘show’, while Bright’s glossary gives source spelling *scēawa* ‘show’. The ordinary Old English headword remains *scēawian* ‘show’; *scēawa* ‘show’ is the imperative singular chosen beside it.

Development to Old English Campbell lists *scēawian* ‘show’ under the West Germanic **auw* ‘show (iptv.2sg)’ developments (Campbell 1959, sect. 120). Ringe and Taylor’s class-II weak imperative singular -a < *-ō supports the late finite ending that yields *scēawa* ‘show’ (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 314). The result is therefore the expected finite singular form of the *scēawian* ‘show’ family rather than an analogical replacement of the headword.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Old English outcome or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
lexeme-level infinitive	*skáwōjaną	regular output <i>scēawian</i>	<i>scēawian</i> ‘show’	ordinary dictionary headword of the verb, but not the finite form compared here
imperative singular	*skáwô	regular output <i>scēawa</i> ‘show’	<i>scēawa</i> ‘show’ / normalized <i>scēawa</i> ‘show’	exact match between the derivational input and the Old English form here
present third singular companion	*skáwōθi	regular output <i>scēawaþ</i> ‘show’	<i>scēawaþ</i> ‘show’	useful family control, but not the target of this entry

show (3sg) — OE *scēawaþ*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **skawōnq*; form followed here **skáwōθi* > *scēawaþ* (late analogy).

Derivation trace Proto input: **skáwōθi*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Aw Long Diphthong	<i>*skéawōθ</i>
PWGmc Early I Apocope	<i>*skáwōθ</i> OE Sk Palatalization	<i>*fjáwōθ</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian	OE Late O Shortening	<i>*fjáwoθ</i>
	OE Final Unstressed O Lowering	<i>*fjáwaθ</i>
[no change]		

Old English form: *scēawaþ*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel reconstructs the verb as **skawōjanan* ‘show (3sg)’ and cites Old English *sceáwian* ‘show’ beside Old Frisian *skawia* ‘show’, Old Saxon *skawōn* ‘show’, and Old High German *scouwōn* ‘show’ (Orel 2003, 337). The derivational input in this entry is the present third singular **skáwōθi* ‘show (3sg)’, a finite class-II cell with stable *a* in the 3sg ending (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 80).

Campbell states the class-II present endings as *lufas*, *-aþ* (< *-ōsi*, *-ōþi*) (Campbell 1959, sect. 356.4). Ringe and Taylor likewise note that class-II weak present 2sg. *-as(t)* and 3sg. *-aþ* have stable *a* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 80). The relevant comparison is therefore the 3sg cell itself, not an i-umlauted alternative.

Old English evidence Bright lists the simplex headword *scēawian* ‘show’ and the imperative *scēawa* ‘show’, and under *geond-sceāwian* ‘survey’ also records a third singular *sceawað* ‘show’ (Bright 1971, 383). The evidence thus establishes the *scēaw-* / *sceawað* finite-cell pattern directly.

The form written here as *scēawaþ* ‘shows’ is the normalized simplex comparison form for that weak class-II pattern. It is therefore not a dictionary headword but a finite comparison form aligned with the attested *scēaw-* evidence and the directly cited *sceawað* ‘show’ ending pattern.

Development to Old English Campbell lists *scēawian* ‘show’ under the same West Germanic **auw* ‘show (3sg)’ development (Campbell 1959, sect. 120). **skáwōθi* ‘show (3sg)’ therefore belongs to the *scēaw-* family before the class-II 3sg ending is applied. Campbell’s chronology and Ringe and Taylor’s stable-*a* discussion show that the class-II 3sg ending gives *-aþ*, not *-eþ* (Campbell 1959, sect. 356.4; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 80). Because the ending never contains *-j-*, no i-umlaut applies.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Old English outcome or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
lexeme-level infinitive	<i>*skáwōjanq</i>	regular output <i>scēawian</i>	<i>scēawian</i> ‘show’	ordinary dictionary headword of the verb, but not the finite form compared here useful family control, but not the target of this entry
imperative singular companion	<i>*skáwô</i>	regular output <i>scēawa</i> ‘show’	<i>scēawa</i> ‘show’	

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	Old English outcome or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
present third singular	<i>*skáwōθi</i>	regular output <i>sċēawap</i> ‘shows’	normalized <i>sċēawap</i> ‘shows’; source-side pattern <i>sceawað</i>	exact match for the finite form compared here

Part V. Reconstructed Old English comparators

Direct attestation does not supply the required comparator in these entries. The target is an explicitly reconstructed Old English form and carries the corresponding evidential burden.

knob — OE **cnobba*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **knúppaz*; form followed here **knúbbô* > **cnobba* (reconstructed Old English comparator).

Derivation trace Proto input: **knúbbô*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*knóbbā</i>
PNWGmc U Lowering	<i>*knóbbô</i>	
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Old English form: **cnobba*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The wider knob-family is not uniform. Kroonen's discussion of the Germanic n-stems points to related voiced and voiceless branches within this group (Kroonen 2011, 297). The citation reconstruction **knúppaz* 'knob' represents the broader cognate-set headword, while the form followed here, **knúbbô* 'knob', represents the voiced weak-noun branch treated here.

The Old English record is uneven. The better attested OE material belongs to the voiceless branch, but the present entry represents the reconstructed OE form that would continue the voiced branch behind later English knob.

Old English evidence Clark Hall preserves Old English evidence of the *cnoppa* 'knob' type (Clark Hall 1960, 79). Those forms are genuine Old English evidence, but they belong to the voiceless branch of the family.

The target **cnobba* 'knob' is a reconstructed Old English form, not a directly attested one. I use it for the voiced branch because attested *cnoppa* 'knob' continues the voiceless branch and therefore represents a different prehistory.

Development to Old English From the weak-noun form followed here, **knúbbô* 'knob', the regular Old English outcome is **cnobba* 'knob', with Proto-Germanic *kn-* represented in Old English as *cn-* and with the expected weak-noun ending.

The entry therefore does not claim that **cnobba* 'knob' is attested. Its claim is different: if the voiced weak-noun branch is the one to be represented, then **cnobba* is the regular Old English form corresponding to that branch.

Reconstruction status

Form	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>*knúbbô</i> > <i>*cnobba</i>	reconstructed OE form; regular derivation	reconstructed Old English form compared here
<i>cnopp</i> / <i>cnoppa</i>	attested OE branch	important control form, but belongs to the voiceless branch
<i>cnæp</i>	attested OE form from another family	not part of the present lexeme line

This remains the most review-sensitive item here, because the choice between reconstructed **cnobba* ‘knob’ and attested *cnoppa* ‘knob’ is still a comparator-policy question rather than a settled point of OE attestation.

reek — OE **rēac*

Derivation: citation reconstruction **ráukiz*; form followed here **ráukaz* > **rēac* (reconstructed Old English comparator).

Derivation trace Proto input: **ráukaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Au Brightening	<i>*ráeuka</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*ráuka</i>	OE Diphthong Leveling	<i>*rēaka</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*rēak</i>
[no change]			

Old English form: **rēac*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The wider noun family is represented by **ráukiz* ‘reek’ / **rauکی-*, with Old English *rēc* ‘reek’ as the attested noun reflex in the comparative dictionaries (Kroonen 2013, 446; Orel 2003, 338). The derivational input **ráukaz* ‘reek’ is therefore not the lexeme-level headword, but the form used here for the Old English derivation.

Old English evidence The attested noun is *rēc* ‘reek’, not **rēac* ‘reek’. Clark Hall records *rēc* ‘reek’ as the noun and also preserves related forms such as *rēcels* ‘incense’; Kroonen likewise gives OE *rēc* ‘reek’ under the noun family (Clark Hall 1960, 255; Kroonen 2013, 446). Clark Hall and Seebold also record verbal *rēac* ‘reek’ as the preterite of *rēocan* ‘reek’, but that verbal form is separate from the noun treated here (Clark Hall 1960, 254; Seebold 1970, 380).

The Old English form here **rēac* ‘reek’ is therefore a reconstructed West Saxon noun form, not a directly attested manuscript headword.

Development to Old English From **ráukaz* ‘reek’, the regular West Saxon development gives **rēac* ‘reek’. The attested noun *rēc* ‘reek’ belongs to the same lexical family, but reflects a later smoothed surface form rather than the regular noun target represented here.

Form note The distinction here is between an attested noun headword *rēc* ‘reek’ and a reconstructed regular West Saxon target **rēac* ‘reek’. The latter is treated as the modelling target, while the former remains philological background.

strew — OE **strīegan*

Derivation: **stráwjaną* > **strīegan* (reconstructed Old English comparator).

Derivation trace Proto input: **stráwjaną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE Awwj Resolution	<i>*stráujaną</i>
PWGmc J Gemination	<i>*stráwwjaną</i>	OE Au Brightening	<i>*stráujaną</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian		OE Diphthong Leveling	<i>*strēajaną</i>
[no change]		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*strēajan</i>
		OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*strēajan</i>
		OE I Umlaut	<i>*strīejan</i>
		OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*strīejan</i>
		OE J Strengthening After Front	<i>*strīezan</i>
		Diphthong	

Old English form: **strīegan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites the inherited weak verb as **straujan-* and gives Old English *streowian* ‘strew’ as its dictionary continuation (Kroonen 2013, 483). Ringe and Taylor separate the inherited class-I branch from the remodelled class-II branch: Anglian *strēgan* ‘strew’ continues the inherited verb, while West Saxon *streowian* ‘strew’ is remodelled (Ringe and Taylor 2014, sect. 6.1 n. 27).

Luick groups **strauwjan* ‘strew’ with the same set as **hauwja-* and **kauwjan* ‘chew’, yielding Anglian *strēzan* ‘strew’ beside West Saxon forms of the *hīez* ‘hew’, *ciezan* ‘choose’ type (Luick 1914–1940, sect. 98). Fulk likewise allows an early West Saxon **striegan* ‘strew’ directly from Proto-Germanic **straujana* ‘strew’ (Fulk 2018, sect. 4.10 n. 1).

Old English evidence The attested inherited Old English form is *strēgan* ‘strew’ in Anglian. The attested West Saxon citation forms are *strewian* ‘strew’, *streowian* ‘strew’, and *strēawian* ‘strew’, which belong to the remodelled class-II branch (Ringe and Taylor 2014, sect. 6.1 n. 27; Campbell 1959, sect. 753.7).

The target **strīegan* ‘strew’ is therefore a reconstructed Old English form, not an attested manuscript lemma. It represents the inferred West Saxon reflex of the inherited class-I branch.

Development to Old English From **stráwjaną* ‘strew’, the inherited West Saxon line passes through **straujaną* ‘strew’, then a fronted **strēajan-* stage, then **strīejan* ‘strew’ by i-umlaut, with retained/strengthened glide after the front diphthong to yield reconstructed **strīegan* ‘strew’.

This differs from Anglian *strēgan* ‘strew’, where smoothing removes the diphthongal sequence, and from West Saxon *strewian* ‘strew’ / *streowian* ‘strew’ / *strēawian* ‘strew’, where the verb has already been remodelled into class II (Fulk 2018, sect. 4.10 n. 1; Campbell 1959, sect. 753.7).

Reconstruction status

Form or branch	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>strēgan</i> ‘strew’	attested Anglian inherited class-I form	proves that the inherited verb survived into Old English
<i>*strīegan</i> ‘strew’	reconstructed West Saxon inherited class-I form; trace-supported	Old English form here
<i>strewian</i> / <i>streowian</i> ‘strew’ / <i>strēawian</i>	attested remodelled West Saxon class-II forms	genuine OE evidence, but not the inherited branch modeled here

Part VI. Known but unmodelled developments

The historical development is sufficiently supported by comparative and philological evidence, but the current transducer cascade does not yet implement the phonological or morphological process required to derive the target. Naming the gap explains the status without pretending that no historical account exists.

fire — OE *fyre*

Derivation: **fūri* yields regular *fȳr*; the Old English form here is *fyre* (known but unmodelled development).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fūri*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
Northwest and West Germanic	OE I Umlaut	<i>*fȳri</i> <i>*fȳr</i>
[no change]	OE High Vowel Apocope	
Early Anglo-Frisian		
[no change]		

Regular outcome: *fȳr*

Old English form: *fyre*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen places the lexeme in a heteroclitic family **fōr* ‘fire’ ~ **fun-* and explains the front-mutated West Germanic forms from an oblique form of the **fu(w)eri* type (Kroonen 2013, 151). The derivational input **fūri* ‘fire’ therefore does not function as an arbitrary substitute for the headword: it represents the specific inherited cell that supplies the *i* needed for i-umlaut.

The Old English target combines a regular inherited form *fȳr* ‘fire’ with an attested analogical surface form *fyre* ‘fire’.

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller records *fȳr* ‘fire’ as the noun ‘fire’ and also preserves oblique *fyre* ‘fire’ in the Old English record (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 288). The first is the regular inherited outcome of the phonological development from the selected input; the second shows the later restoration of a final *-e* within the paradigm.

The entry therefore concerns the relation between a regular inherited oblique input and an attested Old English surface form that has undergone later morphological remodeling.

Development to Old English From **fūri* ‘fire’, i-umlaut changes *ū* to *ȳ* (Hogg 1992b, sect. 3.3.3.1). Subsequent loss of the final high vowel after a heavy syllable yields *fȳr* ‘fire’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 345). The inherited phonology is complete at that point.

fȳr ‘fire’ is later than that inherited output. Its final *-e* belongs to analogical restoration in the Old English paradigm rather than to the original Proto-Germanic ending. The form therefore remains a known but unmodelled remodelling: the deterministic phonology is regular, but the attested surface form includes later morphological rebuilding.

Paradigm comparison The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the lexeme-level etymological background from the inherited cell that actually produces the front-mutated form and from the later analogical surface result.

PGmc cell / interpretation	Candidate input	OE output or comparison	OE comparison form	Result
lexeme-level heteroclitic headword	<i>*fōr</i> ‘fire’ ~ <i>*fun-</i>	comparative background only	fire family	explains the wider lexeme, but not the selected oblique input
inherited oblique cell	<i>*fūri</i>	regular output: <i>fȳr</i> ‘fire’	<i>fȳr</i> ‘fire’	regular inherited output from the derivational input
later analogical surface form	—	attested <i>fȳre</i> ‘fire’ with restored -e	<i>fȳre</i> ‘fire’	genuine OE target, but not the direct phonological output

tap — OE *tæppa*

Derivation: **táppô* yields regular *tappa*; the Old English form here is *tæppa* (known but unmodelled development).

Derivation trace Proto input: **táppô*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic [no change]	EAF Brightening	<i>*tæppô</i>
	OE A Restoration	<i>*tappô</i>
Early Anglo-Frisian [no change]	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*tappa</i>

Regular outcome: *tappa*

Old English form: *tæppa*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel gives the noun under **tappôn* ‘tap’ and already connects it with Old English *tæppa* ‘tap’ (Orel 2003, 402). The derivational input **táppô* ‘tap’ is therefore the inherited noun itself; the entry does not depend on a different lexeme-level proto or a different inherited noun cell.

Old English evidence The Old English noun family is well attested. Orel gives *tæppa* ‘tap’, and Clark Hall records *tæppa* ‘tap’ together with derivatives *tæppere* ‘tapster’ and *tæppestre* ‘tapster’ (Orel 2003, 402; Clark Hall 1960, 305). The target is therefore a real Old English noun form, not a reconstructed convenience spelling.

Development to Old English From **táppô* ‘tap’, the regular inherited noun path gives *tappa* ‘tap’. The attested target *tæppa* ‘tap’ therefore stands outside that regular phonological development.

The mismatch is historically intelligible, but it is not solved here by a new inherited input. A related j-verb pathway would give *teppan* ‘tap’, not the noun target *tæppa* ‘tap’. The entry accordingly remains a known but unmodelled case.

Form comparison

Form type	Input or form	OE output or comparison	Result
regular inherited noun path attested OE target	<i>*táppô</i> —	regular output: <i>tappa</i> <i>tæppa</i> ‘tap’	regular output, but not the target genuine target form, but analogically remodelled in the present classification
related j-verb background	<i>*táppjanq</i>	<i>teppan</i> ‘tap’	related formation, but not the noun target

Part VII. Unexplained or deliberately unmodelled exceptions

No sufficiently supported account yet reconciles the regular output with the Old English form. An ad hoc sound law would conceal rather than explain the mismatch.

buck — OE *bucc*

Derivation: **búkkaz* yields regular *bocc*; the Old English form here is *bucc* (unexplained exception).

Derivation trace Proto input: **búkkaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*bókk</i>
PNWGmc U Lowering	<i>*bókkaz</i>		
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*bókka</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Regular outcome: *bocc*

Old English form: *bucc*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen and Orel both reconstruct the word with a geminate stop, **bukkaz* ‘buck’ (Kroonen 2013, 121; Orel 2003, 61). Orel also preserves parallel n-stem material behind Old English *bucca* ‘buck’ (Orel 2003, 62). The derivational input therefore remains identical with the lexeme label: no alternative inherited cell accounts for the form.

Old English evidence Old English preserves a mixed lexical picture. Campbell cites *bucca* ‘buck’ in the exception set for this phonological environment (Campbell 1959, sect. 115). Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller show that Old English has both *bucca* ‘buck’ and *bucc* ‘buck’ (Clark Hall 1960, 53; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 122). The a-stem citation form *bucc* ‘buck’ is the target treated here; *bucca* ‘buck’ supplies genuine philological background from the same lexical family.

Development to Old English From **búkkaz* ‘buck’, the regular inherited path gives *bocc* ‘buck’. That is the form expected under the ordinary lowering pattern in this environment. *bucc* ‘buck’ therefore remains outside the deterministic phonology.

No accepted inherited cell repairs the mismatch. A high-vowel alternative would introduce i-umlaut and produce a *bycc* ‘buck’-type form rather than the target. *bucc* ‘buck’ is therefore best treated as a documented exception, not as a regular paradigm-cell survival.

Form comparison

Form type	Input or form	OE output or comparison	Result
regular inherited noun path	<i>*búkkaz</i>	regular output: <i>bocc</i> ‘buck’	regular output, but not the target
attested OE target	—	<i>bucc</i> ‘buck’	genuine target form, but unexplained in the present classification
parallel OE lexical background	—	<i>bucca</i> ‘buck’	related n-stem form, not the present target

fowl — OE *fugol*

Derivation: **fúglaz* yields regular *fogol*; the Old English form here is *fugol* (unexplained exception).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fúglaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*fógl</i>
PNWGmc U Lowering	<i>*fóglaz</i>	OE Epenthetic Vowel	<i>*fógol</i>
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*fógla</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Regular outcome: *fogol*

Old English form: *fugol*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The noun is the ordinary Germanic a-stem **fúglaz* ‘fowl’, continued by forms such as Old Norse *fugl* and Old High German *fogal* ‘bird, fowl’ (Kroonen 2013, 197; Orel 2003, 155). There is no stem-class or paradigm-cell dispute behind this entry. The comparative headword and the derivational input are the same.

The difficulty lies instead in the stressed root vowel. Under the regular West Germanic and Old English development, that *u* should lower before the following non-high vowel, yielding an *o*-vocalism (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 42–43; Campbell 1959, 43).

Old English evidence Old English dictionaries record the noun as *fugol* ‘fowl’, with variant spelling *fugel* ‘fowl’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 282; Clark Hall 1960, 138). The target is therefore an attested ordinary Old English noun, not a reconstructed or selectively chosen paradigm form.

The attested word already contains the crucial problem. Its medial *-o-* is the ordinary parasite vowel of Old English cluster phonology, but the root *fū-* retains *u* where the regular history predicts *fo-* (Campbell 1959, 150).

Development to Old English From **fúglaz* ‘fowl’, the regular cascade yields *fogol* ‘fowl’: the root vowel lowers before the following non-high vowel (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 42–43; Campbell 1959, 43), final *z* is lost, and the cluster is resolved by the usual medial vowel (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 345; Campbell 1959, 150). That is the expected inherited outcome.

The attested Old English noun is *fugol* ‘fowl’, not *fogol* ‘fowl’. Luick and later handbooks treat this preservation of *u* as a small inherited residue, not as a categorical sound law (Luick 1914–1940, 148; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 47). The item therefore remains a genuine lexical exception rather than the output of a recoverable regular mechanism.

Expected and attested forms The comparison below sets the relevant forms side by side. It distinguishes the regular prediction from the attested Old English noun.

Form	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>fogol</i>	computed regular output from <i>*fúglaz</i>	establishes the expected inherited outcome
<i>fugol</i>	attested Old English form	Old English form here; preserves unexplained root <i>u</i>
<i>fugel</i>	attested variant spelling	secondary spelling variant of the attested noun

The unresolved point lies only in the root vowel. The medial *-o-* is regular, but no accepted lautgesetzlich pathway has been found from **fúglaz* ‘fowl’ to attested *fugol* ‘fowl’.

rust — OE *rust*

Derivation: **rústō* yields regular *rost*; the Old English form here is *rust* (unexplained exception).

Derivation trace Proto input: **rústō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*róst</i>
PNWGmc U Lowering	<i>*róstō</i>		
PNWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*róstu</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Regular outcome: *rost*

Old English form: *rust*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The comparative dictionaries do not support a single citation reconstruction uniformly. Orel cites **rustaz* ‘rust’ (sb.m./f.) with Old English *rust* ‘rust’ and Old Saxon and Old High German *rost* ‘rust’ (Orel 2003, 308). The form **rústō* ‘rust’ therefore stands here as a competing citation reconstruction rather than as the best-supported inherited headword.

That disagreement does not remove the central problem. Whether one starts from **rústō* ‘rust’ or from source-supported **rustaz* ‘rust’, the regular citation-form history points toward *rost* ‘rust’, not toward the attested Old English noun.

Old English evidence The Old English noun is attested, not reconstructed. Clark Hall gives *rúst* ‘rust’ (m.) (Clark Hall 1960, 245), and Bosworth-Toller records *rúst* ‘rust’ (also *rust*) (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 677). The form is normalized here as *rust* ‘rust’ from that attested record.

Those dictionary entries identify a masculine noun, which aligns better with Orel’s **rustaz* ‘rust’ than with the competing **rústō* ‘rust’ preserved in the header.

Development to Old English Under Campbell’s regular lowering of stressed *u* before a following mid or low vowel, the citation-form input gives *rost* ‘rust’, not *rust* ‘rust’ (Campbell 1959, sect. 115). The same lowering would also affect comparative citation-form reconstructions such as **rustaz* ‘rust’.

A high-vowel comparator such as instrumental-type **rústu* ‘rust’ would yield *rust* ‘rust’ regularly, but that does not explain the attested citation form of the noun. No accepted regular pathway from the citation form to attested *rust* ‘rust’ has been established.

Expected and attested forms The comparison below sets the regular inherited outcomes beside the attested Old English noun.

Form / interpretation	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>*rústō</i> > <i>rost</i>	computed regular output from one competing citation reconstruction	shows that this citation reconstruction does not reach attested <i>rust</i>
<i>*rustaz</i> > <i>rust</i>	expected regular output from the source-supported citation reconstruction	shows that correcting the stem class does not solve the vowel problem

Form / interpretation	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>*rústu > rust</i>	regular high-vowel comparator	useful negative control, but not a defensible citation-form solution
<i>rust</i>	attested Old English noun, normalized from <i>rūst</i> / <i>rúst</i> / <i>rust</i>	attested Old English form; the citation-form development remains unexplained

wolf — OE *wulf*

Derivation: **wúlfaz* yields regular *wolf*; the Old English form here is *wulf* (unexplained exception).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wúlfaz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		PWGmc Final Bare A Loss	<i>*wólf</i>
PNWGmc U Lowering	<i>*wólfaz</i>		
EAF Final Z Deletion	<i>*wólfa</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Regular outcome: *wolf*

Old English form: *wulf*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The inherited noun is an a-stem: Kroonen gives **wulfa-*, and Ringe and Taylor list PGmc **wulfaz* ‘wolf’ among the inherited words that preserve *u* in Old English beside Old High German *wolf* ‘wolf’ (Kroonen 2013, 638; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 47). Campbell accordingly names Old English *wulf* as an exception to the regular lowering of stressed *u* before a following non-high vowel (Campbell 1959, sect. 115).

The older literature often notices that the exceptional words cluster near labials. Bülbring lists *full*, *wulle*, and *wulf* together, but he also says that the ordinary rule still gives *o* in comparable forms such as *folc* and *bolt* (Bülbring 1902, sect. 116). Luick rejects a categorical labial blocker on the same grounds and prefers a lexical or analogical account instead (Luick 1914–1940, 148).

Old English evidence Campbell treats *wulf* ‘wolf’ as part of the exceptional *u* set (Campbell 1959, sect. 115). Sievers-Brunner notes that oblique *wulfe* ‘wolf (dat.)’ continues *wulfi* ‘wolf (dat.)’ or older *wulfai* ‘wolf (dat.)’ (Brunner 1965, sect. 160).

The surviving oblique forms do not supply a regular route back to bare *wulf* ‘wolf’. They belong to the same lexeme, but they do not remove the explanatory problem presented by the citation form.

Development to Old English Under the ordinary Northwest Germanic lowering of stressed *u* before a following non-high vowel, the citation-form input would point toward *o*-vocalism (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 42–44). The compact trace shows exactly that path: **wúlfaz* ‘wolf’ > **wólfaz* ‘wolf’ > **wólfa* ‘wolf’ > *wolf*.

A high-vowel oblique input would behave differently. There the following high vowel would block the lowering of *u*, but the same environment would also trigger i-umlaut, so the regular control result would be *wylf* ‘wolf’ or *wylfe*, not bare *wulf*. The attested noun therefore remains unexplained at the citation-form level.

Expected and attested forms The comparison below sets the regular inherited outcomes beside the attested Old English noun.

Form / interpretation	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>*wūlfaz > wolf</i>	computed regular output from the citation form	shows the regular development expected from the inherited a-stem
<i>OHG wolf</i>	comparative regular cognate	confirms that the <i>o</i> -vocalism is the ordinary outcome
<i>*wūlfi / *wūlfis > wylf / wylfe</i>	expected high-vowel control forms	shows why oblique high-vowel cells do not solve the noun's vowel history
<i>wulf</i>	attested Old English noun	attested Old English form; the preservation of <i>u</i> remains unexplained

wool — OE *wull*

Derivation: **wūllō* yields regular *woll*; the Old English form here is *wull* (unexplained exception).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wūllō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
Northwest and West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	
PNWGmc U Lowering	<i>*wōllō</i>		<i>*wóll</i>
PNWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*wōllu</i>		
Early Anglo-Frisian			
[no change]			

Regular outcome: *woll*

Old English form: *wull*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence The inherited form is a feminine *ō*-stem **wūllō* ‘wool’. In the ordinary phonological history of West Germanic, stressed *u* lowers before a following non-high vowel, so the regular Old English outcome is an *o*-form. Campbell’s discussion of the parallel adjective *full*, with OHG *fol* ‘full’ as the regular comparator, shows that the handbooks treat this as a genuine exception cluster rather than as a place where the rule itself is doubtful (Campbell 1959, sect. 115).

Bülbring likewise lists *wulle* ‘wool’ among the traditional *u*-preserving exceptions (Bülbring 1902, sect. 116). The comparative evidence therefore establishes two things at once: the regular result should be *woll*, and Old English still has a lexical exception of the *wull* ‘wool’ / *wulle* ‘wool’ type.

Old English evidence The Old English target is given here as *wull* ‘wool’, a normalized lexeme form. Handbook discussion often cites *wulle* ‘wool’, the feminine weak form of the noun (Bülbring 1902, sect. 116). Both point to the same lexical item and to the same exceptional preservation of root *u*.

The OE evidence therefore does not remove the problem. It confirms that the language has a *u*-form where the regular phonology would have produced *o*.

Development to Old English From **wūllō* ‘wool’, the regular sequence is lowering of stressed *u* before a non-high vowel, followed by the ordinary later reductions of the ending. The regular outcome is therefore *woll*.

That regular derivation is not the attested Old English form. Luick rejects a simple phonological rule that would protect this word alone, and Ringe and Taylor state the larger problem plainly: we do not really know why **u* failed to lower in forms of this sort (Luick 1914--1940, 148; Ringe and Taylor 2014, sect. 2.3.1).

What remains unexplained The comparison below sets the regular result beside the attested lexical exception.

Form	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>*wúllō > woll</i>	regular output	shows what the deterministic sound laws produce
<i>wull / wulle</i>	attested OE exception	attested Old English form to be recorded
high-vowel escape from another paradigm cell	unsupported for this noun	rejected because the feminine <i>ō</i> -stem paradigm supplies no suitable escape cell

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